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William Mackenzie Esq.r

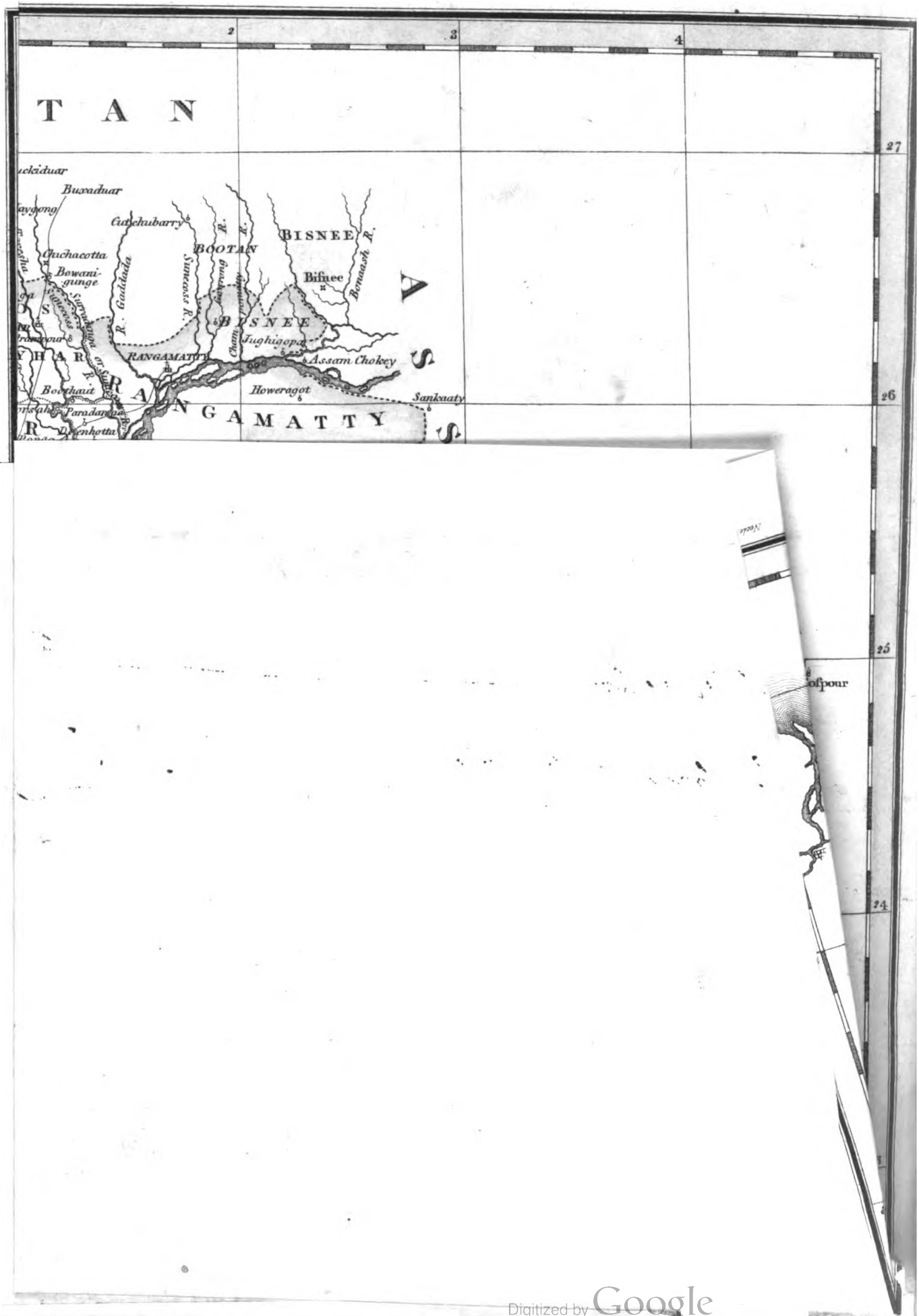
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THE

History

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OF

BENGAL

FROM

THE FIRST MOHAMMEDAN INVASION

UNTIL THE VIRTUAL

CONQUEST OF THAT COUNTRY BY THE ENGLISH

A. D. 1757.

BY

CHARLES STEWART, Esq. M.A.S.

LATE MAJOR ON THE BENGAL ESTABLISHMENT,
PROFESSOR OF ORIENTAL LANGUAGES IN THE HONOURABLE EAST-INDIA COMPANY'S COLLEGE, HERTS.
AUTHOR OF THE DESCRIPTIVE CATALOGUE OF TIPPOO SULTAN'S LIBRARY,
AND TRANSLATOR OF THE TRAVELS OF MIRZA ABU TALEB KHAN.

LONDON:

Sold by

BLACK, PARRY, AND CO. LEADENHALL STREET;

Booksellers to the Hon. East-India Company.

WATTS, Printer, Broxbourne.

1813.

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TO THE

CHAIRMAN, DEPUTY CHAIRMAN,

AND

DIRECTORS

OF

THE HONOURABLE EAST-INDIA COMPANY,

THIS HISTORY

OF THE

FINEST PROVINCE UNDER THEIR DOMINION

IS RESPECTFULLY INSCRIBED,

BY THEIR MOST OBEDIENT

AND FAITHFUL SERVANT,

CHARLES STEWART.

HERTFORD,
May 25, 1813.

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PREFACE.

In offering this work to the public, I do not flatter myself that, to the generality of English readers, it will have many attractions; but to those whose views are not confined to the circle of domestic occurrences, or European politics, I trust it will not be unacceptable.

Every Traveller in a foreign country must be sensible, with how much more interest he views the monuments of antiquity of whose history he has acquired a previous knowledge, than those vestiges of former times which, from his ignorance of the events connected with them, he can only contemplate as useless heaps of ruins, or admire merely for their romantic situations or picturesque beauties.

To those therefore who are looking forward to Bengal as their place of sojourn for several years, a work which faithfully details the events that have been transacted in the country they are about to visit, will, I should hope, prove both instructive and interesting: and to those who have already been resident in the East, it may be presumed to afford some pleasing reflections, by recalling to their minds scenes where many of them will probably acknowledge they have spent the happiest period of their lives. To a few, the subject of this book will be no novelty: but those Gentlemen will probably

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confess, that they acquired their knowledge at the expense of much time and application, a part of which they would gladly have spared.

Of the degree of information it may afford to the politician and statesman, I shall leave others to speak. It is to be regretted, that, in the details of the transactions of the Musselman kings or governors, the narration is seldom varied, by any account of the state of civilization, or of the progress of the arts and sciences: but in a despotic government, where the tyrant was every thing, and the people of no political consequence, and in a state where every individual was a soldier, and educated from his childhood in military habits, it is not to be expected that the historians, generally pensioners of the monarch, should adorn their pages with a detail of circumstances not suited to the taste of their readers.

The greater part of this work is composed of translations made by myself from Persian Historians: I have, however, not declined to make use of the translations of other persons on whom I could depend (which are all noticed in their proper places); and I have availed myself of the assistance of European writers wherever it offered.

To Mr. Bruce's elaborate work I owe much of my information respecting the East-India Company.

To Mr. Jackson, keeper of the Records at the India House, I am indebted for the liberal manner in which he assisted my researches in his office; by which I was enabled to correct the dates of many events that had been mistaken or omitted by the native historians, and to procure copies of the *Firmāns* or Royal Orders inserted in the Appendix: and I freely confess, that without this assistance many of the antient documents

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would have been as unintelligible to me, as a *Shekesteh* manuscript is to a young Persian scholar. The office of Indian Records being unfortunately in a damp situation, the ink is daily fading, and the paper mouldering into dust. The constant attention of Mr. Jackson and his assistants is therefore required to take copies of those documents which are fast vanishing from sight, and in forming a methodical arrangement of the new transcripts.

To CHARLES WILKINS, LL.D. and F.R.S. I return thanks for the trouble he had in selecting and forwarding to me the Persian Manuscripts from the East-India Company's Library.

I beg leave also to return my thanks to WILLIAM WRIGHT, Esq. auditor to the East-India Company, for the information received from his office.

In the progress of this work, generally speaking, I have had no reason to complain of a paucity of materials; but rather of such an abundance, that I have found some difficulty in compressing the narrative within the compass of one volume. Many things, however, have probably escaped my attention; and as Gentlemen residing in Bengal may, by their local inquiries, be enabled to detect mistakes, and to explain some points upon which I have expressed doubts, I shall consider myself obliged to any person who will furnish me with the means of supplying omissions, or of correcting errors.

Throughout the work, I have preserved the date of the Hejira, for the advantage of Oriental scholars, who may have an opportunity of conversing with natives of India on the subject; and to enable them more readily to compare this book with the authors I have mentioned. I must, however, request of them, not to decide hastily against me, because

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I differ from the first author they may read; but that they will suspend their judgment till they have compared both with some other contemporary historian.

I have annexed a List of the Books consulted in the compilation of this work; not with a view of making a parade of Oriental learning, but to evince that great pains have been taken to collect the best information that could be obtained. For the same reason, I have prefixed a correct Map of Behar and Bengal, with parts of Orissa and Arracan; which although it unavoidably adds to the expense of the book, will, I trust, amply compensate the purchaser by its utility.

To the CHAIRMEN and DIRECTORS of the Honourable East-India Company I beg to express my obligations, for their liberal patronage of this work: And having endeavoured to render it worthy the attention of the Public, I submit it, with deference, to that impartial tribunal.

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PRELIMINARY DISCOURSE.

In a work professing to be a History of Bengal, it will probably be expected to find some account of the original inhabitants of the country; and a detail of their gradual rise, from a state of barbarism, to that high degree of civilization in which they were found when first visited by Europeans. In both these respects, I am sorry to say, the reader will be disappointed. Although the Hindoos of Bengal have an equal claim to antiquity and early civilization with the other nations of India, yet we have not any authentic information respecting them during the early ages of their progress; nor is there any other positive evidence of the antient existence of Bengal, as a separate kingdom, for any considerable period, than its distinct language and peculiar written character. It is said to have been, at various periods, tributary to the sovereigns of Oude, Dehly, and Magadha (the present Behar); but, at other times, that its Rajas extended their conquests as far as Benaras*.

Abul Fazil, secretary to the Emperor Akbar, has given, in the *Ayeen Akbery*, a list of sixty-one kings of Bengal, who reigned over that country before the Mohammedan invasion; and although he has in some measure destroyed its credibility, by an ill-judged attempt to make it conform with

* See *Asiatic Researches*, vol. IX. pp. 73, 112. 8vo edit.

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Brahminical antiquity*, yet there is little doubt that it rests on a foundation† of truth; and if twenty or twenty-five years be allowed for each reign, previous to the period of the invasion, viz. A. D. 1203-4, it will give the Bengalese sufficient claim to antiquity.

Mr. Wilford says‡, that Sudruc, or Sudruca, the thirteenth person on the list, was a celebrated conqueror and powerful emperor, and that he lived about the beginning of the Christian æra. But as this is a topic upon which the learned are divided, and as I am credibly informed that materials have been and are still collecting for furnishing an authentic account of the Hindoo governments, I shall dwell no longer on this subject; in the hope that we shall one day be favoured with a history of Bengal from the pure mine of Sanscrit literature.

The province of Bengal is one of the most valuable acquisitions that was ever made by any nation. It is situated between the 21st and 27th degrees of northern latitude, and between the 86th and 92d of eastern longitude; being in

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* As a proof of the uncertainty of Hindoo Chronology, it may be sufficient to state, that the commencement of the Calee Yoog, upon which all antient Hindoo history must depend, is calculated, by the Brahmins at 3100 years B. C.; by the Jinas, 1078 years; by Mr. Wilford, 1370; by Sir William Jones, 1305; and by Mr. Bently, only 57 B. C. See *Asiatic Researches*, vol. IV. pp. 89, 319. and vol. IX. pp. 86, 87, 89. 8vo edit.

† My reasons for giving Abul Fazil so much credit are, first, that he was doubtless a person of very superior ability and indefatigable research: secondly, that he was employed by a monarch who was beloved by the Hindoos, and who withheld no information from him: thirdly, that he was assisted by several learned Pundits, and other intelligent persons: and lastly, that every Hindoo family of distinction retained a herald, whose office it was to keep a register of the birth of each child, and a particular account of the alliances formed by marriage with other families, and every other circumstance connected with genealogy.

‡ See *Asiatic Researches*, vol. IX. page 202. 8vo edit.

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breadth about 300, and in length 400 miles: its area contains nearly twenty-one degrees square. On the north and east it is defended by impenetrable mountains; and on the south by a line of inhospitable and dangerous sea-coast, containing but one harbour capable of admitting vessels of any size; and even that one guarded by innumerable shoals. Its western frontier, although exposed to invasion, is, in many places, so strongly defended by Nature, that fewer troops are requisite to protect it than any other country of similar extent on the continent of Asia. Its numerous navigable rivers, in the possession of a maritime nation, are also so many sources of defence, that should the English ever be driven from all the other parts of India, they may find in Bengal an asylum where no enemy will venture to follow them. Thus secure from a foreign invader, they are equally safe from any insurrection of the natives, whose mildness of disposition and aversion to war are such, that nothing short of the most atrocious cruelty, or of religious persecution, could induce them to draw their swords against their present masters.

If Nature has been thus bountiful to Bengal in its means of external defence and internal security, she has not been less liberal in bestowing on it every other blessing that a nation can desire. Its fertile soil produces every thing requisite for the food of man or animal; and in such abundance, that the crops of one year are sufficient for the consumption of its inhabitants for two. It is thereby enabled to supply all other parts of India with its superabundance; and to become the granary of the East, as Egypt formerly was of the West. In variety of fruits and animals it equally abounds; and yields every other article requisite for the comfort, or even luxury, of

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man. The ingenious inhabitants of Bengal, being well versed in all the arts of useful industry, require no assistance from other countries; whilst their delicate and valuable manufactures are exported to every part of the world. The revenues of Bengal and Orissa, consisting chiefly of rents paid for land, the property of which is vested in the sovereign*, were fixed by Raja Todermul, about the year 1582 (during the reign of the Emperor Akbar), at one crore, six lacs, ninety-three thousand one hundred and fifty-two rupees; or, at 8 rupees per pound sterling, 1,336,644*l.* During the government of Sultan Shujaa they were raised to one crore, thirty-one lacs, fifteen thousand nine hundred and seven rupees, or 1,639,418*l.* 7*s.* 6*d.* In the year 1722 they were increased, by the Nuwab Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan, to one crore, fifty-two lacs, forty-five thousand five hundred and sixty-one rupees, or 1,780,595*l.* 2*s.* 6*d.* For the year 1811-12 the land revenues of Behar, Bengal, and Orissa, amounted to two crore and seventy-two lacs of rupees: deducting seventy lacs for Behar, there remains two crore and two lacs for Bengal and Orissa, or 2,525,000*l.* sterling; which, after allowing 1,025,000*l.* for their proportion of the expenses of the government, leaves a surplus revenue from Bengal and Orissa of 1,500,000*l.*; either to be applied to the purchase of investments or the support of other provinces, or even to be remitted home in specie, whenever the exigencies of the State may require it†. There is also a permanent annual

* This right, or claim, was given up to the zemindars, by Lord Cornwallis, when he made the perpetual settlement in 1793.

† In October 1811, forty lacs of rupees were brought from Bengal, and were sold to the Bank of England for 495,527*l.* sterling.

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revenue, of fifty lacs of rupees, derived from salt and opium, to be added to the account. These must be acknowledged to be great and solid advantages; without taking into consideration the vast increase of commerce and addition to the revenue, arising from the trade of Bengal.

Having thus, I hope, clearly shewn the advantage of Bengal to Great Britain, I trust the Reader may feel equally well assured, that the connection between the two Countries has been beneficial also to the natives of Bengal.

In the following remarks, from the 5th Report of the Select Committee of the House of Commons on the affairs of the East-India Company, I most heartily concur; and believe them, from my own experience, to be perfectly well founded.

"The strength of the Government of British India, di-
"rected as it has been, has had the effect of securing its
"subjects, as well from Foreign depredation, as from internal
"commotion. This is an advantage rarely experienced by the
"subjects of Asiatic States; and, combined with a domestic
"administration, more just in its principles, and exercised
"with far greater integrity and ability than the native one
"that preceded it, may sufficiently account for the improve-
"ments that have taken place; and which, in the Bengal
"Provinces, where peace has been enjoyed for a period of
"time perhaps hardly paralleled in Oriental history, have
"manifested themselves in the ameliorated condition of the
"great mass of the population; although certain classes may
"have been depressed by the indispensable policy of a foreign
"government. The nature and circumstances of our situation
"prescribe narrow limits to the prospects of the natives,
"in the political and military branches of the public ser-
"vice: strictly speaking, however, they were foreigners who

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" generally enjoyed the great offices in those departments, even
" under the Moghul government: but to agriculture and com-
" merce every encouragement is afforded, under a system of
" laws, the prominent object of which is, to protect the weak
" from oppression, and to secure to every individual the fruits
" of his industry. The Country, as may be expected, has,
" under these circumstances, exhibited, in every part of it,
" improvement, on a general view, advancing with accele-
" rated progress in latter times."

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LIST OF PERSIAN BOOKS

USED IN THE

COMPILATION OF THIS WORK.

1. *Taj al Muasir.*

MEMOIRS of the celebrated Mohammed Ghory; commencing with his invasion of Hindoostan, A. D. 1191, and terminating with his death in 1206. See the second Section of this Work.

It was written between the years 1206 and 1220, at Dehly, by *Hussein Nizāmy*, of Nishapore.

The greater part of it is in verse, and it contains much Arabic.

2. *Tabkat Nassiry.*

This Work is divided into many Sections, and may be considered as a General History of the Oriental Mohammedans, till the destruction of the Khalifat by Halagou Khan, A. D. 1258; to which is added an account of Genghiez Khan and his descendants.

The Author was *Minhaje Seraje Addeen Omar al Giorjany*. It was finished in the year 1258-9.

This is a very valuable book, and is written in a clear unaffected style.

3. *Tārīkh Alufy.*

A General History of the Mohammedans for One thousand Lunar Years; viz. from the æra of the Hejira, A. D. 622, to 1592. It was compiled by a Society of Learned Men at the Court of the Emperor Akbar, at the head of which was *Molana Ahmed* of Tatta. The Preface was written by *Abul Fazil*, in the end of the 16th century.

4. *Tabkat Akbery.*

A General History of India, in Nine Sections, commencing A. D. 975, and terminating with 1593. The fifth Section is on Bengal.—Author, *Nizām Addeen Ahmed*, of Herat. Dedicated to the Emperor Akbar, about the year 1600.

5. *Tārīkh Ferishteh.*

A General History of India, in Twelve Sections, commencing A. D. 975, and terminating with 1605.—Written by *Mohammed Kazim Ferishteh*, and dedicated to Abool Muziffir Ibrahīm Adil Shah II. of Bijāpore in the Dekkan, A. D. 1609.

N. B. The two first sections of it have been translated by Colonel Dow, and the third by Mr. Scott. I have given the substance of the seventh section, on Bengal.

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6. *Akbar Nāmeh.*

A copious, but very adulatory, History of the Emperor Akbar; comprising a minute detail of the first forty-seven years of his reign; to which is prefixed an abridged History of his Ancestors.—The Author was the celebrated *Shaikh Abul Fazil Allamy*, Secretary to Akbar. Written in the end of the 16th century.

7. *Zubdet al Tuārīkh.*

Select Parts of History; being a succinct Account of the Mohammedan Kings of Dehly, till the conclusion of the reign of Akbar: also an Account of the Mohammedan Kings of Malwa, Guzerat, Dekkan, Cashmire, Tatta, Moultan, Bengal, and Joanpore. Author, *Noor al Huk Shereky*; probably of Joanpore. No date.

8. *Jehāngire Nāmeh.*

A succinct Account of the Reign of Jehāngire, who mounted the throne of Hindoostan A. D. 1605, and died in 1627.—Author, *Muatimed Khan.*

9. *Shah Jehān Nāmeh.*

A very excellent History of the Emperor Shah Jehān, written the year after his confinement by Aurungzebe, viz. A. D. 1659.—Author, *Mohammed bin Saleh.*

10. *Aalumgire Nāmeh.*

History of the first ten years of the Reign of Aurungzebe; written A. D. 1688-9. Author, *Mirza Mohammed Cazim.*

11. *Muasir Aalumgiry.*

A continuation of the above History, till the death of that Monarch in February 1707. Written in 1710.—Author, *Mohammed Sāky Mustaid Khan.*

12. *Muntekhub al Lebab,* or *Tārīkh Khāfy Khan.*

An excellent History of Hindoostan, commencing with the Invasion of Sultān Baber, A. D. 1519, and continued to the Accession of Mohammed Shāh, A. D. 1718.—Written in 1732. Author, *Mohammed Hashem Khāfy Khan.*

13. *Muasir al Omrah at Timouryeh.*

Memoirs of the Nobility who flourished under the Auspices of the House of Timour (Tamerlane), in India.—Authors, *Abd al Hy Nuaz Khan*, and his son *Sumsam ad Dowlah*, both Noblemen in the Court of the Nizam, at Hyderabad. Published A. D. 1779.

14. *Ryāz Assulateen.*

A History of Bengal, from the earliest period (of authentic) Antiquity, till the Conquest of that Country by the English. Written in 1787-8.—Author, *Ghoolam*

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USED IN THIS WORK.

Hussein Seleemy. He was Moonshy to Mr. George Udny, and resided many years at Mauldah, in the vicinity of the Ruins of Gour, and took considerable pains to ascertain the dates of the Inscriptions on the different buildings. He has, besides, considerable merit in giving the substance of all the Books, which treated on the history of Bengal, that he had access to; but these appear to have been very limited in number, and of course much has been omitted: it is also very deficient in dates. I am, however, indebted to it for the idea of writing of this Work, and for the general outline.

N. B. A more particular description of these Books, excepting Nos. 1. and 14, may be found in the *Descriptive Catalogue of Tippoo Sultān's Library.*

TRANSLATIONS.

1. *Faria de Souza's History of the Portuguese Conquests in Asia.* By *Captain John Stephens,* 1694.
2. *The Seir Mutākhereen,* or, *View of Modern Times:*

   Being a general History of India, from the year A. D. 1706 to 1780; containing the Reigns of the last Seven Emperors of Hindoostan, and an Account of the English Wars in Bengal, by *Syed Ghoolam Hussein Khan,* a relation of the Nuwab Aly Verdy Khan; finished in 1783.

   It was translated by a Renegado Frenchman, named Mustapha, in 1786, and bears such strong evidence of being a literal translation, that I did not think it requisite to search for the Original, which is probably in the East-India Company's Library. It also perfectly coincides with Mr. Jonathan Scott's translation of part of the Original.
3. *History of Hindoostan, by Dow,* 1770.
4. *The Ayeen Akbery of Abul Fazil, by Gladwin,* 1780.
5. *Narrative of the Transactions in Bengal, by Ditto,* 1788.
6. *History of the Successors of Aurungzebe, and History of Bengal, by Scott,* 1794.

The English Books, from which I have received assistance, are mentioned in the course of the Work.

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LIST OF THE GOVERNORS OF BENGAL,

WITH

THE CONTEMPORARY SOVEREIGNS OF HINDOOSTAN AND OF ENGLAND.

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SECT. III. *Early Conquerors of Bengal.*

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1343	743	Ilyas Khaje.	———	———	83
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A. D.	A. H.	Governors of Bengal.	Emperors of Hindoostan.	Kings of England.	Page.
1392	794	Jellal Addeen.	Mohammed IV.	Richard II.	94
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CORRIGENDA.

Page 24, line 2, for *Sinjir, king*, read *Sinjir, lieutenant of the King.*

—— *ib.* 3d date in margin, for 1159 read 1157.

—— 63. The sentence begins at top of the page, "From," &c. and a comma only at "meridian," l. 2.

—— 113, Running Title, for SULTAN ALA ADDEEN, read ALA ADDEEN HUSSEIN SHAH.

—— 155, line 10, for second *Khan* read *Khanan.*

—— 302, line 6. Add Note—"Mr. Orme says the Dutch settled in Bengal about the year 1625."

—— 309, margin, for 1677-8 read 1679-80.

—— 371. Cancel 9th and 10th lines; and add, "Asud Allah, an Afghan Chief, who, with his followers, undertook to defend this territory against the wild mountaineers of Jarcund."

—— 402, line 5, for *ductucks* read *dustucks.*

—— 417, — 16, for *intricate* read *intimate.*

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HISTORY OF BENGAL.

SECT. I.

Of the early Mohammedan Conquerors of India.

INTRODUCTION.

SECT. I.

PREVIOUS to entering on the History of Bengal, it becomes requisite to revert to the first invasion of the north-west provinces of India by the Mohammedans, and to proceed gradually with a narrative of their conquests, until the period from which this History will properly commence: but, as this subject has been before amply detailed in the Translation of Ferishtah's History of Hindoostan by Colonel Dow, it is intended merely to give a summary of those events; referring the reader for more particular information on that subject to the above-mentioned valuable work*.

* Having had frequent occasion, during the compilation of this work, to compare Colonel Dow's Translation with the original of the History of Hindoostan, I conceive it due to the memory of that gentleman, to observe, that few persons could have given a more literal or able translation of his author; and that the suppositions of Mr. Gibbon, and the remarks of a celebrated Orientalist lately given to the public, relative to that History, are equally ill founded. It must be acknowledged, that Colonel Dow has, in some instances, mistaken the author; but such errors may rather be ascribed to the incorrectness of his manuscripts, than to a want of knowledge of the Persian language. It will be recollected, that the 3d volume is not a translation, but a compilation from different authors.

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SECT. I.

Death of Haroun al Rashid, A. D. 809.

After the death of the celebrated Haroun al Rashid, A.H. 170, the temporal power of the Khalifs began gradually to decline: most of the governments of provinces, by the discord or weakness of the Imperial family, became hereditary, and their possessors assumed independence: they, however, retained a nominal respect for the successors of Mohammed; and, constrained by public opinion, inserted the Khalif's name in all their official writings, and acknowledged him as their lord-paramount, temporal and spiritual.

Samanian Dynasty.

The most powerful of those princes that became independent under the Khalifat, was Ishmael Samany, governor of Maverulniher (Transoxania) and Khorassan; who, in the A. D. 870. 263d year of the Hejira, assumed the royal titles. He was the first of the dynasty of the Samanians, who reigned, in the city of Bokhara*, over the provinces of Maverulniher, Khorassan, and the northern part of Persia, with great reputation for justice and humanity.

The family of Samania enjoyed their extensive empire nearly ninety years in much tranquillity and renown, and were celebrated for their justice and the mildness of their government.

Abdul Malik Noo succeeded by his son, Abul Munsur, A. D. 961.

Abdul Malik Noo, the seventh of that race, dying at Bokhara in the 350th year of the Hejira, left a son, then a youth, called Abul Munsur. On this occasion the nobles and principal officers were divided in their opinion about the succession, some favouring the brother of the late monarch, and others declaring for his son. To end the dispute, it was agreed to refer the matter to Abistagy, governor of Khorassan,

* The capital of a province of the same name, in Usbec Tartary. Lat. 39° 15′ N. long. 61° 15′ E.

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SECT. I.

a person distinguished by his integrity and great abilities. Abistagy gave it as his opinion, that Munsur, from his youth, being incapable of governing so extensive an empire with discretion, it would be advisable to elect his uncle to the throne: but before Abistagy's messengers reached Bokhara, the contending parties had settled their dispute, by unanimously electing Munsur to be their king; and the young monarch, offended at Abistagy's opinion, commanded him to relinquish his government, and proceed to Bokhara.

Abistagy revolts from Abul Munsur.

Abistagy, unwilling to trust himself in the power of an irritated prince, who was surrounded by his rivals, sent an excuse to the king, and immediately raised the standard of rebellion: but, finding himself unequal to contend with his adversaries, he quitted Khorassan, with a select corps of 3000 cavalry devoted to his service; and, proceeding to the south-east, he took possession of Ghizne†, declaring himself independent of the Samanian authority.

When the king was informed of the departure of Abistagy from Khorassan, he appointed Abul Hussen to that government, with orders to drive Abistagy from his usurped dominion; but that chief, having reconciled the Afghans of Ghizne to his usurpation, was enabled, by their assistance, to defeat the royal general in two pitched battles; and thus became absolute sovereign of the kingdom of Zabulistan, over which he reigned nearly fifteen years, and died A. H. 365. A. D. 975.

Abistagy was succeeded by his son, Abu Isaac, who died without heirs, after a short reign of one year. On this event,

† Ghizne is situated in latitude 33° 25′ north, and east longitude from the Canaries 104° 20′. 'It is the capital of Zabulistan, and was, at that period, in possession of a tribe of Afghans named Anook.

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SECT. I. Subuctageen, the generalissimo of Abistagy, with the concurrence of the chiefs of the army and the principal inhabitants of Ghizne, mounted the throne, and took to wife the daughter of his patron Abistagy.

SUBUCTAGEEN.

Origin of Subuctageen—Mounts the throne of Ghizne—Invades Hindoostan—Defeats the Raja of Lumghān—Takes possession of Paishawur—Returns to Ghizne—Visits the city of Balkh—Dies.

Subuctageen ascends the throne of Ghizne, A. D. 976.

SUBUCTAGEEN, who was originally a Turkish slave, mounted the throne of Ghizne on the 7th of Shaban, in the 368th year of the Hejira, corresponding with the year 976 of the Christian æra; and, upon this occasion, assumed the title of *Nasir Addeen*.

And invades Hindoostan, A. D. 977.

As soon as Subuctageen found himself firmly established in his government, he resolved to employ his army in making war on the idolaters of India. He, in consequence, invaded the frontier provinces of that country, in the year 367; and, having acquired much plunder, and brought away a number of the inhabitants as slaves, he returned in triumph to his capital.

The Hindoo prince, whose country had been thus invaded, was named Jypaal, the son of Hypaal, of the tribe of Brahmens. His capital was called Bathendeh; and his dominions extended, in a north-west direction, from Lahore to Lumghān*; and, in a south-east line, from Cashmire to Moultan. In order

* The district of Lumghān probably extended as far as the Hindoo Koh†: but this circumstance contradicts the current opinion, that the Hindoos were prohibited crossing the Indus; as we here find that a Hindoo prince possessed countries three degrees west of that river, and that many of his subjects were Afghans.

† See Rennell's Memoir of the Map of Hindoostan.

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SECT. I.

to revenge this insult, Jypaal assembled a numerous army, and advanced towards Ghizne. He was met on the frontier by Subuctageen, and some skirmishing took place between the two armies; but, in consequence of a violent storm, attended by a heavy fall of snow, the Hindoos, who could not endure the cold, sued for peace; the Raja agreeing to pay a fine of a million of *dirhems* ‡, and to present Subuctageen with fifty elephants. Part of the money was paid immediately; the remainder was promised to be liquidated in a short time; and hostages were given for the fulfilment of the treaty. When the Raja returned to his capital, being excited either by avarice, or ashamed of his pusillanimous conduct, he refused to comply with the stipulated terms; and ordered that the persons whom Subuctageen had sent to receive the tribute should be detained until his hostages were released. He at the same time sent embassies to the different Rajas of Hindoostan, imploring them to unite with him in defence of their country and of their religion.

When this intelligence was brought to Subuctageen, he re-assembled his troops, and marched towards Lumghān. The contending armies met on the frontier; and, although the Hindoo forces amounted to 200,000 men, supported by a number of elephants, the Mohammedans gained an easy conquest: they drove their adversaries across the Sinde, or Nilab, and took complete possession of the countries of Lumghān and Paishawur. One of the Omrahs, having under his command 10,000 horse, was appointed Governor of Paishawur: and the Afghans, and especially the tribe of Khiligi,

‡ *Dirhem*, a small silver coin, which has varied much in value. It may, however, be averaged at *sixpence* English.

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SECT. I.

who inhabited the mountains, having promised allegiance, numbers of them were enrolled in the service. After having settled the country to his satisfaction, Subuctageen returned in triumph to his capital.

During the remainder of his reign, Subuctageen was so much engaged by his wars in Tartary, that he did not again interfere with Hindoostan. He died in the year 387, and was buried at Ghizne.

A.D. 397.

SULTAN MAHMOOD GHAZY

Invades Hindoostan—Engages and defeats Raja Jypaal—Takes Bathendeh—Invades Moultan—Conquers the Raja of Bhattea, and Daoud Khan, an Afghan Chief—Invades Nagorkote—Opposed in his progress by Raja Annundpaal—Takes the fort of Bhimnagur—Returns to Ghizne—Obtains the title of Sultan—Marches to Thannasar—Takes that fortress, and destroys the celebrated image—Takes the fortress of Nadoune—Invades Cashmire—Repulsed—Again invades Hindoostan—Subdues the Raja of Cannouge—Takes the cities of Merat, Mabin, and Muttra—Returns to Ghizne—Invades Hindoostan a sixth time—Advances to the bank of the river Jumna—Defeats the Hindoo forces—Returns to his own dominions—Invades Cashmire—Again repulsed—Attacks and subdues the Punjab——Advances into Bundelcund, and lays siege to Callinger—Returns home—Invades Guzerat, and takes the celebrated Temple of Diu—His army suffer much distress on their return to Ghizne—Expedition against the Jats—Returns to Ghizne—Dies.

Subuctageen succeeded by his son, Mahmood Ghazy.

SULTAN MAHMOOD, the eldest son of Subuctageen, having made a vow, that, if he ever succeeded to the throne, he would wage continual war against the idolaters of India, towards the end of

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the year 391 of the Hejira, marched with 10,000 chosen horse from Ghizne; and, on the 8th of Mohurrem of the following year, engaged Raja Jypaal, with 12,000 horse, 30,000 infantry, and 300 war elephants, at Paishawur. TheMohammedans were again victorious, having slain 5000 of the Hindoos, and taken the Raja, with fifteen of his principal adherents, prisoners. The Sultan then advanced, and laid siege to Bathendeh, the capital of the captive prince, which place he quickly reduced. After this, he satiated his revenge upon some of the Afghans; who, neglecting their promise to his father, had taken part with the Hindoos.

A. D. 1001, Mahmood invades Hindoostan.

As it was the custom amongst the Hindoos, that whatever Raja was twice defeated, or taken prisoner, should be considered unworthy to reign, Jypaal, having resigned his kingdom to his son Annundpaal, devoted himself as a sacrifice to the prejudices of his countrymen, and burnt himself on a funeral pile.

In the year 395, the Sultan resolved to carry his arms against Raja Bajerao, whose territories were situated in the vicinity of Moultan. The Raja waited the attack in his capital, named Bhattea, which was well fortified, with an exceedingly high wall, and a very broad and deep ditch. For several days the Hindoos defended themselves with great vigour; but the Raja's courage failing him, he left a strong garrison in the place, and retired to the woods on the banks of the Sinde: here he was soon after surrounded by a detachment of the Mohammedan army, and, finding further resistance vain, fell upon his own sword. The city was soon after taken by assault, and an immense quantity of plunder fell into the hands of the captors; loaded with which, they returned in triumph to their own dominions.

A. D. 1004–5.

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SECT. I.

The Sultan having discovered that Daoud Khan, an Afghan heretic, who then possessed the province of Moultan, and whose predecessor had taken the oath of allegiance to Sultan Subuctageen, had, during the siege of Bhattea, sent assistance to Raja Bajerao, resolved to punish the traitor. He therefore, A. D. 1005–6. in the year 396, again advanced towards Hindoostan; and had proceeded as far as Paishawur, when he was opposed by an army of Hindoos, under the command of Annundpaal, the son of the late Raja. A severe conflict ensued, in which the Hindoos were again defeated, and their prince obliged to take refuge in Cashmire. The Sultan then advanced to the city of Moultan; and, after a siege of seven days, compelled Daoud Khan to pay a tribute of 20,000 *dirhems*, and to embrace the true faith*.

A. D. 1008–9, Mahmood invades Hindoostan a second time.

In the year 399, the Sultan again advanced towards Hindoostan; and Raja Annundpaal, having been reinforced by several other Hindoo princes, again opposed him in the plains of Paishawur. The contest had lasted for several days, when the elephant, on which Annundpaal rode, having taken fright, ran off to the rear. This circumstance induced the whole of the Hindoo army to take to flight. They were pursued by their adversaries for two days and two nights, and 20,000 of them fell by the sword. After this victory, the Sultan, whose mind was governed by bigotry and fanaticism, resolved to proceed to the sacred territory of Nagorkote, and to destroy all the temples of the idolaters in that district.

There was, at that time, in the vicinity of Nagorkote, a

* The Afghans were Mohammedans, but of a different sect from the Sultan.

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celebrated fort, called Bhimē, or Bheemnagur, in which the Hindoos had collected all the wealth consecrated to the idols of that and the neighbouring territories, for many centuries. Mahmood invested this place in the year 400, with such expedition, that the procrastinating Hindoos had not time to reinforce the garrison, which at that time was very weak, and therefore speedily compelled them to capitulate, stipulating only for their lives and liberty: thus the whole of the immense wealth contained in the fortress fell into the hands of the Sultan; with which he immediately returned to Ghizne, and displayed to his astonished subjects such riches as were never before possessed by any monarch. It was on this occasion that he obtained from the Khalif Kader Billah the title of Sultan. SECT. I. A.D. 1009-10.

In the year 401, the Sultan again invaded Moultan; and, having taken the city by assault, slew or mutilated a great number of the heretical Afghans, and led away their chief, Daoud Khan, with many of his followers, captives. A.D. 1010-11.

In the course of this year the Sultan was informed, that in the town of Thannasar, not far from Dehly, there was an image, named Jug Soom, which was held in the highest veneration by the Hindoos; and that crowds of people assembled there annually, from every part of India, to worship the idol. This intelligence having rekindled the zeal of the Sultan, he resolved to destroy this object of profane adoration, and in the year 402 marched from Ghizne; but as his route lay through the country of Raja Annundpaal, with whom he had concluded a treaty of peace, he sent an ambassador to that prince, to demand a free passage through his territory, assuring him that his troops should not commit the smallest injury on any of his subjects. The Raja endeavoured to persuade the A.D. 1011-12.

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SECT. I. Sultan to relinquish his undertaking, offering to pay him annually the amount of the revenues of Thannasar, and to send him immediately fifty elephants, and various other presents. His entreaties had no effect on the bigoted follower of Mohammed, who proceeded with such expedition, that he arrived at Thannasar before the Raja of Dehly could receive the assistance which he had solicited from the neighbouring princes. All the inferior images were, by the Sultan's orders, broken to pieces; but the venerated Jug Soom, after having the head destroyed, was sent to Ghizne, to form one of the steps of the public mosque, that the pious Mohammedans might have the pleasure of trampling on this object of idolatrous superstition. Religious zeal was not the only passion which the Mohammedans gratified by this expedition; their avarice was also satiated by the rich plunder of the temples.

After this transaction, the Sultan wished to advance to the conquest of Dehly; but his nobles having represented the danger of proceeding further, until he had completely subdued the countries of the Punjab and Moultan, he relinquished his intention, and returned to his own dominions, carrying with him 40,000 Hindoos, of both sexes, as slaves.

A.D. 1013-14. In the year 404, Sultan Mahmood again invaded the dominions of Pitteraou Jypaal, the son of Annundpaal, and took the fort of Nadoune (probably Nadone of our maps). The young prince, finding himself unable to contend with the invaders, fled to Cashmire, whither he was pursued by the Sultan; who, after having plundered that province, and forcibly converted a number of the inhabitants to his own religion, returned to Ghizne.

A.D. 1015-16. The year 406 was rendered remarkable by the Sultan's

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unsuccessful attack on Cashmire. He for many months laid siege to the strong fortress of Koh Kote; and was detained so long by this operation, that the winter set in with much violence, and a number of his troops perished in the retreat. This was the first failure this enterprising monarch had ever experienced. SECT. I.

In the spring of the year 409, Sultan Mahmood, having resolved upon an expedition against Cannouge, marched from Ghizne with an army, said to have consisted of 130,000 cavalry. He took the route of Cashmire; and, after a toilsome and arduous march of three months, issued from the mountains which form the northern boundary of the country lying between the rivers Jumna and Ganges, called by the natives the Dooab. His approach was quite unexpected by Korra, the Raja of Cannouge, whose capital was, at that time, equal in magnificence to any of the cities in India; and who, seeing no other remedy than submission, proceeded to the camp of the Sultan, and submitted himself and his country to the mercy of the conqueror. A.D. 1018-19.

The Sultan remained some days in Cannouge, while his detachments took the forts of Merat and Mabin; the one situated on the Cally Nuddy, the other on the banks of the Jumna.

From Cannouge the Sultan proceeded to Muttra, to this day a celebrated place of Hindoo worship. From the Brahmens he met with no opposition, but the plunder he obtained was immense: the images are said to have been all composed of gold or silver, and ornamented with precious stones. The Sultan continued in this country for some months, plundering the inhabitants, and destroying the towns; after which he

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SECT. I. returned to his own dominions, loaded with spoil, and encumbered with captives.

A.D. 1021-22. In the year 412, intelligence was brought to Ghizne, that the princes of India, disgusted with the Raja of Cannouge, for his unmanly submission to the Sultan, had invaded his territory, and put him to death. Mahmood, in consequence of this intelligence, collected a more powerful army than he had ever before mustered, and marched towards Hindoostan. On this occasion he took his route through the Punjab, by Lahore. The prince of that country, Pitteraou Jypaal, not finding himself able to prevent the passage of his invaders, retreated across the river Jumna: there he was reinforced by Nunda, Raja of Callinger (the capital of Bundelcund), and several other chiefs. The Sultan having arrived on the banks of the Jumna, found the allied Hindoo army drawn up, ready to oppose his crossing the river, which at that time was not fordable. He therefore encamped opposite to them, till he could form a better judgment of his own and of their situation; but, during the night, some of his troops, having swum across the river without orders, threw the Hindoos into such consternation, that they all took to flight.

The Sultan continued to pursue them for several days; but the fugitives, when they had nearly reached the confines of Callinger, again rallied, and drew up in order of battle. Their army is said to have consisted of 36,000 horse, 45,000 infantry, and a great number of war elephants; and so formidable was their appearance, that it caused very serious apprehensions to the Mussulmans; but the Sultan, having reconnoitred their position, resolved to delay the attack only till morning. In this, however, he was disappointed, as, during

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the night, the Hindoos abandoned their camp, and retreated in the greatest disorder. The Mohammedans pursued them for several days, and took a number of elephants, and a quantity of their baggage; but the Sultan, reflecting on the distance he was from home, and the state of the countries in his rear, thought it prudent to return towards Ghizne.

In the year 413, Sultan Mahmood again entered Cashmire, A.D. 1022-23. and laid siege to the strong fortress of Koh Kote; but having been a second time foiled, he proceeded to the Punjab, and for several months laid waste that country. Having at length, however, rendered himself master of the city of Lahore, he resolved to annex the Punjab to his own dominions, and commanded his troops to desist from further depredation. The Raja Pitterao Jypaal, unable to contend with his adversaries, retired to Ajmire for protection; and the Sultan, after appointing one of his Omrahs to the government of the Punjab, returned to his capital.

In the year 414, the Sultan, having resolved to subdue A.D. 1023-24. Nunda, the Raja of Callinger, marched from Ghizne with a numerous army. He took the route of Lahore; and, when he arrived at Gualier*, gave orders for his troops to invest that fortress; but on the chief's sending him a valuable present and several elephants, he continued his journey, and shortly after entered the province of Bundelcund.

The Raja, intimidated by the number and prowess of his enemies, retired to the fortress of Callinger †; the commanding situation and strong fortifications of which stopped the

* Twice taken by the English, but again ceded to the Mahrattas.

† Callinger has lately been taken by the English, but not till after having been repulsed in their first attack.

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SECT. I. further progress of the Mohammedan arms, and induced the Sultan, upon receiving a large sum of money and three hundred elephants, to return home.

A.D. 1024-25. In the year 415, the Sultan led his army, over sterile deserts, into the province of Guzerat; the capital* of which he took without opposition. He then proceeded to the Island of Diu, in which was situated the Temple of Som Naat, a celebrated idol, which had been the object of Hindoo worship from time immemorial.

The capture of this temple cost the Sultan the lives of many of his troops; but the immense wealth which he found therein amply repaid all his toils, and was equal in value to the whole of the plunder of his former expeditions.

The Sultan directed the venerated image of Som Naat, which was five yards in height, and contained incalculable wealth, to be broken to pieces, and its fragments to be sent to Mecca, Medina, Ghizne, and other Mohammedan cities, as a testimony of his zeal and power.

The troops having suffered much distress, during this journey, in their passage across the desert, the Sultan determined to return home by the way of Moultan; but even in this route his army experienced excessive hardships, both from the opposition of the inhabitants and scarcity of water and provisions, and with much difficulty returned to Ghizne, after an absence of nearly two years.

A.D. 1026. In the year 417, Mahmood resolved to wreak his vengeance on the Jats, a tribe of Hindoos who inhabited the banks of the lower part of the river Sinde. He therefore, early in the year, proceeded to Moultan, where he collected 1500 large

* Nehrwaleh.

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boats, each of which he armed with iron spikes, projecting over the bow and sides. Some of these boats were fitted up as fire-ships, and the remainder occupied by archers and spearmen.

The fleet launched from Moultan; and, soon after their arrival in the country of the Jats, were opposed by a fleet said to have consisted of 4000 boats of various sizes; but, as the fleet of the Ghizneans had the advantage of the current, the boats of the Jats were unable to withstand the shock; many of them were sunk, a number of them were burned, and the rest dispersed. After the victory, the Mohammedans landed; and, having set fire to the villages, brought away a great number of the women and children, with whom the Sultan returned in triumph to his capital.

Two years after this event, Sultan Mahmood died at Ghizne, on the 23d of the second Rubby (3d month), in the 419th year of the Hejira; and was buried in a magnificent tomb erected near the city, which to this day is resorted to by Mohammedan pilgrims from various parts of Asia, who consider him as having been a glorious champion of their religion, and therefore reverence his memory.

3d of April, A.D. 1028.

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MUSAOOD THE FIRST.

Musaood succeeds to the throne—Character of that Prince—He invades the Persian provinces of Kutch and Makeran—Invades Cashmire, and takes the celebrated fort of Sursutty—Invades Hindoostan, and captures the cities of Hansi and Sunput—Returns to Ghizne—Deposed and murdered by his own subjects.

SULTAN MAHMOOD was succeeded by his second son, Mo-
A. D. 1030. hammed, in the year 421; but as the events of that short and unstable reign are not connected with the affairs of India, it has not been thought requisite to insert it in this abridged history.

Musaood, at the period of his father's decease, was Governor of Hamadan in Persia; and upon his succeeding to the throne, for some time made Balkh the seat of his empire. He was a man of lofty spirit, and great personal strength; on which account he was honoured with the title of Rustem the Second. His arrow could pierce the strongest coat of mail, and pass through the body of an elephant; and his iron mace was so heavy, that no man of his time could raise it with one hand. He was, withal, of an obstinate and fierce disposition, contemptuous of authority, and disdaining all obedience. This circumstance, in his youth, engaged him in many

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quarrels, and greatly disobliged his father; who therefore wished to confer the kingdom on his second son, and, in consequence, detached Musaood to the most distant part of his empire, previous to his last illness. SECT. I.

In the year of the Hejira 422, he quitted Balkh, and repaired to Ghizne, where having settled his authority, he employed his armies in reducing the maritime provinces of Persia, Kutch and Makeran. A.D. 1031.

For two years, the attention of the Sultan was so much engaged by his Persian provinces, that he had little leisure to molest the Hindoos; but in the year 424, he led his army into Cashmire, and invested the fort of Sursutty, which commanded the passes. The garrison, being intimidated, sent messengers to the king, promising valuable presents, and an annual tribute, if he would desist from his enterprise. Musaood was inclined to listen to their proposals, when he received a petition from several Mohammedan merchants, who were captives in the fort, stating, that they had come into that country in the laudable and peaceable pursuit of commerce; that the governor of Sursutty had unjustly seized them, plundered them of all their goods, and kept them in severe confinement: they added, that the provisions in the fort being nearly expended, if his majesty would persevere in the siege a few days longer, it must surrender to his victorious arms. This intelligence at once roused the anger and ambition of the prince. He gave orders for the siege to be prosecuted with redoubled vigour. The ditch was in a few days filled with sugar-canes from the adjacent plantations; scaling ladders were applied to the walls; and the infuriate Musselmans entered the fort, and put the whole garrison to the sword. The king then ordered search A.D. 1033.

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SECT. I. to be made for the captive merchants; and having liberated them, bestowed on them the royal portion of the plunder. This act rendered him beloved by the Mohammedans, and dreaded by the Hindoos.

A.D. 1034. In the year 427, the Sultan entered the mountainous region of Sewalic, and invested the supposed impregnable fortress of Hansi, which he took by storm on the sixth day. In this place he found immense treasures, which he despatched to Ghizne. He then proceeded in person to Sunput, a celebrated place of Hindoo worship, situated only forty miles from Dehly: here, although he met with no opposition, he nevertheless consigned the idols and their temples to destruction. After thus evincing his intolerant zeal, he returned to Lahore; and having established his son Mujdood as governor of that province, he proceeded to Ghizne.

This was the last incursion of Sultan Musaood into Hin-
A.D. 1041. doostan; and in the year 433, he was deposed, and afterwards murdered, by his own subjects.

SULTAN MODOOD

Proclaimed King, at Balkh—Repairs to Ghizne—The Empire declines—The Raja of Dehly enters into a confederacy with the other Hindoo Princes—Takes the fort of Nagorkote—The Mohammedans nearly driven from Hindoostan—The Sultan dies—His Successors.

Sultan Modood, at the time of his father's decease, was at Balkh, where he was immediately proclaimed king. He soon afterwards proceeded to Ghizne; but for several years he was

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so much occupied by an invasion of the Siljokian Tartars, and by civil wars, that he had no leisure to pursue the conquests of his predecessors in India. SECT. I.

In the year 435, the Raja of Dehly, perceiving the declining state of the Ghiznian empire, resolved to make an effort to deliver his country from the hands of the oppressors. He therefore entered into an alliance with all the Hindoo princes of the Punjab, to attack the common enemy; and, that no means might be omitted to rouse their zeal and animate their spirits, he declared that he had seen in a vision the Deity whose idol had formerly been worshipped in the temple of Nagorkote; and who had informed him, that, having revenged himself on the Ghiznians, by the introduction of civil broils and discord amongst them, if he would advance with his army to Nagorkote, he should there find him returned to his temple, and prepared to assist his worshippers by his divine aid. The Mohammedans nearly driven out of Hindoostan, A.D. 1043.

This story, having been propagated by some Brahmens who were probably in the secret, was eagerly credited by a multitude of zealots: these having joined the army of the Raja, he proceeded at their head towards Nagorkote, having, during his route, recovered from the hands of the Mohammedans the cities of Thannasar, Hansi, and several other places. The fort of Nagorkote, being situated on the top of a mountain, and defended by a determined Mohammedan garrison, was not to be taken by assault: the Raja therefore closely invested it with his troops, and patiently waited the slow but certain effects of famine. At the end of four months, the garrison, finding no hopes of relief, capitulated. Previous to the surrender of the fort, the Raja had taken the precaution of causing an idol to be made of the same size and form of that which

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SECT. I. formerly occupied the temple; and having, during the night, conveyed it secretly into the place, it was displayed, soon after their admission into the fort, to the astonished multitude, as the identical image which had been broken to pieces by the Mohammedans. This story revived the fame of the idol throughout Hindoostan, and thousands of its votaries flocked to the victorious standard of the Raja. The princes of the Punjab, encouraged by these events, attacked the Mohammedans with bravery; and in a short time recovered possession of all the places to the east of the Indus, excepting the city of Lahore.

A.D. 1049. Modood died in the year 441. His successors were, Musaoud the Second, Aly, Rashid, and Ferrokhzad, whose short reigns afford nothing interesting with regard to India.

SULTAN IBRAHIM.

Sultan Ibrahim succeeded his brother Ferrokhzad, in the year
A.D. 1058. 450. He was a prince remarkable for his strict morality, and observance of religious duties. For twenty-two years his attention was much occupied by apprehensions from his western
A.D. 1079-80. neighbours; but in the year 472 he sent a powerful army to invade Hindoostan. He took and plundered the ancient city of Adjodin, situated on the skirts of the Great Desert: he also captured the celebrated fort of Rupal, and carried away 100,000 of the inhabitants of that vicinity into slavery.

In its consequences, the most important event of this reign was the appointment of a person named Sham Soury to the government of Ghor, as will hereafter be explained. Ibrahim enjoyed a long and prosperous reign, and quitted
A.D. 1098. this mortal life in the year 492.

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MUSAOUD THE THIRD.

MUSAOUD III. the son of Sultan Ibrahim, mounted the throne on the demise of his father. He revised the ancient laws and regulations of the state, and, abrogating such as were deemed unreasonable, substituted others in their place, founded upon better principles. He took Mehidi Irac, the daughter of Sinjir king of the Siljoky, in marriage; which connection cemented the peace between those princes.

During the reign of Musaoud, his General, named Toghan Sien, led an expedition into Hindoostan; and, having crossed the Ganges, carried the Mohammedan conquests farther than those of the celebrated Mahmood Ghazy.

The remainder of the reign of Musaoud was passed in peace; and he died at Ghizne in the year 509, after a reign of seventeen years. A.D. 1115.

ARSILLA.

WHEN Arsilla, the son of Musaoud, succeeded his father, the first act of his authority was, to seize, and strictly confine, all his brothers. This action gave universal disgust; and his uncle Bahram, fearing for his safety, fled to Sultan Sinjir, who, on the part of his brother Mohammed, king of Persia, then governed the province of Khorassan. Sinjir immediately espoused the cause of Bahram, and commenced preparations for the invasion of Ghizne.

Arsilla, being informed of this circumstance, sent his mother, who was the sister of Sinjir, with a present of 200,000 dinars, to negociate a peace for him; but that lady, disgusted with the tyranny of her son, and his cruelty to her other children, strongly urged her brother to hostility.

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SECT. I.

Sinjir, in consequence, marched from Bost, the capital of Khorassan, with a powerful army, and advanced without opposition to the vicinity of Ghizne; where he beheld the army of Arsilla, consisting of 30,000 horse, an innumerable body of infantry, and 160 war elephants, drawn out in order of battle, to receive him. The contest lasted great part of the day: at length, by the uncommon bravery of Abul Fazil, governor of Seistan, the troops of Ghizne were put to flight; and Arsilla, unable to renew the engagement, fled towards Hindoostan.

Sinjir entered Ghizne in triumph, where he remained forty days; and having placed Bahram on the throne of Ghizne, returned to his own government.

A.D. 1117. In the year 511, Arsilla made an attempt to recover his dominions, but was defeated, taken prisoner, and put to death.

BAHRAM SHAH.

Bahram Shah was possessed of great courage and dignity: he was also a great encourager of learning, and spent much of his time with the Literati, each of whom he rewarded according to merit. During his reign, a great number of books were written and dedicated to him, the most celebrated of which is the *Mukhzen al Asrar* (Treasury of Secrets), by the famous Shaikh Nizamy.

A. D. 1118. In the year 512 the Sultan marched to Lahore, which had been seized by Mohammed Bahlim, the general of the late monarch. An engagement took place in the vicinity of that city, in which Bahlim was defeated and made prisoner; but being a person of great plausibility, he not only persuaded the Sultan to release him, but to take him into his service, and to re-appoint him to the government of Lahore. In return for

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this clemency, Bahlim embraced the first opportunity of rebelling against his master. A second engagement ensued, in which the rebel was defeated, and, in his flight, fell into a quagmire with ten of his sons, and was never more heard of. The Sultan soon after seized the family, and all the wealth of the rebel, which he had deposited in Nagore, a celebrated fort in the mountains of Sewalic.

Some years after this event, a young man, named Mohammed Hussein, a prince of the royal family of Ghor, who was married to one of the daughters of the rebel, having excited the jealousy of the Sultan, was put to death; and this act proved, in its consequences, the ruin of the family of Ghizne. Sief Addeen Soury, the brother of the deceased, raised a great army to revenge his death. He marched directly to Ghizne, which Bahram evacuated, and, unable to oppose him, fled towards Hindoostan.

Sief Addeen, having taken possession of Ghizne, resolved to make that city the place of his residence; and being under no apprehension from Bahram, he permitted the greater part of his army to return, under the command of his brother, Alla Addeen, to Ghor. But the people of Ghizne, dissatisfied with the conduct of their new ruler, took advantage of a severe winter, during which the communication between Ghizne and Ghor was completely cut off, to invite Bahram to return; and, upon his approaching the city, they seized and delivered the Prince of Ghor into his hands.

The conduct of Bahram, on this occasion, was cruel, impolitic, and unmanly. The unfortunate captive was inhumanly ordered to have his face blackened, to be placed backwards on a bullock, and led in procession through the town, exposed to

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SECT. I. the insults and abuse of the mob. He was afterwards put to death, and his head sent to Sinjir king of Persia.

When intelligence of this event reached Ghor, the prince Alla Addeen burnt with rage: he advanced with a numerous army to Ghizne; and, having thrice defeated Bahram, invested that city, and delivered it to be plundered by his troops, and its inhabitants to be massacred, for seven days: he then set fire to it in many places, and carried his ravages so far as to destroy every monument of the Ghiznian kings, excepting the tombs of Mahmood, Musaood, and Ibrahim.

After his defeat, Bahram fled, with the scattered remains of his army, towards Lahore; but he was overwhelmed with his
A. D. 1152. misfortunes, and sunk under the hand of death in the year 547, after a reign of thirty-five years. He was, upon the whole, an amiable and virtuous prince; and had it not been for his impolitic and cruel conduct to the Prince of Ghor, he might have died with the character of a good man.

The author of the Tabkat Nassery states, that he reigned forty years, and that his death occurred at Ghizne in the
A. D. 1157. year 552 of the Hejira.

KHUSERO THE FIRST.

THE son of Bahram succeeded his father (according to the
A. D. 1159. Tabkat Nassery) in the year 552, and, abandoning the western provinces to the power of his enemies, made Lahore the capital
A. D. 1163. of his dominions. He died in that city in the year 559, after having reigned, with no great splendour, for seven years. He however deserved, and attained, the character of a good and peaceable prince.

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KHUSERO THE SECOND

ASCENDED the throne on the death of his father, and reigned thirteen years at Lahore, with the reputation of a benevolent and just prince. In the year 582, he was taken prisoner by the celebrated Mohammed Ghory, who sent him to Firoz Koh, where, in the year 587, he was assassinated; which event put an end to the Ghiznean dynasty, and transferred the sceptre of India to the House of Ghor. Khusero II. A.D. 1184. A.D. 1189.

SECT. II.

THE GHORIAN DYNASTY.

SULTAN MOHAMMED GHORY.

Origin of the Kings of Ghor—Sham appointed Governor of Ghor—succeeded by his sons, Mohammed Hussein, Sief Addeen Soury, and Alla Addeen—The succession devolves upon Ghyas Addeen, who appoints his brother Mohammed governor of Ghizne, and Generalissimo of his forces—Mohammed invades and subdues Moultan—Invades Paishawur—Advances to Lahore, and besieges Sultan Khusero in that city—Returns to Ghizne—Again invades Hindoostan—Defeated by the Hindoo Rajas of Ajmire and Dehly—Compelled to return to Ghizne—Being reinforced, returns, and gains a complete victory over the Hindoos—Proceeds towards Dehly—Appoints Cuttub Addeen governor of the conquered province, and returns to Ghizne—Again invades Hindoostan—Advances as far as Benaras, and destroys the temples and idols of that city—Returns home—Again enters Hindoostan, and takes the fort of Biana—Sultan Ghyas Addeen dies, and is succeeded by Mohammed, who is three years after assassinated by the tribe of Gickers.

THE genealogy of the kings of Ghor, according to the most authentic historians, might be traced through thirty-two Origin of the Kings of Ghor.

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SECT. II. generations, to the Khalifat of Aly the son-in-law of the Prophet, who converted one of their progenitors to the Mohammedan faith.

Sham Soury. It is sufficient for the present history to state, that one of the descendants of this illustrious family, named Sham Soury, having condescended to take upon himself the humble employment of a merchant, was, on his return from India, compelled by a gang of robbers to join their party. He was soon after taken prisoner, with his companions, by the troops of the Sultan Ibrahim, and condemned to death. When the executioner was about to perform his office, Sham protested his innocence with so much appearance of sincerity, that the officer, who superintended the punishment, petitioned the Sultan in his behalf. The Sultan ordered the business to be inquired into; and being convinced of the reality of his story, and much pleased with his eloquence and address, released him, and conferred on him the appointment of Master of Requests; in which station he acquitted himself with so much ability, that he rose gradually in rank and honours, and was at length appointed to the government of Ghor, the ancient patrimony of his ancestors. He soon after married a princess of the house of Ghizne, by whom he had seven sons, denominated the Seven Stars, and acquired such power as to become independent of his sovereign.

Sham was succeeded, in rotation, by his sons, Mohammed Hussein, Sief Addeen Soury, and Alla Addeen, who, as we have before related, having taken and burnt the city of Ghizne, was surnamed (Jehan Soze) the Incendiary.

Alla Addeen, after a short and turbulent reign, died in the A.D. 1156. year 551, leaving his government to his son Mohammed; who

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also died in the course of the year, and was succeeded by his cousin, Ghyas Addeen. SECT. II.

Ghyas Addeen appoints Mohammed Ghory Generalissimo, A.D. 1171.

Ghyas Addeen, being of an unwarlike disposition, appointed his brother, Mohammed Ghory, to be his General; and in the year 567 promoted him to the government of Ghizne, which, by a reverse of fortune, was now become a dependency upon that state to which it formerly sent governors.

A.D. 1176.

In the year 572, Mohammed, in obedience to his brother's commands, led an army into Moultan, and in a very short time subdued that province. Encouraged by this event, he, in the year 574, advanced through the Sandy Desert into Guzerat; but Raja Bim Deo, having collected a numerous army of Hindoos, compelled the Mohammedans, after suffering many hardships, to retire to their own territories.

A.D. 1178.

A.D. 1179.

The following year, 575, Mohammed, having recruited his army, invaded the district of Paishawur, bordering on Cashmire; and in a short time brought it under subjection.

A.D. 1180.

In 576, he advanced towards Lahore, where he invested Sultan Khusero, the last of the Ghiznean dynasty, whom he compelled to submit to such terms as were unworthy the conqueror and disgraceful to the conquered.

A.D. 1184.

In the year 580, Mohammed again invaded Lahore, and was again compelled to retreat; but, in order to secure the final conquest of that country, he built the strong fortress of Sal Kote, between the Ravy and Chunaub, two of the rivers which inclose part of the province called the Punjab.

A.D. 1186.

In the year 582, Mohammed once more invested the unfortunate Khusero in Lahore; and, by a mean stratagem, having made him his prisoner, put an end to the Ghiznean empire, as has before been related in the history of that dynasty.

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SECT. II.

When Mohammed had settled the province of Lahore, he left the government of that place in the hands of Aly, chief of Moultan, and returned to Ghizne.

A. D. 1191. In the year 587 he marched again towards Hindoostan; and, proceeding to Tiberhind, quickly succeeded in gaining possession of that city, which he garrisoned with a chosen detachment, under the command of Mullik Za, and returned towards Ghizne. When he had proceeded half way, he received information that Pittu Rai, prince of Ajmire, and Candu Rai, king of Dehly, having formed an alliance with several other Rajas, were advancing with an army consisting of 120,000 horse and 3000 elephants, towards his new conquest of Tiberhind.

Mohammed, not at all intimidated by this intelligence, immediately retraced his steps, and met the hostile squadrons on the banks of the Sursutty, fourteen miles from Thannasar, and eighty miles from Dehly.

Upon the first onset, the wings of the Mohammedan army, finding themselves outflanked by their opponents, retired, till, having joined in the rear, they formed a complete circle. The Hindoos, finding their adversaries so much inferior in numbers, advanced with great boldness; and Candu Rai, king of Dehly, having discovered Mohammed, advanced against him upon his war elephant. The Mussulman general, not less anxious to contend with his rival, spurred on his steed, and, by a blow from his lance, struck out one of his teeth; at the same time the king of Dehly severely wounded his opponent with an arrow. Mohammed was so much stunned by his wound, that with the utmost difficulty he could preserve his seat; which being observed by one of his faithful attendants, he imme-

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diately vaulted behind him, and bore him off from the field of battle. The Mussulmans seeing their general in this situation, immediately took to flight, and were pursued by their enemies for forty miles. SECT. II.

Upon the retreat of Mohammed, the allied Rajas continued their march to Tiberhind, which they besieged for sixteen months, and were at length obliged to grant a most honourable capitulation to the garrison.

After this unexpected defeat, Mohammed retired to Ghizne, whence he proceeded to Ghor, the capital of his brother; from whom he received such an addition to his forces, as rendered his army one of the most formidable that had ever entered Hindoostan.

His force is said to have consisted of 120,000 horse in complete armour, and a vast number of irregular cavalry. With these he marched, in martial array, first to Ghizne, and thence towards India. Upon his arrival at Lahore, he despatched a nobleman, named Humza, with an ostentatious declaration of war against the Hindoo princes. These, having been prepared for the event, advanced with an army consisting of 300,000 horse, 3000 elephants, and an immense host of infantry. The two armies encamped in sight of each other, on the former field of battle, being only separated by the river Sursutty.

As it is a political maxim of the Hindoos never to use force when any business can be accomplished by stratagem or deceit, they endeavoured to enter into an accommodation with Mohammed; who, meeting them in their own way, declared his readiness to enter into a truce with them.

This answer produced the intended effect, and lulled the

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SECT. II. Hindoos into security. But, during the night, Mohammed forded the river, and attacked his enemies before they were aware of their danger.

Notwithstanding the confusion which naturally occurred on this occasion amongst the Hindoos, their camp was of such an extent, that the greater part of their army had time to form in order of battle, and advanced with considerable regularity, in four lines.

Seeing this formidable array, Mohammed pretended to retreat; by which manœuvre, having induced the Hindoos to break their line, he wheeled round on them with his most select squadrons, and in a short time carried terror and defeat through all their ranks.

Candu Rai, king of Dehly, and many other princes, were slain on the field of battle. Pittu Rai, Raja of Ajmire, was taken prisoner, and afterwards put to death. The spoil of the camp, which was immensely rich, fell into the hands of the conquerors; and the forts of Sursutty, Samana, Khoram, and Hansi, surrendered after the victory.

Mohammed proceeded in person, and took possession of Ajmire, having barbarously put many thousands of the unfortunate inhabitants to the sword, reserving the rest for slavery; but upon the promise of a large tribute from Gola the son of Pittu Rai, he made over the country to him, and released his captives.

He then turned his victorous standards towards Dehly, with the intention of plundering that city; but was prevailed on by the son of the late Raja, at the expense of a great sum of money and valuable presents, to abandon his design.

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SECT. II.

Mohammed then left his faithful slave and general, Cuttub, in the fort of Khoram, with a considerable army, and marched himself with the main body towards the mountains of Sewalic, which form the northern boundary of that part of Hindoostan, plundering and ravaging all the countries in his way to Ghizne.

After the return of Mohammed, his general Cuttub, who afterwards became highly distinguished in the annals of India, advanced, in the year 589, from Khoram, and took from the A.D. 1192. son of Candu Rai the imperial city of Dehly. He thence proceeded to Merat, which he captured in a short time; and having subdued the fortress of Kole, (now called Ally Ghur,) between the rivers Jumna and Ganges, took up his residence for some time in that place.

In the year 591, Mohammed Ghory again advanced into A.D. 1194. Hindoostan, but met with no opposition till he had reached Etaya on the banks of the Jumna, where he was encountered by Rai Joy, prince of Cannouge. The Hindoos were however defeated by the vanguard under Cuttub, and much plunder was seized by the conquerors. After this skirmish, the Mohammedans advanced and took the fort of Assy, in which they found immense treasures. Thence they proceeded to Benaras, which they easily captured; and either wantonly or zealously broke down and destroyed all the idols and temples of that celebrated seat of Hindoo learning. Mohammed then returned to Kole, where he again confirmed Cuttub as his Viceroy in India; and hence, laden with treasure, he took the route of Ghizne.

Scarcely had Mohammed crossed the Indus, when one of the relations of Pittu Rai, late king of Ajmire, whose name

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SECT. II.

was Himraje, rebelled against Gola, the son of his prince, and compelled him to take refuge with Cuttub, the Mohammedan general. The latter immediately advanced with a considerable army to Ajmire, where he quickly re-established Gola in his authority.

The same year, Cuttub invaded the province of Guzerat, and, having vanquished Raja Bim Deo, took ample revenge for the defeat the Mohammedan arms had sustained in the year 574. After plundering that rich country, he returned in triumph to Dehly.

A.D. 1202.

In the year 599, Mohammed, for the last time, entered into Hindoostan; but after taking the fort of Biana, he was obliged to return in haste towards Ghizne; where, upon his arrival, he received intelligence of the death of his brother, Sultan Ghyas Addeen, in whose name he had hitherto acted. In recompence for this forbearance, so uncommon amongst Mohammedans, he had the pleasure of acquiring the sovereignty of Ghor, and all its dependencies, with a clear conscience.

Mohammed succeeds Ghyas Addeen in the sovereignty of Ghor.

From this period, Mohammed interfered little with the politics of India, leaving the arrangement of that country to his trust-worthy viceroy, Cuttub.

A.D. 1206.

Mohammed was assassinated in the year 602, by the tribe of Gickers, after a reign of thirty-two years from the commencement of his government over Ghizne, and three from his accession to the empire, the titles and honours of which, as before mentioned, he permitted his elder brother to enjoy during his life-time. He was esteemed one of the greatest men that ever sat on the throne of India; and though he was in some instances cruel, he possessed many virtues.

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CUTTUB ADDEEN ABIEK.

Origin of Cuttub—Purchased by Sultan Mohammed Ghory—Promoted by degrees to the rank of Master of the Horse—Taken prisoner by the King of Khuarizm—Retaken—Appointed Governor of the conquered Provinces—Captures the City of Merat—Takes Dehly—His Expedition against the Jats—Crosses the river Jumna, and takes the fort of Kole—Defeats the Raja of Benaras—Sultan Mohammed adopts Cuttub as his son—Cuttub succeeds to the Throne of Hindoostan—Dies.

WHEN Mohammed Ghory had departed this life, his nephew Mahmood assumed the imperial titles at Ghor; but sensible of his own want of power, he thought it more prudent to conciliate the friendship of Cuttub, the viceroy of Hindoostan, although originally a slave of his uncle's, than, by asserting his claim to those dominions, to raise up a dangerous rival to his authority. He therefore sent to Cuttub all the ensigns of royalty; viz. a throne, an umbrella, standards, drums, and the title of Sultan. A. D. 1205.

Cuttub received these honours with proper respect; and mounted the throne at Lahore, on the 2d of Zykāad of the year 602. June, A. D. 1206.

As this person makes so conspicuous a figure in the annals of Hindoostan, his history cannot fail of being interesting, although fully detailed in another work.

Cuttub was a native of Toorkestan, and in his childhood purchased by a merchant, who brought him to Nishapore, and sold him to Cazy Fakher Addeen, a learned judge, and a Origin of Cuttub Addeen.

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SECT. II.

person of very ancient family, who sent him to school with his own sons. The youth evinced uncommon abilities, and in a few years made great progress in his learning, and in acquiring all the polite accomplishments of the age. Upon the death of the judge, his heirs sold Cuttub, for a large sum of money, to a merchant; by whom he was carried to Ghizne, and presented to Sultan Mohammed Ghory, who amply rewarded the merchant for his present.

In a short time, Cuttub became a great favourite of the Sultan, who, in consequence of his having lost a finger, gave him the nick-name of Abiek. One evening, the Sultan, having made considerable presents to his attendants and slaves, gave to Cuttub a larger sum than to any other of the boys; but as soon as the company broke up, Cuttub distributed his present among the inferior servants of the palace, saying, that as the Sultan's favour supplied all his wants, he had no use for money. This conduct being reported to the Sultan, he was much pleased, and promoted Cuttub to stand at the side of his throne; and by degrees raised him to the confidential office of Master of the Horse.

In one of the expeditions of Mohammed Ghory against the king of Khuarizm, Cuttub, being detached with a party of horse to procure forage, was, after exhibiting many proofs of valour, taken prisoner, and carried before the Khuarizm monarch, who ordered him to be secured with iron chains. A day or two after, a general engagement took place between the two armies, in which the Khuarizmians, being defeated, fled, and left their prisoner seated on a camel, fast bound with chains. In this situation he was retaken by some of his friends, and sent to the Sultan, who, on seeing him, was much

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affected, and, as a mark of the highest honour and regard, bestowed on him one of his own dresses. SECT. II.

When, in the year 588, Mohammed Ghory had taken his revenge of the princes of Ajmire and Dehly, by the total defeat of their armies on the banks of the river Sursutty, he appointed Cuttub commander-in-chief of his forces in Hindoostan, with orders to prosecute his conquests in that country. Cuttub made Commander-in-chief, A. D. 1192.

As soon as the Sultan returned to Ghizne, Cuttub commenced his operations, by the capture of Merat, a celebrated fortress in the Dooab; after which he proceeded to Dehly, and laid siege to that city. He was there opposed by a powerful army of Rajepoots; but, after a bloody contest, the Hindoos were defeated, and compelled to retire within their walls. Cuttub continued to press the siege, and in a short time compelled the garrison to capitulate; by which he became master of the imperial city, which has ever since been considered as the capital of Hindoostan, although sometimes forsaken by its emperors. He besieges and takes Dehly.

In the month of Ramzan, of the year 589, the tribe of Jats who were subject to the Raja of Neherwala, in Guzerat, laid siege to the fort Hansy; but the governor defending himself with great bravery, gave time for Cuttub to march to his assistance. Upon the arrival of the Mohammedan army, the Jats hastily retreated, and were pursued to the confines of their own country. A.D. 1193.

The following year, Cuttub crossed the river Jumna, and took the celebrated fort of Kole (Alyghur), in which he found 1000 horses and much plunder. In this place he continued to reside for some time.

In the year 591, Cuttub proceeded from Dehly, to meet his A.D. 1194.

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SECT. II.

master, who was advancing from Ghizne, with an intention of subduing the countries of Cannouge and Benaras. When they met, Cuttub presented the Sultan with a hundred Arabian horses, an elephant made of gold, and another of silver; and caused his army, consisting of 50,000 horse, to pass in review before him.

The Sultan was much pleased with Cuttub's conduct, and, having conferred on him a dress of honour, appointed him to command the first division of the army.

With this division, which consisted of his own troops, he totally defeated Jychund the Raja of Benaras, who fell in the heat of the battle. The number of slain was so great, that for a long time the body of the prince could not be found, but was at length recognised by his artificial teeth, which were fixed with wedges of gold.

After this victory the Sultan proceeded to the city of Benaras, and demolished nearly one thousand Hindoo temples. He then laid waste the country to the boundaries of Bengal; and after securing all the elephants, treasure, and property belonging to the Raja, (great part of which was found in the fort of Assy,) he returned towards Ghizne, leaving Cuttub as Viceroy of Hindoostan.

Sultan Mohammed adopts Cuttub as his son.

After some days' march, the Sultan sent Cuttub a letter, declaring him his adopted son; and at the same time, as a proof of his special favour, sent him a white elephant, one of those taken from the prince of Benaras. This animal, of so uncommon a colour in Hindoostan, was rode constantly by Cuttub, and died three days after the decease of his master.

Cuttub succeeds Mohammed Ghory, A. D. 1205.

Upon the death of Mohammed Ghory, in the year 602, Cuttub succeeded to the uncontrolled possession of the Indian provinces; and having established Delhy as the capital

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of his dominions, he may be considered as the first Mohammedan king of Hindoostan.

Cuttub died at Lahore, in the year 607. His reign, properly speaking, was little more than four years, though he enjoyed all the state and dignity of the sovereign for more than twenty. A.D. 1210.

As it was during the reign of Cuttub Addeen Abiek that Bengal became subject to the Mohammedan arms, we now turn to the affairs of that province.

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SECT. III.

Of the early Mohammedan Conquerors of Bengal.

MOHAMMED BUKHTYAR KHULIJY.

Origin of Bukhtyar Khulijy—His arrival at Dehly—Unsuccessful application to be admitted into the Imperial service—He obtains employment from one of the provincial Governors—Raises a regiment of his own Clan—Noticed by the Viceroy—Appointed to the command of an army destined to invade the province of Behar—Conquers that country—Returns to Dehly—Re-appointed Governor of Behar—History of Luchmunyah, the last Raja of Bengal—Bukhtyar invades Bengal—Selects the ancient City of Gour as the Capital of the two Provinces—Attempts the Conquest of Thibet—Compelled to retreat—Returns to Bengal—Dies.

SECT. III. Origin of Bukhtyar Khulijy.

THE first Chief who exalted the banners of Mohammed in the fertile plains of Bengal, was Mohammed Bukhtyar Khulijy. This person was an inhabitant of Ghor, a city in the district of Gurmseir, on the northern boundary of Afghanistan, and of the tribe of Khulijy*. Nature had not been favourable to Bukhtyar in his formation: he was ill-favoured,

* Throughout Dow's History of Hindoostan this name is softened into *Cheligi*, which renders it unintelligible to a native of the East.

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and of a mean appearance; and, amongst other deformities of his person, it is stated, that when he stood upright the ends of his fingers extended considerably below his knees. When arrived at the age of manhood, he repaired to Ghizne, and offered himself as a volunteer to the officers of Mohammed Ghory; but they, disgusted with his appearance, refused to enrol him amongst their levies. Disappointed in his hopes, he proceeded to Dehly, and, on his arrival in that city, made a tender of his services to the officers of Cuttub Addeen the Viceroy; but the inspector of recruits again rejected him. Finding it impossible to obtain employment in the imperial service, he enlisted as a cavalier with Oughul Beg, one of the provincial governors: in this situation, his activity, courage, and abilities, soon recommended him to the notice of his superiors, and he quickly obtained promotion. SECT. III.

When Mohammed Bukhtyar had acquired some celebrity in his new situation, he invited several parties of his own tribe, who were in want of employment, to accept him as their commander, and had the good fortune shortly after to be admitted, with his regiment, into the service of the Viceroy. Having signalized himself on many arduous occasions, he was at length (about the year 596) appointed to the command of an army destined to the conquest of Behar. A. D. 1199.

In this undertaking he was again successful; for after ravaging and plundering all the country, and sacking the capital†, he returned, at the end of two years, loaded with

† Mr. Wilford states, in the 9th volume of the Asiatic Researches, that the kings of Behar, or Magadha, were for many ages the sovereigns or lords-paramount of India. If

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SECT. III.

plunder; the whole of which he laid at the feet of the Viceroy, who was so much pleased with his conduct, that he conferred on him such honours as excited the envy of all his contemporaries.

The mode which the courtiers devised to get rid of an envied favourite, would be incredible in a civilized nation: but, as the circumstance occurred in an assemblage of illiterate soldiers, who considered courage as the chief virtue, we cannot refuse to give credit to the following extraordinary anecdote, which is corroborated by several historians. On a public occasion, when the whole court of the Viceroy were assembled, some of the nobles took an opportunity of introducing the subject of the late conquest of Behar, and of extolling the feats of bravery performed by the General: they added, that such was their high opinion of his courage, they were assured he would, single-handed, contend with and overcome a fierce elephant: this being contradicted by some other person in the secret, the question was at length submitted to the Viceroy, and by him proposed to Mohammed Bukhtyar, who, dreading the imputation of cowardice more than death, foolishly agreed to try the contest.

One of those elephants which are kept for fighting by the princes of the East, and which was then in a state of intoxication, was shortly introduced into the area in front

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such was the case, their descendants must have degenerated exceedingly; for at the period of the Mohammedan invasion, the Raja, instead of heading his army in defence of his country and religion, shamefully absconded, leaving his capital, then a celebrated seat of Hindoo learning (whence its name of *Behar*), so destitute, that it was taken by a detachment of two hundred men, who put a number of the unopposing Brahmans to the sword, and plundered all the inhabitants.

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of the palace; and Mohammed, without making any other preparation than merely throwing off his coat and girding up his loins, advanced with a battle-axe in his hand. SECT. III.

The elephant, which had been accustomed to contend in that place, either with one of its own species or some more ferocious animal, took little notice of its puny foe, till, urged on by its driver, it made a charge at Bukhtyar, who dexterously avoided, and, at the same moment, struck the elephant with his battle-axe with such force on the trunk, that the animal screamed out and ran off. Shouts of wonder and acclamation resounded through the palace; and the Viceroy not only presented the General with a large sum of money himself, but ordered all the nobles to present him with an OFFERING of congratulation. The sum collected on this occasion was of considerable value; but the General, scorning to be thus enriched, added a sum of his own, and made a donation of the whole to the inferior servants of the court.

Shortly after this transaction, Mohammed was, in the year of the Hejira 599, re-appointed Governor of Behar, with orders to extend his conquests over all the neighbouring territories. A.D. 1202.

The remainder of the year 599 was occupied by Bukhtyar Khulijy in firmly establishing his authority over the province of Behar, and making such inquiries into the state of Bengal as might facilitate the conquest of that country. A.D. 1202-3.

Bengal was at that period ruled by a Hindoo prince, named Luchmunyah, who resided at Nuddeah, still a celebrated seat of Hindoo learning, and whose history has History of Luchmunyah, the last Raja of Bengal.

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SECT. III. been thus succinctly narrated by nearly a contemporary historian*.

On the death of Luchmun the father of Luchmunyah, this prince was still unborn; but as his mother, who was of the royal family of the Sovereigns of India, was far advanced in her pregnancy, the nobles seated her on the throne, and made their obeisance. When the princess felt the pains of labour approaching, she assembled the astrologers and Brahmans, and consulted them on the probable destiny of her child.

The astrologers, having attentively considered the position of the heavens, declared, that if the child should be born before a particular hour, his destiny would be replete with misery; but if after the time specified, he should enjoy a very long reign.

The intrepid lady immediately gave positive orders to her attendants, that, without paying any attention to her feelings, or regard to her safety, they should use every endeavour to postpone her delivery. The measures they adopted were rude and cruel; and although their efforts were attended with success, it was at the expence of the life of the mother†.

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* Abu Omar Menhajaddeen Giorjany, whose history, the *Tabkat Nassery*, was published in the year of the Hejira 658, corresponding with A.D. 1260, only fifty-eight years after the conquest of Bengal. The author had conversed with many persons who assisted in the conquest of that country; and he himself passed several months at the capital of Bengal.

† This circumstance will not be thought improbable by those who are acquainted with the little value the Hindoos set on the life of a woman, and the importance of the birth of a son. In proof of the first, see *Asiatic Researches*, vol. IV. chap. 22.; and of the latter, see Note 6, to Wilkins's Translation of the *Bhagvat Geeta*.

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SECT. III.

As soon as the child was born, he was laid on the throne, and the commencement of his reign dated from that instant. This prince nominally ruled Bengal for eighty years, and was distinguished for his clemency, generosity, and justice.

A.D. 1202-3.

In the 599th year of the Hejira, the Mohammedans having conquered the province of Behar, and extended their ravages to the borders of Bengal, the Brahmans and astrologers waited on the Raja, and represented that their ancient books contained a prophecy that the kingdom of Bengal should be subdued by the Toorks; that they were convinced the appointed time was now arrived; and advised him to remove his wealth, family, and seat of government (then at Nuddeah), to a more secure and distant part of the country, where they might be safe from any sudden incursion of their enemies.

The Raja, on hearing this representation, asked the Brahmans if their books gave any description of the person who was to be the conqueror of his dominions. They replied in the affirmative, and that the description exactly corresponded with the person of the Mohammedan General, then in Behar.

The Raja, being far advanced in years, and partial to his capital, would not listen to their advice, and took no measures to avoid the danger. But the nobles and principal inhabitants sent away their property and families, either to the province of Jagernaut, situated on the sea side, or to the countries on the north-east bank of the Ganges.

Bukhtyar invades Bengal, A.D. 1203-4.

In the year 600, Mohammed Bukhtyar Khulijy, having acquired sufficient information of the unguarded state of Bengal, secretly assembled his troops; and marching from Behar, proceeded with such expedition towards Nuddeah, that his approach was not even suspected.

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On his arrival in the vicinity of the city, he concealed his troops in a wood, and, accompanied by only seventeen horsemen, entered the city. On passing the guards, he informed them, that he was an envoy, going to pay his respects to their master.

He was thus permitted to approach the palace; and having passed the gates, he and his party drew their swords, and commenced a slaughter of the royal attendants.

The Raja, Luchmunyah, who was then seated at dinner, alarmed by the cries of his people, made his escape from the palace by a private door, and, getting on board a small boat, rowed with the utmost expedition down the river.

The remainder of the Mohammedan troops now advanced, and, having slaughtered a number of the Hindoos, took possession of the city and palace. Soon as this intelligence was conveyed to the Raja, he became overwhelmed with affliction; and resolving to dedicate the remainder of his life to religion, he continued his journey to Jagernaut, and had the consolation of dying soon after in the vicinity of the sacred temple.

Bukhtyar selects Gour as his Capital.

After the flight of the Raja, Bukhtyar gave up the city to be plundered by his troops, reserving for himself only the elephants and public stores. He then proceeded, without opposition, to Lucknowty, and established the ancient city of Gour* as the capital of his dominions. As a necessary part

* The following extract from Major Rennell's Memoir of a Map of Hindoostan, gives the best modern account of the city of Gour that is to be found in print:

"Gour, called also Lucknouti, the ancient capital of Bengal, and supposed to be the *Gangia regia* of Ptolemy, stood on the left bank of the Ganges, about twenty-five miles below Rajemal. It was the capital of Bengal 730 years before Christ, and was repaired and beautified by Homayoon, who gave it the name of Jennuteabad; which name a part of the circar, in which it was situated, still bears. According to Ferishta's account, the

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of this ceremony, he destroyed a number of Hindoo temples, and with their materials erected mosques, colleges, and caravanseries, on their ruins †.

Although elated by success, and absolute master of an extensive dominion, he did not assume to himself independence, but continued to stamp the coin with the name of the Sultan of Ghor; and sent a great portion of the elephants and treasure to Cuttub Addeen, the Viceroy, at Dehly.

In the course of a year, Mohammed Bukhtyar, having completely subdued Bengal, and stationed garrisons in all the strong

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unwholesomeness of its air occasioned it to be deserted soon after; and the seat of government was removed to Tanda, or Tanrah, a few miles higher up the river.

"No part of the site of ancient Gour is nearer to the present bank of the Ganges than four miles and a half; and some parts of it, which were originally washed by that river, are now twelve miles from it. However, a small stream, that communicates with the Ganges, now runs by its west side, and is navigable during the rainy season. On the east side, and in some places within two miles, it has the Mahanada river; which is always navigable, and communicates also with the Ganges.

"Taking the extent of the ruins of Gour at the most reasonable calculation, it is not less than fifteen miles in length (extending along the old bank of the Ganges), and from two to three in breadth. Several villages stand on part of its site: the remainder is either covered with thick forests, the habitations of tigers and other beasts of prey; or become arable land, whose soil is chiefly composed of brick-dust. The principal ruins are, a mosque lined with black marble, elaborately wrought; and two gates of the citadel, which are strikingly grand and lofty. These fabricks, and some few others, appear to owe their duration to the nature of their materials, which are less marketable, and more difficult to separate, than those of the ordinary brick buildings; which have been, and continue to be, an article of merchandize; and are transported to Moorshedabad, Mauldah, and other places, for the purpose of building. These bricks are of the most solid texture of any I ever saw; and have preserved the sharpness of their edges, and smoothness of their surfaces, through a series of ages. The situation of Gour was highly convenient for the capital of Bengal and Bahar, as united under one government; being nearly centrical with respect to the populous parts of those provinces; and near the junction of the principal rivers that compose that extraordinary inland navigation, for which those provinces are famed: and, moreover, secured by the Ganges and other rivers, on the only quarter from which Bengal has any cause for apprehension."

† In consequence of this conduct, which was imitated by his successors, many Hindoo Figures and Inscriptions are to be found in the ruins of these Mosques.

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SECT. III.

Bukhtyar attempts the Conquest of Thibet.

places, was seized with the mad ambition of adding the bleak mountains of Bootan and Thibet to his dominions. He therefore appointed Mohammed Sherān Khulijy, his principal officer, to be his deputy during his absence; and proceeded, with a select detachment of 10,000 horse, towards the ridge of mountains which separates India from Tartary and China.

These mountains were inhabited by three distinct tribes, called Koonch, Mikeh, and Neharu. These people have all Tartar countenances, and speak a language between Hindy and Thibetian.

Mohammed Bukhtyar had the merit of converting one of the Chiefs of the tribe of Koonch to the Mussulman faith, to whom he gave the name of Aly Miekh. This person undertook to be his guide and director on this expedition. He first led the army to a city named Burdehun, or Murdehun, under the walls of which ran a very large river, called Bungmutty, three times as broad as the Ganges. This river falls into the Indian Sea, which is called, in the Hindy language, Sumundur. For ten days they proceeded upward, along the banks of this river; till they entered the narrow defiles of the mountains, and came to a stone bridge consisting of twenty-two arches, over which the army crossed.

As the possession of this bridge was of the utmost consequence, to secure a safe retreat, Mohámmed Bukhtyar took the precaution of leaving a strong party to guard it, under the command of two officers; one of whom was of his own tribe, but the other a Toork.

When the Raja of Kamroop was informed that the army had crossed the bridge, he sent an envoy to Mohammed Bukhtyar, to solicit his friendship; and offering, if he would

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postpone the expedition for another year, he would, at the expiration of that period, join him with all his forces, and lead him, by an easy route, into Thibet. SECT. III.

Mohammed, being either anxious to finish his undertaking, or giving little credit to the promises of the Raja, declined his offer; and proceeded for fifteen days through narrow valleys and over lofty mountains, till at length the army entered an extensive plain of Thibet, well cultivated and inhabited. They shortly after came to a well-fortified town, the inhabitants of which opposed them courageously, and killed a number of the Mussulmans *.

The armour of these people was entirely composed of bamboos, sewed or tied together with raw silk. With such materials they very ingeniously formed not only shields, breast-plates, and cuishes, but even helmets. Their offensive weapons were long spears, and large bows and arrows.

After a hard day's contest, the Mussulman forces were obliged to retire to their camp, without any other fruit of victory than a few prisoners; from whom they learned, that, at the distance of fifteen miles, there was a very large and strongly fortified city, called Kurmputtun, which was inhabited by Brahmans and Bootaneers; that their prince was a Christian, but that he had in his service an innumerable army of brave Tartars well versed in the use of the bow and spear; that a thousand or fifteen hundred horses were daily sold in its market; and that the species of horse, called Tanyan, or Tangan, well known in Bengal, was brought from thence;—that,

* Menhajaddeen, the author of the *Tabkat Nassery*, asserts, that, in the year 642 of the Hejira, he visited, at Deocote in Bengal, Muatmid Addowleh, one of the officers who attended Bukhtyar on this expedition; and that he learned the facts from him.

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SECT. III. on the first appearance of the Mussulmans, an express had been sent off to the city; and that, without doubt, a powerful force would arrive from thence early next morning.

This intelligence very much alarmed Mohammed Bukhtyar, whose army was considerably reduced by fatigue and battle. He therefore called a council of war, in which it was resolved that they should immediately retire, and return at a more favourable opportunity, with a greater force.

Two hours before day, the Mussulmans silently commenced their retreat; but as soon as the inhabitants of the country were aware of their intentions, they set fire to all the forage and grain which was on their route, and threw various obstacles in their way. At length, after suffering the greatest hardships, the Mussulmans arrived, on the fifteenth day, at the banks of the river which they had crossed: but how great was the disappointment of Mohammed Bukhtyar, to find that the officers, to whom he had entrusted the defence of the bridge, having quarrelled with each other, had abandoned their post; and that the insidious Raja of Kamroop*, now taking advantage of the distresses of the Mussulmans, had combined with the enemies to cut off his retreat, and had, in consequence, broken down two of the arches of the bridge.

In this dilemma, Mohammed ordered his troops to take possession of a large Hindoo temple, which was in the

* The boundaries of Kamroop are very indefinitely described. The name is applied by Mohammedan writers to all the countries between Bengal and Thibet, from the river Gunduck on the west, to the Burhampooter on the east. The crossing of so large a river determines the country invaded to have been South Assam, although the account of the Tanyan horses might lead us to suppose it was Bootan. From Doctor Wade we learn that Kamroop was formerly a very extensive kingdom; and that its capital was the present town of Rangamutty, in the N.E. corner of Bengal.—*See Asiatic Annual Register*, 1805.

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vicinity, and which contained many massy idols of gold and silver; whilst a party were employed in cutting down wood and bamboos, to form rafts for crossing the river. During this time, the Raja of Kamroop, having collected a large army, surrounded the Mussulmans; but knowing that his troops could not withstand the close attack of their invaders, he ordered them to construct a line of circumvallation, composed of stakes interwoven with bamboos, at a considerable distance round the temple, and thus to starve their enemies to death.

When the Mussulmans saw this wall rising on all sides of them, they called out to their Commander: "If we remain longer here, we shall all be caught in the net of these infidels." So saying, they made a sudden charge upon the Hindoos, and cut their way through the unfinished stockade: they then retreated to the banks of the river, and each man employed himself in devising some means of getting over, whilst the Hindoos annoyed them from a distance with their arrows.

Bukhtyar's army destroyed, and he escapes with great difficulty.

One of the troopers having ridden some way up the banks of the river, discovered a place which for a short distance was fordable. The army seeing this, and supposing that the ford extended across the river, impetuously rushed after him; nor did they discover their mistake till too late. The majority of them were carried away by the rapidity of the current, and found a watery grave; whilst the General, and a small number of the best-mounted soldiers, with much difficulty reached the opposite side.

When Mohammed Bukhtyar had reached Koonch (probably Cooch Beyhar) he was hospitably received by the inhabitants, and especially the relations of Aly Miekh, who endeavoured

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SECT. III. to alleviate his wants, and to mitigate his sorrows; but melancholy and disappointment overwhelmed him; and a few days after his arrival at Deocote in Bengal, he sunk under the pressure of his calamities, amidst the execrations and curses of the orphans and widows of the soldiers who had fallen a sacrifice to his insatiable ambition. His remains were carried to Behar, and there buried. These events happened in the year
A.D. 1205-6. of the Hejira 602.

Aly Murdan Khulijy, governor of Barsool, who will hereafter be noticed in this history, was suspected of having shortened the days of Mohammed Bukhtyar, by stabbing him while he lay in a state of stupefaction; but as there does not appear to have been sufficient inducement for so foul a deed, the story may, with probability, be imputed to the machinations of his rivals, or to the sanguinary character which he afterwards evinced.

MOHAMMED SHERAN AZA ADDEEN.

Origin of Mohammed Sherān—Promoted by Mohammed Bukhtyar to the command of his Army—Elected Governor of Lucknowty (Gour) after the death of Bukhtyar, under the title of Aza Addeen—Excites the jealousy of the Emperor, who sends an army against him—Defeated, and killed in a quarrel of the Khulijy Chiefs.

MOHAMMED SHERAN was a person of good family, of the tribe of Khulijy, and had given many proofs of activity and valour. It is related, that, after the Mussulman forces had taken possession of the city of Nuddeah, and the troops were

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occupied in collecting the spoil from all the neighbouring villages, Mohammed Sherān was for three days absent, without any person knowing what was become of him. As Mohammed Bukhtyar esteemed him one of his best officers, he much regretted his loss, and sent a number of people to search for his body. Some of these, entering a wood, discovered Mohammed Sherān, mounted on horseback, with his spear in his hand, driving before him a body of thirty war-elephants belonging to the Raja, the drivers of whom were endeavouring to carry them off, but had been compelled by this indefatigable officer to return towards the city. This act of bravery raised him high in the opinion of Mohammed Bukhtyar: he promoted him to the command of his army; and, when he set out on his unfortunate expedition, he left Sherān at Lucknowty, as his Deputy in the government.

When Mohammed Sherān was informed of the death of his master, he marched with the troops under his command to Deocote, with an intention of seizing Aly Murdan, who was strongly suspected of having murdered the late Governor; but that Chief, alarmed at his approach, fled to his government of Barsool, where he made some resistance: he was however at length taken prisoner, and consigned to the charge of Baba Ispahany Cutwall. After this event, Mohammed Sherān returned to Lucknowty; where all the Mussulman commanders being assembled, they unanimously elected him to be their Chief, on condition of each receiving a certain district, or *feod*, for the support of their troops. On this occasion Mohammed Sherān assumed the ensigns of royalty, and took the title of Aza Addeen.

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SECT. III.

In the mean time, Aly Murdan, having bribed the Cutwall* in whose charge he had been left, made his escape to Delhy; where he informed Cuttub Addeen, who had just then assumed the title of Emperor of Hindoostan, of the state of affairs in Bengal.

The Emperor, jealous of his authority having been thus slighted, ordered Kemar Roumy, Governor of Oude, to proceed to Bengal, and to make a new division of the districts amongst the Khulijy Chiefs. He was also directed to establish in that country an Imperial Dewan, to receive the Royal proportion of the revenues.

On the approach of the Imperial army, one of the Khulijy Chiefs, named Hissam Addeen Avuz, to whose lot had fallen the district of Gungowtry, or Kuthoury, joined the royal standards, and was confirmed in the government of Deocote; but the other Chiefs, disdaining submission, opposed Kemar Roumy: they were however defeated, and fled towards Cooch Beyhar, where, quarrelling amongst themselves, Mohammed Sherān fell by one of their swords.

After this event, Kemar Roumy, pardoning the remaining Chiefs, made a new division of the country amongst them; and having appointed an officer to receive the Imperial portion of the revenues, returned to his own government.

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* An officer somewhat similar to the Mayor or chief magistrate of a town.

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ALY MURDAN KULIJY ALA ADDEEN.

Aly Murdan graciously received at Dehly—Accompanies Cuttub Addeen in his Expedition to Ghizne—Appointed the Emperor's Viceroy in Bengal—Rejects the authority of the Court of Dehly on the death of the Emperor—Proclaimed King of Bengal—Becomes vain and capricious—Assassinated by his Nobles.

Aly Murdan Khulijy, who was suspectedof the murder of Mohammed Bukhtyar, was a man of great activity, courage, and resolution; and on making his escape from Bengal, was graciously received at the Court of Dehly, where he arrived just as the Emperor, Cuttub Addeen, was setting out for Ghizne. He immediately offered his services to attend the Royal stirrup; and his request having been complied with, he in a short time insinuated himself so much into the good graces of the Sultan, that he became one of his greatest favourites.

Although Cuttub Addeen was at first successful in driving away his rival Eldoze, and in gaining possession of the city of Ghizne, he was finally obliged to relinquish it, and to retire to Lahore†, where, as has been before related, he died in the year of the Hejira 607. A.D. 1210.

During the expedition to Ghizne, Aly Murdan was taken prisoner, and carried into the presence of Eldoze, who so far gave him his liberty, as to permit him to attend him while hunting. The recompence which he made for this act of condescension, was an offer to imbrue his hands in the blood of that prince; but his overture having been rejected, he was sent back to Cuttub Addeen, with whom he returned to Lahore;

† See History of Hindoostan, A. H. 602.

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SECT. III. and, about the year 605, was appointed to be that Emperor's
A.D. 1208. Viceroy in Bengal.

In obedience to the royal mandate, Hissam Addeen Avuz, and the other Khulijy Chiefs, met the new Viceroy on the banks of the river Coosa; thence they carried him to Deocote, and placed him on the Musnud. Shortly after, he proceeded to Lucknowty (Gour), and obtained the undisputed controul of the kingdom.

A.D. 1210. Upon the death of Sultan Cuttub Addeen, in 607, Aly Murdan rejected the authority of the Court of Dehly, and, assuming the white umbrella and other ensigns of royalty, caused himself to be proclaimed King of Bengal, under the title of Sultan Ala Addeen.

Previous to this event, Aly Murdan had been esteemed a vigilant and brave officer, but his head now became turned with vanity. On his public court-days he used to talk of the Kings of Persia, Khorassan, and Dehly, as his inferiors; and went so far as to bestow provinces of their dominions on his menial servants.

It is related, that one day a merchant complained to the new king, of having lost all his property by shipwreck or some other accident. The king asked of what country he was; and when informed that he was a Persian, he desired his minister immediately to draw out a patent, constituting the merchant Governor of Ispahan. The minister, not daring to say that Ispahan was the property of another monarch, retired to an adjoining apartment, under pretence of preparing the patent; but soon after returned, and represented to his majesty, that the merchant was truly grateful for the favour conferred, but that, as it was requisite he

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should be attended by a proper escort of troops, and should enter on his government in a dignified style, he begged to be further assisted with a sum of money, for the purpose of purchasing horses and equipments. Aly Murdan felt himself outwitted; but rather than lower his dignity, he ordered a large sum to be given to the fellow.

Had the conduct of this king been restricted to such ludicrous actions, it might have been excused by his subjects, though very offensive to the neighbouring monarchs; but he extended the hand of rapine and murder, not only to the Hindoos, but unjustly put several of the Khulijy nobles to death. Their patience being at length exhausted, they assassinated him, in the second year of his impolitic reign, and the 609th year of the Hejira. A. D. 1212.

HISSAM ADDEEN AVUZ GHYAS ADDEEN.

His Origin—Entertains two Derveishes, who predict his future greatness—Accompanies Mohammed Bukhtyar into Bengal, and promoted to the government of Gungowtry—Elected to the Musnud of Bengal—Improves the City of Lucknowty—Makes tributary the neighbouring Rajas—Offends the Court of Dehly—Prevents the Emperor's army from passing the Ganges—Makes peace with the Emperor—Drives the Royal troops from Behar—His territory again invaded by the Emperor's army—Slain, after many proofs of valour.

After the assassination of Aly Murdan, the Khulijy Chiefs raised to the throne Hissam Addeen Avuz, a nobleman who had given frequent proofs of his abilities and valour, and who was highly esteemed by all parties.

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SECT. III.

Origin of Hissam Addeen.

This Chief was descended of a good family, who resided at Ghor in Persia. When he arrived at the age of manhood, he travelled towards Toorkistan, in order to improve his fortune; and one day, having climbed an hill called Pooshteh Afroz, he there found two Derveishes, who, putting their trust in Providence, travelled through the world without any worldly care, or attention to their own wants. After the customary salutation, the Derveishes asked him if he had any provision with him. He replied that he had; and immediately opening his stores, gave them several cakes of bread, and some savoury meats. While they were eating, he procured them water to drink; and during the continuance of their meal, he respectfully attended them as a servant. When they had finished, they returned him thanks, and told him that he must immediately proceed to India, where there was a kingdom allotted for him.

His prosperity foretold.

Hissam Addeen, feeling a confidence in their prediction, was much rejoiced at this intelligence, and immediately turned his steps towards Hindoostan. On his arrival there, he was admitted into the service of his countryman, Mohammed Bukhtyar, whom he accompanied into Bengal, where he quickly obtained promotion, and, at the time of his master's death, was Governor of Gungowtry.

On his election to the Musnud of Bengal, he assumed the title of Ghyas Addeen, and, having removed his residence to Lucknowty (Gour), he took much pains, and expended large sums of money in improving that city. He built there a superb mosque, a college, and a caravansery; and, as the country in the vicinity of Gour was subject to inundations, he constructed causeways, extending on one side to Naghore in Beerbhoom, and on the other side to Deocote, being ten days'

Improves the city of Lucknowty.

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journey, which enabled the inhabitants to travel with convenience, at all times of the year, over a tract which had been considered nearly impassable during the season of the rains*.

This prince was a liberal encourager of the Arts and Literature. Many of the stately edifices of Gour were erected by him; and he bestowed ample pensions upon the learned and devout. He also distributed justice with great impartiality, making no distinction between the rich and the poor, the Mohammedan and the Hindoo.

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* Colonel Colebrook, late Surveyor-general of Bengal, was of opinion that the Ganges formerly ran under the walls of Gour, although its present bed is three miles distant from the ruins†: but the following description of that city, written on the spot by Menhajaddeen, author of the *Tabkat Nassery*, A.D. 1243-4, proves that the Ganges ran through the middle of it, and that the city, or citadel, was on the western side of the river: which confirms Mr. Wilford's‡ supposition respecting the course of the Ganges. "The writer of this work arrived at Lucknowty in the year 641, and visited all the religious buildings erected by that prince (Hissam Addeen Avuz). Lucknowty consists of two wings, one on each side of the Ganges: the western side is called Dal, and the city of Lucknowty is on that side. From Lucknowty to Naghore (in Beerbhoom), and, on the other side, to Deocote, a mound or causeway is formed the distance of ten days' journey, which in the rainy season prevents the waters from overflowing the lands: and if this mound did not exist, there would be no other mode of travelling, nor of visiting the edifices in the neighbourhood, but in boats. Since his time, in consequence of the construction of the causeway, the road is open to every body."

For the satisfaction of Persian scholars, the original is here inserted:

منتخب از احوال ملك حسام الدين غياث الدين

كاتب در شهور سنه احدي و اربعين و ستماية بديار لكهنوتي رسيد ور اطراف ان بلاد خيرات ان بادشاة مشاهدة افتاد لكهنوتي دو جناج دارد بر دو طرف آب كنك طرف غربي را دال كويند و شهر لكهنوتي بران جانب است از لكهنوتي تابشهر نكهور واز طرف ويكر تابشهر ويوكوت پل بسته است بقدر دة روز راة بسبب انيه در ان راة بوقت پرشكال ان زمين آب كيرد واكر ان راة پلوان نباشد مكر وركشتي بمقاصد وعمارت اطراف نتوان رسيد از عهد او بسبب عمارت ان پلوانها راة برجميع خلق كشادة وشد

† See Asiatic Researches, vol. VII. p. 10. 8vo. edition.

‡ Ibid. vol. V. p. 272.

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His time, however, was not occupied solely by these acts of peace. He carried his arms into the territories of the Rajas of Kamroop, Tirhoot, and Jagernaut, which had never been before subdued by the Mohammedan arms, and compelled them to pay him tribute.

For ten years he reigned with great prosperity; but having neglected to send presents to the Court of Dehly, the Emperor Altumsh, son-in-law of Cuttub Addeen, in the year of the
A. D. 1225. Hejira 622, marched from Dehly, and, without opposition, took possession of Behar: but Ghyas Addeen, having secured all the boats, prevented the royal army from crossing the Ganges; and, by the mediation of some friends, the Emperor at length agreed to make peace, and let him retain the government of Bengal on the following conditions;—that the money should in future be stampt, and the *Khutbē* (proclamation) read, in the name of Altumsh; and that Ghyas Addeen should present the Emperor with thirty-eight elephants and a large sum of money, and send annually a tribute to Dehly. These terms having been ratified, the Emperor returned towards Dehly, previously appointing a nobleman, named Mulk Ala Addeen, to be Governor of Behar: but scarcely had he arrived in his capital, before Ghyas Addeen crossed the river, dispossessed the new Governor, and drove the royal troops out of the district of Behar.

The Emperor was highly irritated at this conduct; and having assembled a numerous army in Oude, under the command of his son, Nasir Addeen, he ordered that prince to proceed to, and subdue Bengal. Nasir Addeen marched from
A. D. 1227. Oude in the year 624, at a time when Ghyas Addeen was employed in subduing some of the Rajas in the eastern parts of

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Bengal: in consequence of which the young prince obtained possession of Lucknowty without opposition. But as soon as Ghyas Addeen had received intelligence of the invasion, he hastened to meet his opponents. He courageously attacked them in the neighbourhood of his capital; and, after exhibiting many proofs of valour, fell, with many of his Chiefs, either on the field of battle, or immediately after, by the hands of the executioner. SECT. III.

This prince reigned twelve years; and with such reputation, that even the Emperor Altumsh always spoke of him with the highest respect, saying, that he well deserved the title of *Sultan*, and the epithet of *Supporter of the Faith*.

THE PRINCE NASIR ADDEEN.

On the death of Ghyas Addeen, the young prince took possession of Bengal and Behar, in the name of the Emperor; and having sent the family of the deceased and the plunder of Lucknowty to Dehly, was appointed Viceroy of those provinces, with permission to use the red umbrella, and other insignia of royalty.

He is said to have ruled with great justice for nearly five years, and died at Lucknowty in the year 626. Upon this event, the Khulijy Chiefs revolted, and for some time threw the affairs of Bengal into confusion; but the Emperor Altumsh having marched from Dehly on the news of his son's death, entered Bengal early in 627, and, after defeating the rebels, appointed Mulk Ala Addeen to the government. A. D. 1228-9. A. D. 1229-30.

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MULK ALA ADDEEN, AND SIEF ADDEEN TOORK.

THE former of these Nobles, after having held the government of Bengal for four years, was succeeded by Sief Addeen Toork,
A. D. 1237. who, at the end of three years, died by poison (A. H. 634).

AZA ADDEEN TOGHAN KHAN.

Origin of Toghan Khan—Promoted to the Government of Bengal—Invades Tirhoot—Seizes the Province of Kurrah Manikpore—His unsuccessful attack on Ketasun—The Orissians besiege him in Gour—Timour Khan sent to his assistance—Superseded by Timour—Retires with his property to Dehly—Appointed Governor of Oude—Dies.

TOGHAN KHAN was born in the district of Khota in Tartary. He was handsome in his person, and possessed of every amiable quality. Whilst a youth, he was purchased by the Emperor Altumsh, who for several years employed him in confidential situations in the royal household, and in the year
A.D. 1233. 630 appointed him to the government of Budaoon (now Rohilcund). Having distinguished himself in this situation, he was promoted to Behar; and on the death of Sief Addeen
A.D. 1237. Toork, in 634, was rewarded with the important government of Bengal.

When Sultana Rizia, daughter of the Emperor Altumsh, ascended the throne of Dehly in the end of the year 634, Toghan Khan sent an eloquent agent, with valuable presents, to Court, and by these means was not only confirmed in his government, but was also promoted to the highest rank of

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nobility, with permission to use the red umbrella, as the representative of the Empress. SECT. III.

In order to signalize himself in his new situation, the Governor led his army into Tirhoot; and having compelled the Raja to pay him a large sum of money, returned in triumph to Gour.

During the early part of the impotent reign of the Emperor Musaoud, Toghan Khan, finding that all the other Omrahs were extending their authority to the annihilation of the Imperial dignity, resolved to add the province of Kurrah Manikpore to his dominions. With this intention he marched from Gour; and having effected his purpose without any opposition, remained in the city of Kurrah for a considerable time. During his residence there, in 640, he was joined by A.D. 1242. Menhaj Seraje Addeen Giorjany, author of the Tabkat Nassery, with whom he shortly after returned to Bengal.

In the year 641, the Raja of Jagepore (Orissa) having A.D. 1243. given some cause of offence, Toghan Khan marched, in the month of Shual, to Ketasun, on the frontier of Jagepore, where he found the army of the Raja had thrown up entrenchments to oppose him.

On Saturday the 6th of Zykād, the Mohammedans drew up in order of battle, and, having made a vigorous attack on the entrenchments of the enemy, succeeded in taking two of the lines; but there being still a third, and the troops fatigued and oppressed with heat, Toghan Khan allowed them to halt and refresh themselves. In the mean time, a small party of the Hindoo cavalry, getting into his rear, seized upon the elephants, and began to plunder the camp. On seeing this, the Mohammedans retreated in great disorder; and being

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warmly pursued by their enemies, numbers of them were slain, and all their baggage and elephants seized by the enemy. Toghan Khan was therefore compelled to return with ignominy to Lucknowty, whence he sent a special messenger to solicit assistance from the Emperor.

The Orissians besiege Gour, A. D. 1244.

The Raja being encouraged by this success, invaded Bengal; and in the month of Shual of the following year, 642, the Orissa army, which was accompanied by a number of war elephants, laid siege to the city of Gour, but were vigorously opposed by Toghan Khan. Another party of the Orissians made an attack upon Naghore, the capital of Beerbhoom, the defence of which had been entrusted to Kureem Addeen, who with a great number of his followers fell in the contest, and the town was plundered by the enemy.

In the mean time, the army of Oude, under the command of Timour Khan Keran, which had been ordered by the Emperor to the assistance of Toghan Khan, approached Lucknowty. When intelligence of this event reached the Orissians, they were alarmed, and retreated with their plunder to their own country*.

When Timour Khan arrived at Lucknowty, being either irritated at the Hindoos having escaped with their plunder, or captivated by the appearance of the rich country through which he had passed, he affirmed that his commission from the Court superseded Toghan Khan in the government, and demanded possession of the city of Lucknowty. This claim was resisted by the Governor; and an appeal to arms was the result,

* The national vanity of Ferishtah has induced him to convert the attack of the humble Orissians into an invasion of Tartars, part of the immense host of Jenghiez Khan, who about that period were approaching India.—*See History of Hindoostan, vol.* I. *p.* 179.

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from the dawn of day till the sun had nearly attained the meridian. The inhabitants of Bengal were amused by the view of two Mohammedan armies opposed to each other: but, by the interference of Menhajaddeen, and other mutual friends of the Chiefs, the combatants were at length separated, and each party returned to their respective camps. That of Toghan Khan being close to the gate of the city, most of his men went into the town, either to their families, or to procure provisions, leaving their Chief nearly alone. The spies of Timour having brought him intelligence of the situation of his rival, he immediately headed his cavalry, and rushed towards the tent of Toghan Khan. The latter had barely time to vault on his horse, and to take refuge within the city walls. This event occurred on Saturday the 5th of Zykād, 642.

Timour Khan supersedes Toghan Khan in the government of Bengal.

A. D. 1244.

After this, by the intervention of Menhajaddeen Giorjany, and some other friends, it was agreed that Toghan should be allowed to take away with him all his treasure, elephants, and other property, and that Timour Khan should continue as Governor of Bengal.

Toghan was favourably received at the Court of Dehly, and was soon after appointed Governor of Oude, in which situation he died, in the year 644.

A. D. 1246.

TIMOUR KHAN KERAN.

Timour Khan was a native of Kipchak (north of the Caspian Sea), and was purchased by Sultan Altumsh for 50,000 *Rytel*. Being a youth of great comeliness and bravery, he was speedily promoted to various offices of importance, and was at length

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entrusted with the government of Oude; whence, as has been before related, he proceeded to Bengal; which country he governed with great prudence for two years, and died at Gour
A. D. 1246. in the year 644, on the same night that his predecessor, Toghan Khan, died in the city of Oude. His remains were, by his own desire, carried to Oude, and were buried close to those of his rival.

SIEF ADDEEN YUGAN TUNT,

ORIGINALLY a Turkish slave, succeeded to the government of Bengal, and reigned with considerable reputation for seven
A. D. 1253. years. He died at Gour, in the year 651.

IKHTYAR ADDEEN, TOGHRIL KHAN, MULK YUZBEK.

His Origin—Intriguing disposition—Confinement—Raised to the Government of Bengal—Invades Orissa, without success—Invades the Raja of Azmurdun, and obtains much plunder—Aims at independence—Unsuccessful Expedition against Oude—Invades the Raja of Kamroop, and plunders his capital—Defeated in his retreat from Kamroop, and taken prisoner—Dies.

THIS Chief was also one of the Tartar slaves of the Emperor Altumsh; and having been by degrees promoted to an important command in the army, joined the rebels, who, in the year 634, deposed Ferose, the son of his master, and exalted the Sultana Rizia to the throne; but three years afterwards he turned his arms against the Princess, and became a favourite with the emperor, Byram Shah. His intriguing disposition, however, having rendered him suspected, two months before the tragical death of that emperor, which occurred in the end

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of the year 639, he was seized and confined; but upon the accession of Musaood he obtained his release. Under the reign of that emperor, he obtained first the government of Tiberhind, and subsequently that of Lahore. In this situation he evinced a refractory spirit, and was recalled to Dehly; but was pardoned at the intercession of his friends. He was subsequently intrusted with the government of Cannouge, and afterwards with that of Oude; whence, on the death of Sief Addeen Yugan Tunt, (A. H. 651) he was transferred to Bengal. A. D. 1253.

Unsuccessful Expedition against the Orissians.

The first act of his government was the assembling of an army, to revenge the disgrace which the Mohammedan arms had sustained, in the year 641, from the Raja of Jagepore (Orissa), as has been before related. He accordingly invaded the dominions of that prince, and was victorious in two battles; but in the third was completely defeated, and lost all his elephants; among which was a white one, esteemed a great curiosity.

In the following year he invaded the territories of the Raja of *Azmurdun**, and took the capital of that prince, with all his treasure and elephants. After overrunning that country for some months, he returned, loaded with plunder and captives, to Lucknowty.

Mulk Yuzbek aims at Independence.

The success of his late expedition, and the distracted state of the empire of Dehly, inflamed the Governor with the ambition of independence: he accordingly assumed not only the red and black, but the white umbrella; and took upon himself the title of Mogies Addeen. Shortly after, he assembled a numerous army, and proceeded to Oude. Here he was opposed

* Probably Silhet, in which there is still a large town, called *Azmurgunge*.

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by the Governor of that district; and it being rumoured that the Emperor was marching in person against him, he made a speedy and disgraceful retreat to Bengal.

This rebellion of Mulk Yuzbek against his legitimate Sovereign rendered him contemptible in the eyes of all mankind; nor did his ill actions go unrequited, as will subsequently appear.

Mulk Yuzbek invades Kamroop, A. D. 1256-7.

In the beginning of the year 655, he assembled his army, and, having crossed the Bagmutty river, invaded the territories of the Raja of Kamroop*. That Chief, finding himself unable to oppose the Mohammedans, retreated into the mountains; and his capital was taken possession of by the invaders, who found therein immense wealth. Mulk Yuzbek ordered a mosque to be built; and after the accustomary prayers and thanksgiving, for the success of the Mohammedan arms, had been read, he was proclaimed Sovereign of the United Kingdoms of Bengal and Kamroop.

During this time, the Raja sent an ambassador to Mulk Yuzbek, offering, on condition of his retiring, not only to pay him a large tribute of money and elephants, but also to stamp the coin in his name. These offers were rejected by Mulk Yuzbek with disdain: but he had shortly occasion to repent his temerity; for the Hindoos, having taken possession of the roads, cut off all the supplies of grain; and, as soon as the rainy season set in, cut the banks of the rivers, and overflowed all the low country. In this dilemma, the invaders attempted to retreat across the mountains; but lost their road, and suffered the greatest distress. At length the Hindoos, having completely surrounded

* See Note in p. 48.

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them in a defile, galled them severely with their arrows. Mulk Yuzbek, who rode upon an elephant, being thereby rendered very conspicuous, was mortally wounded; after which the whole of the Mohammedan army yielded themselves prisoners to the enemy. Mulk Yuzbek was then carried before the Raja; and when introduced to that prince, he requested that his son, who had been with him in the battle, might be sought for, and, if alive, brought to him: his request was complied with; and the youth having been found among the prisoners, was brought to his father, who embraced him, and immediately after yielded up his soul to his Maker. This event occurred in the year 656.

Defeated, and mortally wounded, A. D. 1257.

JELAL ADDEEN KHANY.

As soon as the death of Mulk Yuzbek was known at the Court of the emperor Nasir Addeen Mohammed, the ministers of the empire, judging it a favourable opportunity to recover their influence in Bengal, despatched (in the year 656) a Chief, named Jelal Addeen Khany, to take possession of that province. This officer was received by the subordinate Chiefs with every mark of respect due to the Imperial authority, and permitted to assume the reins of government without any opposition. Jelal Addeen, after settling the business in the neighbourhood of Lucknowty, was induced to lead his army into the eastern part of Bengal, to reduce some of the independent Rajas to obedience; but while thus employed, his government was invaded from a quarter whence he could least have suspected it: for Irsilan Khan, the Imperial Governor of Kurrah, having been intrusted with the command

A. D. 1257.

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of an army to subdue the Raja of Callinger, in Bundelcund, suddenly turned his footsteps towards Bengal, and, after a siege of a few days, got possession of Gour. In a subsequent engagement he killed Jelal Addeen; but in consequence of his sending the elephants, horses, and other property of the murdered chief, as a bribe to the flagitious minister, the Vizier of the contemptible Court of Dehly, his conduct was overlooked.

IZA AL MULK, TAJADDEEN, IRSILAN KHAN, SUNJIR KHUARIZMY.

THIS Chief was also one of the slaves of the Emperor Altumsh, and was promoted, by degrees, to the principal offices of
A. D. 1258. the state. He at length, in the year 657, obtained the government of Kurrah, with orders to subdue the countries of Callinger and Malwa: but having made several marches in that direction, he suddenly turned his route towards Bengal; the Governor of which province being absent on an expedition to the eastward, he, after a siege of three days, obtained possession of the city of Lucknowty. The Governor, Jelal Addeen, returning soon afterwards, an engagement took place, in the month of Jummad 657, between the two chiefs. The latter was slain in the contest; and the plunder of his property having been remitted to Dehly, procured the confirmation of the usurper. He continued to rule Bengal for two years, and died
A. D. 1260. at Lucknowty in the year 659.

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MOHAMMED TATAR KHAN.

THIS Chieftain was celebrated for his generosity, bravery, and virtue; and was so great a favourite with the army, that, on the death of his father, the late Governor, in 659, he took quiet possession of his office: and the attention of the Emperor Nasir Addeen being at that time much occupied in defending his northern frontier against the Moghuls, it was thought unadvisable to depose him. But when, in the year 664, the reins of supreme authority had fallen into the able hands of Balin, the Governor of Bengal drew his neck within the circle of obedience, and despatched to Dehly a rich tribute, consisting of sixty-three elephants, great quantities of silks, muslins, &c. and a large sum in specie.

A.D. 1265, Tatar Khan sends rich presents to Delhy.

As this event occurred in the first year of Balin's reign, the Emperor considered it an auspicious omen, and ordered the cavalcade to be introduced into the capital with great pomp. The agents were received in public court, and were distinguished by dresses of honour; and a few days after received from the hands of the Emperor a commission, confirming Tatar Khan in his government; to which were added several presents, as a proof of the royal favour. This conduct had such an effect on the mind of Tatar Khan, that he continued thenceforward a faithful vassal of the Court of Dehly, and died at Lucknowty in the year 676.

A.D. 1277.

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SULTAN MOGIES ADDEEN TOGHRIL.

Promoted to the Government of Bengal—Enforces tribute from the neighbouring Rajas—Invades Jagenagur—Aims at independence, and proclaims himself King of Bengal—Obtains two successive victories over the Royal army—The Emperor takes the field in person, and Toghril retires towards Jagenagur—Pursued by the Emperor's army—His Camp surprised—Toghril slain while endeavouring to escape—His Adherents and Relatives put to death—The Emperor bestows the government on Nasir Addeen, the youngest of his own sons.

His Origin.

TOGHRIL was originally a Tartar slave, and had the good fortune to be purchased by the Emperor Balin, with whom he became so great a favourite, that, on the government of Bengal becoming vacant, he was intrusted with that important command. Being a person of a courageous and active disposition, he turned his arms against the Rajas whose territories adjoined to the north-east of Bengal, and compelled them to pay him tribute.

Invades Jagenagur, A. D. 1279.

In the year 678, he assembled a very numerous army, and invaded the country of Jagenagur (Tippera). After having defeated the Raja in a general engagement, he plundered the inhabitants, and brought away with him immense wealth and one hundred elephants. At this period the Emperor Balin was confined to his bed by sickness; and his two sons were employed in defending the northern boundaries of the kingdom against the Moghuls.* Toghril, fired by ambition, and destitute of every principle of gratitude, deemed this a favourable opportunity to render himself independent; and having caused it to

Toghril rebels against the Emperor.

* These were the troops of Zingis or Jenghiez Khan, who at that period made several incursions into Hindoostan.

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be reported that the Emperor was dead, he assumed the red umbrella and other insignia of royalty, and proclaimed himself King of Bengal, under the title of Sultan Mogies Addeen.

Toghril twice overcomes the Royal Army.

When this intelligence reached the Court of Dehly, the Emperor was much alarmed; and though far from being well, he appeared in public, and caused it to be notified throughout all his dominions that he was perfectly recovered from his indisposition. He also wrote a letter to Toghril, upbraiding him with his ingratitude, and conjuring him to return to his allegiance: but this letter not producing any effect on the mind of the traitor, the Emperor appointed Mulk Abektegien, whose title was Ameen Khan, to the government of Bengal; and placed under his command a numerous army, ordering him to proceed and expel the rebel. Abektegien marched from Oude, crossed the river Gogra, and continued his march towards Bengal. He was met on the frontier by Toghril, who having previously corrupted some of the Tartar Chiefs in the royal army, engaged the remainder, and obtained an easy victory.

On receiving intelligence of this event, the Emperor was enraged, and ordered Abektegien to be hanged at the gate of Oude, the seat of his late government. He at the same time despatched another army, under the command of Turmutty, a Turkish officer, with orders to extirpate the rebels. But this General was not more successful than his predecessor: he was totally routed, and lost all his baggage and the public treasure.

The Emperor takes the field in person against Toghril.

When the news of this second defeat reached the Emperor, he was overwhelmed with affliction; but recovering his former energy, he resolved to proceed in person against the rebel: he therefore gave orders to assemble a numerous army; and having collected an immense fleet of boats in the rivers Jumna

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and Ganges, he proceeded, early in the rainy season, accompanied by his younger son, Bagora Khan, towards Bengal.

Although Toghril would have boldly defied an army commanded by any of the nobles, he durst not openly contend with his former master and sovereign: he therefore collected all his wealth and elephants, and proceeded with a chosen detachment towards Jagenagur, resolving to remain there till the Emperor should return to Dehly.

On the arrival of the Emperor at Gour, he appointed Hissam Addeen governor of Bengal; and having halted there a few days, to make the requisite arrangements, he then proceeded, in pursuit of the rebel, towards Jagenagur.

When the Imperial army arrived at Sunergong*, Dhinuj Rai, the Chief of that district, paid his compliments to the Emperor, and, having taken the test of allegiance, undertook to guard the passage of the river against the rebel, should he endeavour to make his escape that way.

The Emperor continued his march with great expedition, but for many days could obtain no information respecting Toghril. He therefore ordered a detachment of 7000 horse, under the command of Mulk Barik, to proceed a day's march in advance of the army, and to scour the country for intelligence.

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* In Dow's History, vol. I. p. 202, Jagenagur is said to have been a town in Orissa, near Cuttack; but this passage proves it to have been situated on the eastern side of the Burhampooter. The Jagenagur mentioned by Ferishtah should have been written Jagepore, still a town of some consequence in Cuttack. *See page* 65.

Sunergong is thus described in Rennell's Memoir of the Map of Hindoostan:—"Sunergong, or Sunnergaum, was a large city, and the provincial capital of the eastern division of Bengal, before Dacca was built; but it is dwindled to a village: it is situated on one of the branches of the Burhampooter, about thirteen miles south-east from Dacca, and was famous for a manufacture of fine cotton cloths."

That Dacca is a modern city, is evinced by its not being noticed, at least under that name, in the *Ayeen Akbery*. See Sircar Sunergong, vol. II. p. 288.

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After a lapse of several days, a picquet, consisting of forty horse, belonging to the advanced guard, commanded by Mohammed Shir, fell in with some grain merchants, whose empty sacks evinced that they had lately disposed of their property. Of these Mohammed inquired if they had seen or heard aught of the rebel army. They at first pretended ignorance; but Mohammed having ordered one of them to be beheaded, the others fell on their knees, and acknowledged they had on that morning disposed of their grain in the rebel camp, which was only a few miles in front of them.

Mohammed immediately despatched the merchants, under an escort, to the officer commanding the advanced guard; and proceeded with his forty troopers till he came within sight of the camp, and could plainly distinguish the tents of Toghril, and that the rebels were so completely off their guard as to have turned their horses loose into the corn-fields. Being fired with the ambition of seizing the rebel himself, Mohammed urged his small party to make the attempt: they advanced in full speed, and were permitted by the unsuspicious enemy to enter the camp. On their arrival at the tent of Toghril, they drew their swords, and, crying out "Victory to the Emperor Balin!" rushed forward to the tent of audience, and put a number of the persons therein to death.

Toghril's camp surprised.

Toghril, on hearing the alarm, supposing he was surprised by the whole of the royal army, fled in the greatest perturbation. He vaulted on a horse without a saddle, and galloped towards the river; but was perceived and pursued by Malleck, the brother of Mohammed, who shot him with an arrow, as his horse was swimming the river. Toghril immediately fell; and Malleck, plunging into the stream, dragged him to the shore, and cut off his head.

Toghril slain while endeavouring to escape.

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The royal party having in the mean time put to death a number of Toghril's principal officers, an universal panic seized the rebels, and they fled on all sides. The advanced guard soon after came up, and secured the encampment.

An express was immediately sent off to the Emperor with an account of the victory, which was corroborated by the head of the rebel Chief. On the following day, the Emperor, with the whole of the Imperial army, arrived, and took possession of all the wealth and elephants. The Emperor, after glutting his avarice with the spoils of the conquered, returned towards Gour, and, on his arrival in that city, ordered a number of the adherents and relations of Toghril, including their wives and children, to be put to a cruel death. This was the first time that any of the Emperors of India had inflicted punishment on the women and children of rebels.

Nasir Addeen crowned King of Bengal.

The Emperor some time after bestowed on his younger son the kingdom of Bengal, with the title of Sultan Nasir Addeen (Defender of the Faith)*, and conferred on him all the insignia of royalty: he also admonished him never to contend with the Emperor of Dehly; but whether that throne should be occupied by a brother, a relation, or a stranger, to be always subservient to him, and to avoid opposition, by retiring to a distant part of the country, if the Imperial standards should ever advance towards Bengal. Having added some salutary rules for his conduct and the government of his subjects, he

A. D. 1282. returned towards Dehly, in the year 681.

* In Dow's *History of Hindoostan* he is called Kera, but in my Manuscripts the name is written Bagora.

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SULTAN NASIR ADDEEN BAGORA KHAN

Attends his Father's commands at Dehly—Returns to his government of Bengal, and loses the succession to the throne of Dehly—His Son, Kiekobad, made Emperor—Nasir Addeen, displeased with his Son's administration, proceeds with an army towards Dehly—Affectionate meeting with his Son on the Plain of Oude—Terms of Peace agreed on—The Emperor assassinated soon after his return to Dehly—Nasir Addeen resigns the government of Bengal—Behadur Khan appointed in his stead—Behadur's conduct displeases the Court of Dehly—Nasir Addeen re-appointed to the government of Lucknowty—Dies.

THIS prince governed Bengal for several years with much reputation; but his elder brother, Mohammed, having been killed in a battle with the Moghuls in the vicinity of Moultan, the Emperor ordered him, in the year 685, to proceed to Dehly, A. D. 1286. and, on his arrival there, thus addressed him:—"The sudden death of thy elder brother has bent down my aged head with sorrow to the grave; and although he has left a son who is doubtless the legitimate heir to the throne, the youth is of too tender an age to wield with effect the weighty sceptre of Hindoostan: it must therefore be placed in more able hands. You are my only prop and support. Bear for the short period, for which I am destined to remain in this world, the yoke of dependence. Send a deputy to govern Bengal, and remain near my throne, ready to step into it as soon as Fate shall call me hence."—The prince promised implicit obedience to the will of his aged parent; but several months having elapsed, and the Emperor improving in his health, Nasir Addeen resolved to return to Bengal, and leave the empire of Dehly for those to whom it might be destined by Providence.

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SECT. III.

Having taken this resolution, he requested permission of his father to make a short excursion, for the purpose of hunting; and under this pretence quitted Dehly, and proceeded directly to Gour.

This step gave great offence to the Emperor; who thereon sent for Ky Khusero, the son of the Prince Mohammed, and declared him the heir of his kingdoms: soon after which event
A. D. 1286. he departed this life, in the end of the year 685, and in the eightieth year of his age.

Notwithstanding the legitimate claim of Ky Khusero to the kingdom, which was further sanctioned by the will of the
Kiekobad, son of Nasir Addeen, created Emperor. deceased Emperor, the nobles raised Kiekobad to the throne, a prince of eighteen years of age, son of Nasir Addeen the king of Bengal. This youth soon fell into all the allurements of pleasure, and devoted his whole time to amusement; relinquishing to his minister, Nizam Addeen, the government of his dominions.

Nasir Addeen was well pleased with the elevation of his son to the throne: but when informed of his unworthy conduct, he wrote to him, severely reprehending his behaviour, and advising him to discard the unworthy minister. Finding, however, that his advice was of no avail, he gave orders for assembling an army, resolving to go in person to Dehly, and to effect a revolution. The son, also, displeased with the admonitions of his father, and goaded by the animosity of the minister, advanced at the head of a great force towards Bengal. In the
A. D. 1288. year 687, the two armies approached within a few miles of each other; the camp of the father being on the banks of the river Sirve, and that of the son on the banks of the Gogra, both in the district of Sircar Sarun, part of North Behar.

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SECT. III.

Interview of Nasir Addeen with his son.

Nasir Addeen, finding it impossible to reduce his son by force, made overtures of reconciliation to him: but the prince, at the instigation of his minister, rejected them with disdain. Three days were passed in this manner, when, on the fourth day, Nasir Addeen wrote with his own hand the following letter:—"My beloved son, my desire of seeing you exceeds all bounds; nor can I endure to be longer separated from you. The patriarch Jacob did not more anxiously wish to embrace his son Joseph before his death, than I do you. Grant me this request, and I swear never again to disturb your reign, or to oppose your will."—When Kiekobad read his father's letter, he was deeply affected, and wished immediately to go, unattended, to visit him; but the artful minister restrained the ardour of the prince's affection, by representing that it would be derogating from the dignity of the Emperor of Hindoostan to pay the first visit to an inferior prince, although that person was his father.

It was at length settled, that a suite of the Imperial tents should be pitched in the Plain of Oudē, between the two armies; and that the King of Bengal should there pay his respects to the Emperor seated on his throne. This arrangement being made, and the astrologers having determined on an auspicious hour, the son first proceeded to the tents, in great state, surrounded by his guards: after which the father crossed the river Sirve, and, when he came in sight of the throne, made his first obeisance; as he approached nearer, he made a second obeisance; and when arrived at the foot of the throne, was about to make the third; when the prince, being much affected by the humility of his father, burst into tears, and, rushing into his arms, continued to embrace him

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SECT. III.

for a considerable time. After this affecting scene, the father attempted to hand his son to the throne; but the latter refused, and compelled his father to sit thereon, taking his place in a respectful manner below him. This meeting gave great satisfaction to all the well-disposed subjects; and for several days great rejoicings and illuminations were displayed, and alternate visits passed between the monarchs and the officers of both armies *.

The terms of peace were easily agreed on. Nasir Addeen was permitted to retain Bengal, and all its dependencies, as a distinct kingdom, on condition of not interfering with the
A. D. 1288. government of Dehly. These events occurred in the year 687.

Previous to separating, Nasir Addeen gave his son some salutary advice for the government of his dominions; and concluded by privately admonishing him to beware of his insidious minister, and to get rid of him the first favourable opportunity. Having then affectionately embraced him, they took leave of each other, and returned towards their respective capitals.

Nasir Addeen was much affected on this occasion; and told his friends, on returning to his own camp, that he feared he had on that day parted with his son and the empire of Hindoostan for ever. His fears were soon after realized; for
The Emperor Kiekobad assassinated, A. D. 1289. in the end of the following year, viz. 688, Kiekobad was assassinated, and the throne of Dehly usurped by Feroze, a chief of the tribe of Khulijy.

Sultan Nasir Addeen was permitted to retain the kingdom of Bengal, during the whole of the reign of Feroze,

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* This affecting interview has been well described, in a beautiful Poem called the *Keran Assaedin*, or *Auspicious Conjunction*, by Amyr Khosrou of Dehly.

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SECT. III.

and the earlier part of that of the Emperor Alla, without molestation; but when that able, though cruel, monarch had attained the height of his power, Nasir Addeen, dreading his displeasure, voluntarily laid aside his umbrella and other insignia of royalty, and, professing himself a subject of the Court of Dehly, was permitted to retain in fief the district of Lucknowty (Gour), and the south-west part of Bengal. This event occurred about the year 699. A. D. 1299.

Nasir Addeen resigns the Kingdom of Bengal.

The Emperor at the same time appointed a Chief, named Behadur Khan, to the government of the eastern districts of Bengal; hoping, by thus dividing that province into two governments, to render it more subservient to the Court of Dehly than it had hitherto proved. The capital of the new government was fixed at Sunergong†.

Behadur Khan retained his situation with humility during the remainder of the reign of Alla, but is said afterwards to have ruled with great tyranny.

When, in the year 717, the dissolute prince Mubarick Shah succeeded to the throne of Dehly, Behadur, despising the weakness of the Imperial councils, arrogated to himself independence; assuming the white umbrella, and ordering the coin to be stampt with his own name, changing the title of Behadur Khan to Behadur Shah. A. D. 1317.

In the year 724, the Emperor Tughlik, jealous of the assumed rank, and wearied by complaints of the oppressions and tyranny of Behadur Shah, marched from Dehly with a numerous army, and, on his arrival at Tirhoot, was met by Nasir Addeen, the deposed king of Bengal, who having presented the Emperor with many valuable jewels, was received A. D. 1324.

† See Note to p. 72.

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SECT. III.

Re-appointed Governor of Lucknowty.

with great favour, permitted to use the insignia of royalty, and re-appointed to his government of Lucknowty, on condition of holding it in fief from the Court of Dehly. This agreement he faithfully complied with, and died in the year

A.D. 1325.

725, being forty-three solar years from his first accession to the throne of Bengal; over which country he may be said to have been the first regularly constituted Mohammedan monarch, having been crowned as such by his father, the Emperor Balin, and confirmed in the possession of his kingdom by his son, the acknowledged Emperor Kiekobad.

Behadur Shah, finding himself unable to oppose the Imperial arms, submitted to the clemency of the Emperor; and was pardoned, on condition of giving up the public treasure and elephants, and attending the Imperial stirrup to Dehly.

The Emperor then appointed Tatar, with the title of Bhiram Khan, to the government of Sunergong; and having subdued Tirhoot, formed it into a distinct government, to which he appointed Ahmed Khan, and then returned to Dehly.

KUDDER KHAN.

A.D. 1325.

WHEN intelligence of the death of Nasir Addeen had reached Dehly, the Emperor Mohammed Shah, who had just then succeeded to the throne, appointed Kudder Khan to the government of Lucknowty, and confirmed Bhiram Khan in the government of Sunergong. These two persons are said to have ruled their respective territories, for fourteen years, with much equity and propriety.

A.D. 1338.

In the year 739, Bhiram Khan died at Sunergong, at a period when Mohammed Shah, having conquered great part

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SECT. III.

of the Dekkan, was busily occupied in transferring his capital from Dehly to Dowletabad *. This occasion presented a favourable opportunity to Fakher Addeen, the armour-bearer of Bhiram Khan, not only to assume the government of Sunergong without permission, but also to declare himself an independent monarch, assuming the title of Sultan Sekunder.

When intelligence of this event was carried to Court, the Emperor ordered Kudder Khan, the governor of Lucknowty, and the neighbouring Chiefs, to unite their armies, and expel the rebel. In obedience to the Imperial commands, Kudder Khan marched from Lucknowty, and, in a general engagement, defeated Fakher Addeen, who fled, and concealed himself in the forests. The Governor took possession of Sunergong; and after some time had elapsed, and the rainy season had set in, he allowed the subordinate Chiefs to return to their homes, and dispersed the greater number of his own troops, to collect the revenues. It happened that there was at this period a large sum of money in the treasury, which the Governor was preparing to forward to Dehly. Fakher Addeen having obtained intelligence of this circumstance, sent proposals to the portion of the army remaining with the Governor, that if they would kill their master, and join him, he would distribute the whole of the treasure amongst them. His emissaries were successful: the troops consented to the terms: they murdered the Governor; and then proceeded to join the rebel, who immediately advanced to Sunergong, and, having taken possession of the treasure, distributed it according to his promise. This event occurred either in the end of the year 740, or beginning of 741. A. D. 1340.

* See History of Hindoostan, A. D. 1338.

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SECT. IV.

Of the Independent Kings of Bengal.

FAKHER ADDEEN SULTAN SEKUNDER.

SECT. IV. FAKHER Addeen having, as we have stated in the preceding chapter, succeeded in regaining his authority, caused himself to be proclaimed Sovereign of Bengal; and ordered the coin to be stamped, and all public papers to be issued, in his name.

A. D. 1340-1. The throne of Dehly being at that period (A. H. 741) possessed by the weak Mohammed III. no effort was made to reduce the province to the Imperial authority; and as the power of the empire continued to decline, Bengal remained for many years afterwards an independent and distinct kingdom; on which account historians have considered Fakher Addeen as the first Mohammedan king of Bengal.

The new Sultan fixed his residence at Sunergong; and sent an army, under the command of his slave, Mukhliss Khan, to take possession of Lucknowty and the dependent districts: but in this expectation he was foiled; for Aly Mubarick, one of the officers of the deceased Governor, having collected some troops, opposed the invaders, and killed their leader. On this event, Aly Mubarick sent a petition to the Emperor,

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stating his success against the rebel, and soliciting that he might be confirmed in the government; but without waiting for the sanction of the Emperor, he took the title of Ala Addeen, and, advancing against Fakher Addeen, in the year 743, took him prisoner, and caused him to be put to death. A.D. 1342-3. The reign of Fakher Addeen, if such it may be termed, was only two years and five months. SECT. IV.

Aly Mubarick was assassinated, at the expiration of a year and five months, by his foster brother, Ilyas Khaje, or Hajy Elias, who took possession of the kingdom.

ILYAS KHAJE SULTAN SHUMS ADDEEN BHENGARA.

Ilyas assumes the government of Bengal—Invades the dominions of the Raja of Jagenagur—Offends the Emperor Ferose, who invades Bengal, and takes the city of Pundua—The Emperor long and unsuccessfully besieges Ilyas in the fort of Akdala—Ilyas obtains access to the Camp of the Emperor, in the disguise of a Fakier—Makes Peace with the Emperor, who afterwards acknowledges the independence of Bengal.

After the assassination of Aly Mubarick, his murderer assumed the reins of government, under the lofty title of Shums Addeen; and being of a mild and generous disposition, he soon rendered himself popular, both with the army and his subjects, who, in his other good qualities, shortly forgot the mode by which he ascended the throne.

As soon as Ilyas found himself perfectly established in his authority, he invaded the dominions of the Raja of Jagenagur (Tippera), and compelled that prince to pay a great sum of money, and to give him a number of valuable elephants, with which he returned in triumph to his capital.

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SECT. IV.

For ten years Ilyas Khaje ruled Bengal with absolute authority, and without any molestation from the Court of Dehly;

A. D. 1353.

but in the end of the year 754, the Emperor Ferose, taking offence at his having made encroachments on the province of Benaras, invaded Bengal with a numerous army.

Ilyas, not finding himself able to oppose the Emperor in the field, placed his troops in different garrisons, and took post himself in the fort of Akdala*; leaving his son to defend the city of Pundua (near Maldah), which for some time past he had made his capital.

The Emperor advanced to a place now called Feroseporeabad, where he pitched his camp, and commenced the operations of the siege of Pundua.

The Emperor Ferose takes the city of Pundua,

The son of Ilyas, led away by the ardour of youth, ventured to march out of the city, and to engage the royal army; but he soon paid the forfeit of his temerity: his troops were defeated, and himself made prisoner; after which the city surrendered.

and invests the fortress of Akdala.

From Pundua the Emperor proceeded to Akdala, and invested that fortress; but the place being very strong, the Emperor, after besieging it for twenty-two days, found it requisite to change his ground of encampment: for this purpose, he proceeded, with a detachment, to reconnoitre a spot on the banks of the river. Ilyas, seeing this movement, concluded the royal army were retreating, and sallied from the fort with all his garrison; but being vigorously opposed, was, after some hours, obliged to retreat, with the

* Akdala is placed by Major Rennell, in his *Bengal Atlas*, at a short distance to the north of Dacca: it is not to be found in the common maps, nor have I met with any account of it.

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loss of forty-four elephants which he had brought from Jagenagur, his umbrella, and other insignia of royalty. SECT. IV.

Ilyas, in disguise, enters the Emperor's Camp.

It is related, that, during the siege of Akdala, a celebrated Saint, named Raja Byabany, who resided in that vicinity, and to whom Ilyas was much devoted, died. Ilyas, wishing to pay the last duties to so revered a character, dressed himself as a Fakier, and, having come out of the fort, attended the funeral; after which he rode into the camp of the Emperor, to whom he made his obeisance; but, not being known, was allowed to depart, and returned in safety to his garrison. When the circumstance was related to his Majesty, he was very much vexed, though he could not help admiring the boldness of his adversary.

The siege having been protracted to a great length, and the rainy season, which in Bengal sets in with great violence and inundates the plains, drawing near, the Emperor found it requisite to make peace: he therefore, upon a promise from Ilyas of an annual tribute, and some trifling presents, released the prisoners taken at Pundua, and returned to Dehly.

A.D. 1354. In the year 755, Ilyas sent ambassadors, with very valuable presents, to the Emperor; by whom they were most graciously received, and afterwards dismissed with assurances of friendship.

The Emperor acknowledges the Independence of Bengal.

In 757, Ilyas, being still suspicious of the Emperor's intentions, sent other ambassadors to Dehly, who, after some negociation, concluded a permanent treaty of peace; by which the independence of Bengal was formally acknowledged, and the respective limits of each kingdom defined.

A.D. 1357. In the year 759, the King of Bengal sent a number of elephants, and other valuable presents, by his ambassador Tajaddeen, to the Emperor, who received the embassy in the

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SECT. IV. most gracious manner: and, in return, ordered Sief Addeen, a nobleman of distinction, to proceed, as his ambassador, to the Court of Bengal; and to take with him a number of choice Arabian and Tartar horses for the King.

The Imperial ambassador proceeded as far as Behar, where he received the melancholy intelligence of the death of the King of Bengal: he therefore waited in that city for further instructions; and, in consequence of orders received from his Court, he divided the horses amongst the Chiefs of Behar, and returned to his master.

Ilyas Khaje, under the title of Shums Addeen, ruled Bengal for sixteen years and five months, and died in the year
A. D. 1358. 760. Amongst a people who could overlook the step by which he mounted the throne, he was much respected and beloved. During his reign, the capital of Bengal was transferred from Gour to Pundua: and, as he is said to have founded the city of Hajypore, which has since given its name to a considerable district, it is probable that, previous to, or during his reign, the boundaries of Bengal were extended to the banks of the river Gunduk, including all North Behar.

SULTAN SEKUNDER SHAH.

Sekunder Shah raised to the throne—The Kingdom again invaded by the Emperor Ferose, who besieges the Fort of Akdala—The Emperor consents to a Peace, and retires—Sekunder builds a superb Mosque at Pundua—His son Ghyas Addeen excites the jealousy of his Step-mother, and engages in open rebellion—Sekunder mortally wounded.

Sekunder Shah mounts the throne of Bengal. THREE days after the death of Ilyas Khaje, the Chiefs placed on the throne his eldest son, Sekunder Shah, who

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SECT. IV.

commenced his reign by a strict administration of justice, and minute attention to the welfare of his subjects.

As soon as the days of mourning were accomplished, the King prepared a splendid embassy, with valuable presents, to be sent to the Court of Delhy. But when the Emperor Ferose heard of the death of Ilyas Khaje, he judged it a favourable opportunity to recover the Imperial authority over Bengal: he therefore, early in the year 761, advanced with hostile intentions towards that province; and having proceeded as far as Zufferabad, cantoned his army in that place till the expiration of the rainy season. In the mean time, he sent an ambassador to Sekunder Shah, with offers of peace, provided he would acknowledge himself the vassal of the empire. To these humiliating terms the King would not agree; but sent five elephants, and some costly presents, as a peace-offering.

A. D. 1359.

The Emperor Ferose again unsuccesfully invests Akdala.

As soon as the rains had subsided, the Emperor advanced with his army as far as Pundua; and Sekunder, following the prudent example of his father, took refuge in the strong fortress of Akdala. The Imperial army in a short time surrounded Akdala; but after a siege of some weeks, the Emperor, finding there was no probability of taking the place, consented to accept a present of forty-eight elephants and a large sum of money, and, on the promise of a future annual tribute, to withdraw from Bengal.

From that period, till nearly the close of his life, Sekunder Shah enjoyed a happy and undisturbed reign; and not being of a warlike disposition, he cultivated the arts of peace. In the year 763, he commenced a superb mosque in the vicinity of Pundua: and judging from the vestiges which are still remaining, it must have cost an immense sum of money, and much labour and time.

Sekunder erects a superb Mosque at Pundua, A. D. 1361.

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SECT. IV.

Sekunder Shah married two wives. By the first he had seventeen children, and by the second only one son. This youth, who was named Ghyas Addeen, possessed a most amiable disposition, and surpassed all his brethren in learning and accomplishments: on this account, the first wife beheld him with the eye of envy, and did every thing in her power to injure him in the affection of his father. One day, whilst alone with the King, she said, in a melancholy but respectful tone, that she had "something to communicate to his Majesty; but, as she was sensible it would give him pain, and probably excite his anger, she should forbear mentioning it, unless he would first swear not to divulge it to any person." The curiosity of the King having been thus raised, he complied with her request, and commanded her to disclose the secret, though it should rend his heart. The treacherous woman replied: "Since it is your positive command, I shall obey; and however repugnant to my feelings, must inform your Majesty, that Ghyas Addeen not only plots against the life of my sons, but has even the audacity to talk of deposing his father.—Let me advise you, as your sincere friend, to avert the mischief he intends, either by sending him to prison, or, by depriving the pupils of his eyes of their visual powers, render him incapable of effecting his flagitious schemes." —It was with difficulty the King could restrain himself during this speech: but when finished, he said to her, "Treacherous and subtle woman! are you not ashamed thus to evince your ingratitude to Heaven, for having bestowed on you the blessing of a numerous family*, (many of whom are advanced to manhood, and are the pride of their parents,) thus to envy your

Ghyas Addeen, the son of Sekunder, excites the jealousy of his Step-mother.

* In the East, from the most ancient times, women have been held in high estimation who gave birth to a number of children.

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partner in my bed the consolation of one only son, that thou seekest his destruction. Begone! I will not hear thee more."

Although the King did not communicate the conversation he had held with his wife to Ghyas Addeen, the youth was suspicious of the machinations of his step-mother; and one day, under pretence of going to hunt, he made his escape to Sunergong, and engaged in open rebellion. He was shortly enabled to collect an army, at the head of which he advanced towards Pundua. The first day he encamped at Sunarcote, and on the second day at Gualpareh. The King having also advanced to meet the rebels, found them at this place. A general engagement ensued, in which, although Ghyas Addeen had given positive orders to his troops not to injure his father, the King was unintentionally mortally wounded: but as soon as the son was informed of this untoward event, he hastened to his father's presence, and, taking his head in his lap, shed tears of repentance, and humbly besought the old man's forgiveness. The King then opened his eyes, and said, "My business is finished; may your dominion be prosperous!" after which his soul took its flight to the other world.

Ghyas Addeen engages in open rebellion.

The King mortally wounded.

Sekunder Shah reigned somewhat more than nine years, and was killed in the year 769. A. D. 1367.

SULTAN GHYAS ADDEEN.

Ghyas Addeen ascends the Throne — Commands the eyes of his half-Brothers to be eradicated — His attention to the due administration of the Laws — Anecdote of his three favourite Concubines — and of the celebrated Poet HAFIZ.

THE Prince, leaving some officers to attend the burial of his father, hastened to Pundua, where he immediately mounted

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SECT. IV. A.D. 1367.

the throne. The first act of his government was to seize his half-brothers, whose eyes he ordered to be eradicated and sent to their mother.

After this cruel act of self-preservation (as it is considered by Oriental politicians), Ghyas Addeen is said to have ruled with great justice and moderation; in proof of which the following anecdote is related of him.—One day, while the King was amusing himself in the practice of archery, one of his arrows by chance wounded a boy, the son of a widow. The woman immediately repaired to the tribunal of the Cazy, Suraje-addeen, and demanded justice. The judge was confounded, and said to himself, "If I summon the King to my court, I shall run the risk of being disobeyed; and if I pass over his transgression, I shall be one day summoned before the court of God, to answer for my neglect of duty."—After much reflection, he ordered one of the officers to go and summon the King, to answer the complaint of the woman. The officer, dreading to enter abruptly the palace with such an order, considered on some means to get introduced into the presence of the King. At length he ascended the minaret of the mosque adjoining the palace, and at an improper hour called the people to prayers. The King hearing his voice, ordered some of his guards to bring before him the man who thus made a mockery of religion.

Anecdote of the Sultan's attention to the due administration of the Laws.

When the officer was introduced into the royal presence, he briefly related the circumstance, and concluded by summoning his Majesty to the Cazy's tribunal. The King instantly arose, and, concealing a short sword under his garment, went before the Cazy; who, far from paying him any mark of respect, said to him with a tone of authority, "You

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have wounded the son of this poor widow; you must therefore immediately make her an adequate compensation, or suffer the sentence of the law." The King made a bow, and, turning to the woman, gave her such a sum of money as satisfied her: after which he said, "Worthy judge, the complainant has forgiven me." The Cazy asked the woman if such was the fact, and if she was satisfied: to which the woman having assented, was dismissed. The Cazy then came down from his tribunal, and made his obeisance to the King; who, drawing the sword from beneath his garment, said, "Cazy, in obedience to your commands, as the expounder of the Sacred law, I came instantly to your tribunal; but if I had found that you deviated in the smallest degree from its ordinances, I swear that with this sword I would have taken off your head! I return thanks to God that matters have thus happily terminated, and that I have in my dominions a judge who acknowledges no authority superior to the law."—The Judge, taking up the scourge, said, "I also swear, by the Almighty God, that if you had not complied with the injunctions of the law, this scourge should have made your back black and blue! It has been a day of trial for us both."—The King was much pleased, and handsomely rewarded the upright judge.

Ghyas Addeen was of a gay and convivial disposition; but, at one period of his reign, having for some time laboured under a severe illness, he despaired of life, and therefore made his will. In it he directed that three of his favourite concubines, whose names were The *Cypress*, The *Rose*, and The *Tulip*, should wash his body after his decease. The King soon after recovered; but the other women of the Seraglio, envious of the Favourites, conferred on these ladies the opprobrious title

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SECT. IV.

of *Ghossaly* (Washers of the dead); in consequence of which the Favourites complained to the King, who, after musing for some time, uttered the following extemporary hemistich:

"Cup-bearer! let us sing the praises of the Cypress, the Rose, and the Tulip——"

but, after several attempts, he could not finish the verse; nor could any of the Poets of his Court write an Ode on the subject to his satisfaction. He therefore wrote the hemistich, and sent it, accompanied with a valuable present, by the hands of a special messenger, to the celebrated *Hāfiz* of *Shiraz* in Persia. The messenger was also authorized to offer the Poet any terms that might induce him to proceed and reside at the Court of Bengal. It is said, that, as soon as the messenger arrived in Shiraz, the Poet, without having been informed of any of the circumstances, but as if by inspiration, spoke, extemporary, the other hemistich;—the sense of which is,

Of the celebrated Poet HAFIZ.

"Let these joyful tidings be carried to the three charming Ghossalehs."

After which he finished the Ode, still to be found in his Diwan, each verse of which terminates with the words, "*My ruvud:*" and in the last verse, he says,

"Hāfiz! why conceal the desire that possesses you, of visiting Sultan Ghyas Addeen: it is your business to complain of the distance that separates you."

But, as Hāfiz was indifferent to all worldly pursuits, and was besides afraid of undertaking so long a voyage, he declined the King's generous offer*.

Ghyas Addeen was a fellow-student of the celebrated saint

* See the Memoir of Hāfiz in p. 64 of the *Descriptive Catalogue of Tippoo Sultan's Library.*

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Cuttub al Aalum: they both studied theology under Hamid-addeen, the hermit of Nagore (Birbhoom). He reigned with much reputation six years and some months, and died in the year 775. A. D. 1373.

SIEF ADDEEN SULTAN ASSULATEEN.

When the soul of Ghyas Addeen had taken its flight to the other world, the nobles placed his son, Sief Addeen, on the throne, with the lofty title of King of Kings. This prince was of a generous, courageous, and humane disposition: he disturbed not the quiet of his neighbours by his ambition, but ruled Bengal peaceably and unmolested for ten years, and died in the year 785. A. D. 1383.

SHUMS ADDEEN II.

On the death of Sultan Assulateen, the nobles raised to the throne his adopted son, a youth of very inferior talents, who took the title of Shums Addeen the Second. For little more than two years he enjoyed a tranquil reign; but, at the expiration of that period, Kanis, the Zemindar of Bhetourieh, rebelled against him; and the youth being unsupported by the Mohammedan chiefs, was defeated, and lost his life, in the year 787. A. D. 1385.

RAJA KANIS.

Immediately after the above-mentioned event, the Zemindar, having assumed the title of Raja, advanced to Pundua, where he was greeted by the Hindoos as the Restorer of their Religion, and Sovereign of Bengal; but after being seated on the throne, he found that the Mohammedans in his dominions

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SECT. IV. were so numerous, and so much superior in bravery to his natural subjects, that he judged it requisite to treat them with mildness and affability: he therefore allowed many of the Afghan chiefs to retain their estates, and granted pensions to the learned and devout of that religion. By these means he enjoyed a quiet and peaceable reign of seven years, and died
A. D. 1392. in the year 794.

Raja Kanis had so well ingratiated himself with the Mohammedans, that, after his death, they claimed him as one of the *Faithful*, and disputed with the Hindoos whether his body should be buried according to their rites, or be burned on the funeral pile.

During the reign of Raja Kanis, the city of Pundua was much extended and celebrated in the East, and the temples of idolatry again raised their heads.

CHIETMUL SULTAN JELAL ADDEEN.

Some historians have related, that during the life-time of Raja Kanis, his eldest son, named Chietmul, whilst a boy, was deprived of his *cast* by the celebrated Mohammedan hermit or saint, named Cuttub ul Aalum, throwing the betle-leaf which he had chewed into the child's mouth, and bestowing on him the title of Jelal Addeen (Glory of Religion). Other writers have affirmed, that he was converted after his succession to the throne: but the probability is, that he was the offspring of a Mohammedan concubine; and being the eldest or only son of the Raja, the Hindoos had acquiesced in his elevation to the throne, in order to prevent the evils attending a disputed succession; in which success would have been doubtful, as

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the prince would certainly have been aided by all the Mohammedans, whose numbers and bravery were very formidable. SECT. IV.

Whatever may have been the cause of the prince's abandoning the idolatry of the Hindoos, he proved himself a zealous disciple of the Mussulman faith; for having invited the celebrated Shaikh Zahed from Sunergong, he consulted him on all his spiritual affairs, and resigned his conscience to his direction.

Jelal Addeen removed again the seat of government from Pundua to Gour, and expended large sums of money in improving that city. The mosque, baths, reservoir, and caravanserai, distinguished by the name of Jelally*, were all constructed by him. This prince ruled with great equity and justice; and, after an undisturbed reign of eighteen years, died at Gour, in the year 812. A. D. 1409.

To persons unacquainted with the history of India, it may appear extraordinary, that the Sovereigns of Bengal should have remained for so many years undisturbed in their possession of that country; but upon a reference to the History of Hindoostan, it will be discovered that during the period above mentioned the empire of Dehly was torn to pieces by an ambitious aristocracy, and that the Emperor retained little more than the name. It was in such a state of affairs that the celebrated Tartar conqueror, Timour, or Tamerlane, in the year 801, invaded India†; and it is rather surprising that he should have met with any opposition, than that he A. D. 1398.

* Charles Wilkins, LL.D. Librarian to the East-India Company, is about to publish an elegant Set of Engravings of the Ruins of Gour; which will evince the former grandeur of that ancient city, and form a valuable accompaniment to this work.

† See Dow's History, commencement of Vol. II.

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SECT. IV. should so easily have defeated the weak Mohammed the Third, and his pusillanimous Vizier.

The following extract from that History will fully elucidate the subject:—"During the misfortunes and confusion of the empire, the Subahs (Governors) had rendered themselves independent in their governments. Guzerat was seized upon by Azim; Malwa by Dilawer; Kinnouge, Oude, Kurrah, and Joanpore, by Khoja Jehan (commonly called King of the East); Lahore, Debalpore, and Moultan, by Khizer; Samana by Ghalib; Biana by Shums; Mohaba by Mohammed (the son of Mallik and grandson of the Emperor Ferose); and so on with regard to the other provinces: the Governors asserting their own independence, and styling themselves (Mulook) Kings."

AHMED SHAH.

Ahmed Shah succeeds to the throne—His territory invaded by Sultan Ibrahim of Joanpore—Solicits the protection of the Court of Herat—Extract from Shah Rookh's Letter, prohibiting Sultan Ibrahim from molesting the King of Bengal—The Tartar Monarch sends an Ambassador to the Court of Gour, who is afterwards shipwrecked on the Coast of Malibar.

A.D. 1409. THE oldest of Jelal Addeen's sons succeeded, in the year 812, to the throne, without any opposition. He walked in the footsteps of his father, and administered justice to his subjects with impartiality; insomuch that the followers of Mohammed and the worshippers of idols vied in their attachment to his person.

During the reign of this prince, Sultan Ibrahim of

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Joanpore* invaded Bengal with a numerous army, and, after plundering several of the districts, carried away many of the inhabitants as slaves. Ahmed Shah finding himself unable to contend with so formidable an adversary, whose power, in fact, exceeded that of the feeble representative of monarchy at Dehly, sent an ambassador to Shah Rookh, the son of Timour, who, although residing at Herat (in Persia), was considered as the Emperor of Hindoostan, to solicit his protection and interference.

The ambassador was received by the Tartar monarch with much honour; and on his taking leave, was accompanied by Abdul Kereem Hajy, who was furnished with a letter to Sultan Ibrahim, threatening him with the most exemplary vengeance if he did not immediately release all the captives, and peremptorily prohibiting him from ever again molesting the King of Bengal.

Sultan Ibrahim received the letter with much respect; and whether from dread of Shah Rookh's vengeance, or being constantly occupied by his contests with the neighbouring Chiefs, never afterwards invaded Bengal.—As the Letter is a curious specimen of the pompous style of the East, it is here subjoined.

Extract of the Emperor SHAH ROOKH'S *Letter to Sultan* IBRAHIM SHEREKY *of Joanpore.*

"As soon as this mandate (to which the whole world is "subject, and the universe obedient) shall arrive, in the space "of one day, collect all the *Mohammedan* captives, and other "persons belonging to that country (Bengal); and having

* The Court of Joanpore, during the forty years' reign of Sultan Ibrahim, far eclipsed that of Dehly, and was the resort of all the learned men of the East.

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SECT. IV.

" delivered them over to their respective lords, procure a cer-
" tificate of the fact, signed and sealed by the Cazies: and send
" it immediately to the foot of the Imperial throne. And be
" assured, that if you use any delay, or are in the smallest
" degree neglectful of this order, We will issue our Imperial
" mandate to our most illustrious son Sultan Mahmood, King
" of Cabul, and to our Governors of Khotelan, of Ghiznē, Kan-
" dahar, and Gurmseir, to proceed (to India), and so severely
" punish you, that it shall serve as an example for others. If
" this shall not be sufficient, We will issue our orders to our
" General, Ferose Shah, to march with the armies of Khorassan,
" and inflict vengeance on you. And if this shall not suffice,
" We will send our mandate to our most noble son Shums
" Addeen Mohammed, to advance with the troops of Arhung,
" Pyrai, Kund-Diz, and Bakelan, to chastise you. If this shall
" have no effect, We will direct our brave and victorious son
" Bayestegur Behadur to march with the forces of Babul, Sary,
" Mazinderan, Tubberistan, Gorickē, and Jilan; and thus render
" you sensible of your crimes and impotence. But if you still
" continue to persevere in your atrocious conduct, We will
" command our august son Sultan Ibrahim to move with the
" armies of Irac, Azerbijan, Bagdad, and the districts of Arabia,
" to separate your soul from its body. And if they shall not be
" able to effect this our purpose, We will signify our Royal will
" to our most beloved and victorious son Ulug Beg Goorgan,
" to proceed with all the squadrons of Toorkistan, and either tear
" you to pieces, or hang up your body to be eaten by the crows*."

* *N. B.* The Letter is taken from Ferishtah; but the circumstances of the Embassy are confirmed in the *Mutlia Assaedine*, a very elegant Persian History of Shah Rookh, presented to the East-India Company by General Kirkpatrick.

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SECT. IV.

In return for this compliment, the Tartar monarch despatched Molana Abdul Reheem as his ambassador to the Court of Gour. After a residence of some months in Bengal, the ambassador having been joined by Abdul Kereem Hajy from Joanpore, proceeded by sea towards Ormuz; but on their arrival on the coast of Malibar, they were shipwrecked in the vicinity of Calicut, where they were hospitably received and entertained by the Zamorin, who, in consequence of their representation of the magnificence and power of Shah Rookh, was induced to send an envoy along with them to the Court of Herat.

It was to repay this compliment, that Shah Rookh sent, in the year of the Hejira 846, the celebrated Malolana Abdul Rezac to Calicut, whence he was invited to Bijenagur; of which kingdom he has given a minute and entertaining account in the *Mutlia Assaedine*†. A. D. 1442.

Nothing more interesting occurs in the history of the reign of Ahmed Shah, which lasted eighteen years, and was terminated by his death in the year 830. A. D. 1426.

NASIR SHAH.

Ahmed Shah not having left any son to inherit his dominions, one of his slaves, named Nasir, seized upon the government; but the other Chiefs, disdaining to submit to his authority, at the end of eight days put him to death, and raised to the throne a youth who was a descendant of Ilyas A.D. 1426-7.

† An interesting account of this Embassy may be found in the *Annual Asiatic Register* of 1800.

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SECT. IV. Khaje Sultan Shums Addeen Bhengara*, on whom they
A. D. 1426-7. conferred the title of Nasir Shah.

On the unexpected elevation of this prince to the sovereignty, all the adherents of the Bhengara family, and many other zealous Mohammedans, who during the reigns of the Hindoo dynasty had lived in retirement, now assembled round the throne, and gave to it such stability, that Nasir Shah enjoyed a long and undisturbed reign.

This prince constructed the fortifications round the City of Gour; the gates of which are still in existence; and the foundations have been traced over its whole circumference†.

A. D. 1457-8. Nasir Shah departed this life in the year 862.

BARBEK SHAH.

NASIR Shah was succeeded by his son Barbek Shah, who was esteemed a man of great abilities. He was the first prince in Hindoostan who introduced Abyssinian and negro slaves into his service. He at one period had eight thousand of them, well mounted and armed, in his army: and having by experience found them faithful and attached to him, he promoted several of them to high rank and important situations. His example was afterwards imitated by the sovereigns of Guzerat and the Dekkan; and many of those people, who, if they had fallen

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* See p. 83.

† A correct Plan of the City is deposited in the East-India House; and will probably be given to the public by Dr. Wilkins, along with the Engravings of the Ruins of Gour, mentioned in p. 95.

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into the hands of Europeans, would have been condemned to servile drudgery, became the associates of Princes and Governors of provinces. SECT. IV.

Barbek Shah died in 879, after a prosperous reign of seventeen years; and was succeeded by his eldest son, Yusuf Shah. A. D. 1474.

YUSUF SHAH.

As soon as this prince had taken possession of the throne, he established rules for the strict administration of justice throughout his dominions: and having summoned the judges and municipal officers to attend him, he informed them that the laws were to be administered with impartiality to the poor and to the rich, to the weak and to the powerful; and if he discovered any of them swayed in their decisions, either by interest or affection, he would punish them most severely. He then ordered them to send him a weekly report of their proceedings; and being himself very learned, and well informed in the law, he frequently decided on points which had perplexed the most experienced Cazies and Moofties. After having reigned with much reputation for seven years and six months, he departed this life in the year 887. A. D. 1482.

Yusuf Shah dying without children, the nobles raised to the throne a youth of the royal family, named Sekunder Shah; but after two months, finding him incapable of governing, they deposed him, and placed on the throne his uncle, Futteh Shah.

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SECT. IV.
A. D. 1472-3.

FUTTEH SHAH.

THIS prince is said to have been possessed of a good natural understanding, which he much improved by study: and finding that the Abyssinian slaves, and the eunuchs of the palace, during the reigns of his predecessors, had gained too much influence, and had been guilty of improper practices, he punished some of them severely, and reduced them all to a level with his other servants and subjects. This conduct of the King's gave much offence to the eunuchs; they seduced the corps of guards called Paiks, (infantry, armed with swords and spears,) 5000 of whom daily mounted guard over the palace; and one night murdered their master in the Seraglio, or female apartments, which their confidential situation in the interior of the palace enabled them to effect without immediate discovery.

It was the custom of the Court of Bengal, that the old guard should wait till the King mounted the throne in the morning; and after having saluted his Majesty, to march off, and give place to the new guard. The morning after the murder, the Paiks waited some time for the approach of the King; and either were, or pretended to be, much surprised to see the chief eunuch, Bareek, ascend the throne, dressed in the royal robes.

It happened at this period that both the Vizier, Khan Jehan, and Mulk Andiel, the Abyssinian Commander-in-chief, were detached from the capital, to wage war against some refractory Rajas; and there were no troops left in the city but the Paiks; the commanders of whom having been previously bribed, the

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eunuch was proclaimed without opposition, under the title of Sultan Shahzadeh. This event happened in the year 896. SECT. IV. A. D. 1490-1.

The reign of Futteh Shah was seven years and six months.

SULTAN SHAHZADEH.

Shahzadeh promotes the Eunuchs—Employs the former Vizier, and Mulk Andiel the Commander-in-chief, under an oath of fidelity—His servants corrupted by the latter, who, with his companions, gains admittance by night into the private apartments, and, after much resistance, murders the Usurper—The Widow of Futteh Shah declines the proposal to elevate her infant Son to the throne—Mulk Andiel unanimously elected sovereign.

SULTAN Shahzadeh immediately promoted a number of his companions, the eunuchs, to the most important commands; and filled all the offices with persons of the lowest description; supposing that they would be more attached to his government than the nobility or persons of good family. But not thinking himself sufficiently established in his authority without the concurrence of Khan Jehan the Vizier, and Mulk Andiel the Commander-in-chief, he offered to confirm them in their employments if they would take the oath of fealty to him: and these officers, thinking it would be better to temporize, and wait for a favourable opportunity of destroying him, than by opposing him openly, returned to Court, and were received with much apparent cordiality.

During many months, these officers conducted themselves with so much circumspection, that, although the eunuch had established a very severe police, and placed spies over their houses, he could receive no intelligence of their harbouring any evil intentions against him: he therefore admitted them

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SECT. IV. A.D. 1491.

into the greatest degree of favour, and reposed entire confidence in them. This confidence was however misplaced; for Mulk Andiel, having gained over to his party one of his countrymen, an Abyssinian eunuch, who had charge of the sleeping apartments, was admitted one night into the palace with twenty of his companions; when the Sultan, having dressed himself in female attire, and put on all his jewels, had seated himself on the throne, and indulged freely in the pleasures of music and wine. At a late hour of the night, after the Sultan had fallen asleep in a state of inebriety, and as soon as the attendants retired, the black eunuch extinguished all the lights except one, and admitted Mulk Andiel into the room.

It appears, that when Mulk took the oath of allegiance, he had sworn that as long as the Sultan should fill the throne he would never be guilty of any aggression against him, but support and defend him: when therefore he saw the Sultan sitting on the throne, his conscience upbraided him with the treachery he was about to commit. He stood for some time, with his sword drawn, hesitating what to do: at length the Sultan, in a fit of intoxication, fell on the floor; and the mental reservation of the assassin being now satisfied, he struck him with his sword. The blow, however, only served to rouse the Sultan, who starting up, and being a very powerful man, seized Mulk Andiel in his arms, and threw him on the ground. In this situation, Mulk called to his companions to come to his assistance. Yugrish Khan, a Turk, and two Abyssinians, immediately entered: but during the struggle between the Sultan and Mulk Andiel, the light was extinguished, and Yugrish knew not whom to assist, or whom

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he was to strike. At length, Mulk Andiel, who had fast hold of the eunuch's long hair, and would not let him escape, called out to strike without fear, as he was undermost, and was well shielded by the corpulence of his adversary. On this intelligence, Yugrish Khan gave the Sultan several cuts, which so hurt him, that he fell on the ground, and pretended to be dead. SECT. IV. A. D. 1491.

Mulk Andiel, supposing he had effected his purpose, retired with his party: but after they were gone, the black eunuch, having entered the apartment with a light, and seeing the Sultan in that situation, called out, in counterfeited agony, that some traitor had cruelly murdered his lord and master. The Sultan, who, on the entrance of the eunuch, had imagined it was Mulk Andiel returned to finish his business, was much rejoiced to hear the voice of his supposed faithful servant; and, making him a signal to be quiet, narrated to him all the circumstances that had occurred; after which he desired him to go to certain officers, and to give them positive orders to proceed immediately to the house of Mulk Andiel, and bring with them his head.

The eunuch, having promised implicit obedience, went to Mulk Andiel, and informed him that he had left his design unaccomplished; and that if he did not finish it, his own existence would very shortly be terminated.

Mulk Andiel, seeing he had now no hopes of safety but in perpetrating the murder, returned to the Sultan's apartments, and in a few minutes finished the atrocious deed. He then sent for Khan Jehan the Vizier, and consulted with him what further was requisite to be done. The Vizier was of opinion that it would be proper to place on the throne the

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SECT. IV. infant son of Futteh Shah (then only two years of age), and
A. D. 1491. that a person should be nominated to administer the affairs of government during his minority. Mulk Andiel having acquiesced in this proposal, he immediately summoned all the other chiefs; and on his obtaining their assent, they all repaired to the apartments of the widow of Futteh Shah, where, in a respectful manner, they informed her of their determination; and requested her to nominate a proper person to be the guardian of her child.

The widow, alarmed at the invidious situation in which the nomination of a regent might place her, and reflecting on the distant prospect of her son succeeding quietly to the throne in so unstable a government, replied, that, on the murder of her husband, she had made a vow to God, that whatever person revenged his death should have her suffrage to be King.

This sentiment was probably expected by the chiefs; and Mulk Andiel, although an Abyssinian slave, was unanimously elected to be their monarch.

The reign of the eunuch Sultan Shahzadeh was barely eight months.

SULTAN FEROSE SHAH HEBSHY.

A. D. 1491. WHEN the Abyssinian, Mulk Andiel, was elected to the sovereignty of Bengal, he assumed the title of Ferose Shah, and governed his subjects with strict justice and munificent liberality.

As Mulk Andiel, during the long period that he had served in the armies of Barbek Shah and Futteh Shah, had frequently given proofs of his valour and skill in war, and was well

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supported by a numerous body of his own countrymen, and beloved for his generosity by the common people and soldiery, none of the Afghan or Turkish chiefs dared to rebel against him.

The following anecdote of his liberality is thus related. On some public occasion, the King having ordered a Lac (100,000) of rupees to be distributed to the poor, the ministers thought he was too profuse of the public treasure, which might probably arise from his little knowledge of the value of money, or of the amount he had ordered: they therefore piled the money in one of the apartments through which he was to pass, in hopes that he would notice it, and be surprised at the quantity of silver. When the King entered the apartment, and saw the heap of money lying there, he asked what it was; and on being told it was the sum he had that morning ordered to be given to the poor, he said, "Is this all? it is too little: give them double the quantity." The ministers were astonished at his prodigality, but were obliged to conform to his wishes.

The remains of a mosque, a minaret, and a reservoir, which Ferose Shah constructed, are still to be seen at Gour.—He reigned nearly three years, and died in 899. A. D. 1494.

MAHMOOD SHAH.

When Ferose Shah departed from this transitory world, the nobles raised to the throne his eldest son, with the title of Mahmood Shah; but the Vizier, Hebsh Khan, originally an Abyssinian slave, left to his master nothing but the name of King. This conduct gave much offence to the other

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SECT. IV. Abyssinians; and, under pretence of relieving the prince from a galling yoke, one of them, named Siddee Budder Dewaneh, assassinated the Vizier: and having thus mounted the first stage of the ladder of ambition, he shortly after murdered the King, and ascended the throne.

The period of Mahmood Shah's nominal reign was one year.

Hajy Mohammed Candahary has stated, in his History, that Mahmood Shah was not an Abyssinian, but the infant son of Futteh Shah, whose pretensions his mother had resigned in favour of Mulk Andiel, as has been before related.

MUZUFFIR SHAH.

SIDDEE BUDDER DEWANEH mounted the throne in the year
A. D. 1495. 900, and assumed the title of Muzuffir Shah. He commenced his reign with the murder of several of the Turkish nobility. He afterwards marched his armies against some of the tributary Hindoo princes; and having seized them, put them to death, and plundered their estates. In short, there was no species of cruelty or oppression that this tyrant did not commit: till at
A. D. 1497-8. length, in the year 903, all the chiefs, headed by the Vizier, Syed Hussein Sherief of Mecca, rebelled against him, and besieged him in his capital; but Muzuffir Shah, having in his service a corps of 5000 well-mounted Abyssinians, and 25,000 Afghan and Bengal troops, defended the city of Gour for four months with great resolution: and whenever he made prisoners of any of the rebels, he took pleasure in beheading them himself. The number of persons he is said to have put to death in this manner is incredible.

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At length, thinking himself able to contend with his adversaries in the field, he marched out of the city and engaged them. A bloody battle ensued, in which Muzuffir Shah lost his life, and the plains of Gour were strewed with 20,000 of the slain. The reign of this oppressor of the human race was three years and five months.

Such is the account of this event given by Hajy Mohammed Candahary, in his History; but Nizam Addeen states, that Muzuffir Shah, being universally detested by the nobles, the Vizier, Syed Hussein, entered into a conspiracy with them; and having gained over to their party the Commandant of the corps of Paiks, sixteen of them entered the apartment of the tyrant at night, and put him to death without any opposition. One of the mosques still standing at Gour was built by this impious tyrant.

SULTAN ALA ADDEEN HUSSEIN SHAH SHERIEF MECCA.

Ala Addeen elevated to the throne—His origin—Permits Gour to be plundered by his own army—Regulates the troops, and firmly establishes his government—Successfully invades the Kingdom of Assam—Attempts the conquest of Kamroop and adjoining countries—The Rajas retire to their mountain-fastnesses till the rainy season, when the Sultan's forces are obliged to retire with immense loss—The Sultan applies himself to the improvement of his Kingdom—Erects many public buildings, and encourages the Learned and Devout—The King of Joanpore seeks refuge at the Court of Bengal—The Emperor Sekunder subdues Behar, and prepares for the invasion of Bengal—Ala Addeen sends his son with terms of Peace, and a treaty is concluded—Dies, after a peaceable reign of twenty-four years.

On the death of the Abyssinian, Muzuffir Shah, the chiefs elected to the throne another foreigner, but of a more noble A. D. 1489.

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SECT. IV.

race. This person was a descendant of the Prophet Mohammed, and had quitted the sandy deserts of Arabia to improve his fortune in the fertile region of Bengal. His illustrious descent first introduced him into the Court of Gour, where his superior abilities soon raised him to the high dignity of first subject of the empire. The oppressions and brutal temper of Muzuffir made him a rebel, and fortune made him a king.

As Syed Hussein, during the period that he acted as prime-minister to his predecessor, had given many proofs of his abilities and general benevolence, all the chiefs, of whatever tribe, concurred in opinion that he was the most worthy person to fill the throne; and he, in return, granted them the extraordinary privilege of plundering the city of Gour for a prescribed period*.

On his elevation to the throne, he is said to have taken the title of Ala Addeen Sherief Mecca: but the author of the *Ryaz Assulateen* states, that, in all the inscriptions on the monuments about Gour, he is styled Hussein Shah; and supposes that his father, or some of his ancestors, might have been Sherief of Mecca; and that the son, through family pride, may have used the title improperly. It is however certain, that, on his first arrival in Bengal, he was for some time in a very humble situation; but the Cazy of Chandpore, having been informed of his illustrious descent, gave him his daughter in marriage, and introduced him into the service of Muzuffir Shah.

The privilege of plundering the city having been carried

* The rich inhabitants of Gour being principally Hindoos, the pious Syed thought they were fair plunder, although his own subjects. This may be considered as a specimen of a bigoted Mohammedan government.

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further than the Syed intended, he ordered the soldiery, after some days, to desist; but finding his orders disobeyed, he caused twelve thousand of them to be put to death, and seized all the fruits of their rapine.

At that period it was customary, amongst the rich inhabitants of Bengal, to have a number of golden dishes on their tables; and the degree of respect due to any person was estimated by the quantity of plate he displayed upon public occasions: on which account, the quantity of gold and silver regorged by the plunderers is said to have been immense.

One of the first acts of Ala Addeen's government was to reduce the corps of Paiks †, who had so frequently assisted in dethroning their Sovereigns: after which he raised a regiment, denominated *Serhungs*, to mount guard over his person. He also dismissed the whole of the Abyssinian troops: and they, having lost their reputation in Hindoostan by their frequent acts of disloyalty and treachery, could not obtain service either at Joanpore or Dehly, and were therefore compelled to proceed to Guzerat and the Dekkan, where they procured employment, and afterwards became very conspicuous, under the appellation of Siddees ‡.

After these arbitrary but salutary acts, Ala Addeen ruled with strict justice; but, for the better security of his person, he made the Fort of Akdala the seat of his residence. Being himself of noble descent, he encouraged and patronised persons

† A number of the descendants of these Paiks were settled in the Midnapore district; and had lands assigned to them, on condition of defending the country against all invaders and marauders: but the English Government not requiring their services, and wishing to put them on a footing with their other subjects, they were much dissatisfied for a considerable period, and caused frequent disturbances between the years 1790 and 1800.

‡ See Orme's *Historical Fragments*, Index.

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SECT. IV. of good family, and reduced some of the upstarts of the late reigns to their original nothingness. Having by these means introduced a number of Syeds, Moghuls, and Afghans into his service, his government became firmly established; and the tributary Rajas, as far as Orissa, paid implicit obedience to his commands; nor was there a single rebellion or insurrection during his reign.

The Sultan, after regulating his own kingdom, began to aspire to foreign conquests. He, in consequence, assembled a numerous army, and invaded the kingdom of Assam, situated to the north-east of Bengal. Having overrun that country, and acquired much plunder, he turned his arms against the Rajas of Kamroop, and the countries lying at the foot of the northern mountains, distinguished by the general name of Turryana; and, on taking possession of many of their forts, established garrisons therein: after which, having appointed his son to be Governor of the conquered districts, he returned to his capital.

Kamroop again unsuccessfully invaded.

It has ever been the systematic policy of the princes of Turryana to relinquish the level country to the invaders, and retire with their families and effects to fastnesses in the mountains, until the setting in of the rains; when, the roads being rendered impassable for an army by inundation and torrents from the hills, they cut off all supplies of provisions, and either starve their opponents into a capitulation, or force them to retreat under the greatest disadvantages.

This system was now put in practice; and the son of the Sultan was compelled to make a humiliating retreat, with the loss of half his army.

After this unsuccessful attempt, the Sultan built an extensive

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fort on the banks of the Bettiah River (the Gunduk), to defend his own territories from invasion; and occupied himself in promoting the population of his country, and in improving the situation of his subjects. He built public mosques and hospitals in every district, and settled pensions on the learned and devout. Amongst the numerous instances of his piety, he settled a grant of lands for the support of the Tomb, College, and Hospital of the celebrated saint Kuttub al Aalum, which are continued to this day; and every year made a pilgrimage on foot, from Akdala to Pundua, to visit the holy shrine of that saint. SECT. IV.

In the early part of this reign, Shah Hussein, king of Joanpore, who for many years contended for the empire of Hindoostan with Sultan Beloli*, having suffered reiterated defeats, fled before the arms of Sekunder, and sought protection in Bengal. He was most hospitably and honourably received by Ala Addeen, who assigned him a pension and establishment suitable to his former dignity, which were continued to him during his life. The tomb of this prince is still in good preservation in the vicinity of Gour.

The Emperor Sekunder having, in the year 905, subdued the province of Behar, which for several years had been dependent on Joanpore, and was the last of the possessions of the Kings of the East, advanced the banners of hostility against Bengal; but on his arrival at Tuglickpore (or Cutlickpore) in Behar, he was informed that the Prince Daniel, son of Ala Addeen, was on the way to meet him, with overtures of amity from his father. The Emperor, being also desirous of peace, A.D. 1499.

* See *History of Hindoostan*, A.D. 1478.

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SECT. IV. A. D. 1499. that he might be enabled to return to Dehly, halted at this place, and sent forward two noblemen to meet and confer with the prince.

The plenipotentiaries met in the town of Bar; and in a few days concluded a treaty, the terms of which were, that the Emperor should retain Behar, Tirhoot, Sircar Sarun, and all the other countries he had subdued, provided he did not invade Bengal; and that neither party should support, or in any manner assist, the enemies of the other. This treaty having been ratified by both monarchs, the Emperor returned towards Dehly. After this event, Ala Addeen enjoyed a peaceable and happy reign, beloved by his subjects, and respected A. D. 1520. by his neighbours; and died at Gour in the year 927, having reigned twenty-four years.

NUSSERIT SHAH, *commonly called* NASEEB SHAH.

Nusserit Shah elected to the throne—Humane conduct to his Brothers—Invades Tirhoot and Hajypore—Gives protection to Mahmood Lody and other Afghan Chiefs—Marries the Daughter of the late Sultan Ibrahim—Excites the jealousy of the Moghul Emperor Baber—Mahmood, and the Afghan Chiefs, defeated by Baber—On the death of the Moghul Emperor, the Afghan Chiefs recover several provinces—Nusserit assassinated—Buildings erected by him at Gour.

A. D. 1521. THE deceased King left eighteen sons; the eldest of whom, Nusserit Shah, being a person of acknowledged bravery and superior talents, was chosen by the Chiefs to be their monarch. As a proof of the benevolence of his disposition, it is stated, that instead of confining his brethren, or depriving them of their sight, as is the common custom of the East, he treated them

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with the greatest affection, and doubled the allowances granted them by their father. SECT. IV.

The distracted state of the Court of Dehly, occasioned by the approach of the Moghuls, under the celebrated Baber, presenting a favourable opportunity of recovering some of the districts which had formerly belonged to Bengal, Nusserit Shah broke the treaty which his father had contracted with the Emperor Sekunder; and having invaded Tirhoot, and put the Raja to death, he appointed his son-in-law, Ala Addeen, to the government. He then proceeded against Hajypore; and having subdued it, gave it in charge to another son-in-law, named Mukhdoom Aalum: after which he crossed the Ganges, and took possession of the fort and district of Mongeir, which he entrusted to one of his best generals, named Cuttub Khan.

When, in the year 932, the Emperor Baber defeated and slew Sultan Ibrahim, and the empire of Hindoostan was transferred from the Afghan to the Moghul dynasty*, many of the chiefs of the former nation sought employment and protection in Bengal: even Mahmood Lody, the brother of Sultan Ibrahim, was compelled to seek refuge at the Court of Gour. All these persons were most hospitably received, and had pensions assigned them, suitable to their rank and former situation. A. D. 1526.

Mahmood having brought with him one of the daughters of the late Emperor, the King took her in marriage, and made great rejoicings on the occasion. This circumstance, added to the protection afforded to the Afghan chiefs, excited the jealousy of the Moghul Emperor, Baber, who, in the year 935, sent an army, under the command of his relation Askary, to A. D. 1528-9.

* See *History of Hindoostan*, A. D. 1525-6.

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SECT. IV. invade Bengal; but Nusserit Shah, having obtained timely intelligence of his intentions, sent an ambassador with costly presents, to deprecate the Imperial wrath.

A.D. 1529-30. Early in the year 936, Mahmood (brother of Ibrahim), being previously joined by a number of the Afghan chiefs, made another attempt to recover his paternal dominions, and advanced as far as Hideri on the banks of the Ganges.

The Emperor Baber having about the same time marched from Agra, the contending armies met at Hideri; but such was the dread the Afghans had of Baber's prowess, and the formidable charge of the Moghul cavalry, that, as soon as the Emperor's advanced guard crossed the river, they shamefully took to flight, and never halted till they had re-crossed the river Soane. Mahmood, dispirited by his defeat, retreated to Bengal; and Nusserit, alarmed at the approach of the Moghuls, sent an ambassador to implore the Emperor's mercy.

As the rainy season was approaching, and the affairs of the upper provinces required the presence of Baber, who had advanced as far as the town of Mooneer (at the mouth of the Soane), he graciously condescended to make peace, on condition that the Afghans should remain quiet, and that the King of Bengal should no longer give any assistance to Mahmood. These terms having been ratified by both monarchs, the Emperor returned to Agra, where he died in the month of

A.D. 1530-1. Jummad of the following year, A. H. 937.

The death of Baber served as a signal to rouse the Afghan chiefs once more to attempt the recovery of the empire. Mahmood, the son of Diria Lohani, took possession of Behar; and Mahmood, the brother of the Emperor Ibrahim, having collected an army of his countrymen, first defeated Joneid Burlass

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the Moghul governor of Joanpore, and then took possession of that province. Sultan Behadur of Guzerat also advanced at the head of a large force, and took the fort of Mindu, whence he detached an army of 40,000 men to plunder the country, even to the vicinity of Agra, then the residence of the new Emperor Homayon. SECT. IV.

Although the King of Bengal, from the pusillanimity of his disposition, did not take an active part in these scenes, yet, regardless of his treaty with the Emperor Baber, he gave every assistance in his power to Mahmood; and in the year 939 sent Mulk Murjan, as his ambassador, to form a treaty of alliance with Sultan Behadur of Guzerat. A. D. 1533-3.

Notwithstanding Nusserit Shah was by descent a Syed (descendant of Mohammed), he was naturally of a cruel disposition; and was frequently guilty of such acts of tyranny, as not only to give disgust to his subjects, but to render him hateful to his private servants. At length, having gone one day to pay his devotions at the tomb of his father in the city of Gour, and one of the eunuchs having given him some offence, he threatened severely to punish the fellow on his return to the palace; but the other eunuchs, tired out with his brutal behaviour, espoused the cause of their companion, and, before the king could carry his threats into execution, they put a period to his existence.

Nusserit Shah reigned thirteen years, and was assassinated in the year 940. Some historians have assigned him a reign of sixteen years, and say his death occurred in 943; but this statement does not agree with the account of subsequent transactions. Of the buildings erected by him in the city of Gour, there are still two remaining, with the inscriptions A. D. 1533-4.

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SECT. IV. perfect; viz. the Golden Mosque, called, in the Hindoostany language, *Soona Musjid*, finished in 932; and the *Kuddum Roosul* (Footstep of the Prophet), erected in 939.

Ferishtah, in his History of Bengal, styles this prince Nuseeb Shah; though, in his History of Dehly, he gives him his proper name. This circumstance induced the author of the *Ryaz Assulateen* to examine several of the inscriptions in the vicinity of Gour; from which he ascertained, that the title at full length was Sultan Nusserit Shah, ben Sultan Ala Addeen, Hussein Shah. The tomb of the saint Hezerut Mukhdoom, at Saad-ullapore*, was also erected by him, and bears the same inscription.

After Nusserit Shah had drunk the sherbet of death, the nobles raised to the throne of Bengal his son Ferose Shah; but at the end of three months the youth was murdered by his uncle, Mahmood Shah, who usurped the government.

MAHMOOD SHAH

A.D. 1533-4 WAS one of the eighteen sons of Sultan Ala Addeen; and during the whole reign of the late King, conducted himself in the most exemplary manner: but scarcely was his brother deposited in the tomb, when he entered into machinations against his nephew, and ceased not till he had imbrued his hands in murder. This flagitious conduct did not however pass unrevenged; for Mukhdoom Aalum, governor of Hajypore, raised the standards of rebellion, and united himself in

* There is still an annual assemblage of devotees held at this tomb, which is also attended by merchants and traders, and a regular fair thereby established.

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the bonds of friendship with the celebrated Shere Khan, who afterwards became Emperor of Hindoostan, and who at that time was Regent of Behar.

Mahmood Shah, in order to punish Shere for the assistance afforded to the rebel, ordered Cuttub Khan, governor of Mongeir, to invade Behar. As the forces of Shere were inferior to those of Bengal, Cuttub Khan flattered himself with an easy conquest: he therefore rejected all overtures for peace, and made a spirited attack on the army of Behar. But Fortune did not favour his wishes: he was shortly pierced by an arrow, and fell from his elephant. On seeing this accident, his army fled; and the whole of his elephants, artillery, and baggage, became the plunder of his adversary.

This defeat was a severe disappointment to the King of Bengal: he however assembled a more numerous army, the command of which he entrusted to Ibrahim Khan, the son of the unfortunate General.

At this time, an event occurred which flattered the vanity of the King of Bengal, and gave him every reason to hope for success. Jellal, the young King of Behar, disgusted with the overbearing and insolent conduct of the Regent Shere, fled from Behar, attended by a number of his followers, and took refuge in the Bengal camp, whence he sent orders to all his adherents to afford no manner of assistance to Shere.

This event having much diminished the force of the Regent, he was obliged to shut himself in the fort of Behar; the fortifications of which were only ramparts composed of mud.

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† For the history of Shere Shah, see *Dow's Hindoostan*, vol. II. p. 166. The year inserted in the margin is erroneous.

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SECT. IV.

The Bengal army advanced, and surrounded the fort; but the Afghan troops of Shere defended the place with so much resolution, that, after a siege of several months, Ibrahim was obliged to apply to the King for a reinforcement. Previous however to its arrival, Shere, having made a sally from the fort, completely defeated the Bengalese, slew their General, and seized on all their artillery and baggage, compelling the young King Jellal to flee, and seek refuge at the Court of Gour.

A. D. 1535-6. This event occurred in the end of the year 942.

From this period may be dated the downfall of the Empire of Bengal; for in the following year, 943, Shere Khan, having acquired possession of the strong fortress of Chunar, rendered himself completely master of all Behar; after which he advanced with a numerous army towards Bengal. The natural strength of the passes of Terriagurry and Sicklygully delayed the fate of Mahmood for a short period; but Shere having surmounted these difficulties, the King was compelled to retreat to his capital.

Shere immediately invested Gour; but some important affairs requiring his presence at Behar, he left an army, under the command of his general, Khuas Khan, to carry on the blockade.

During this period, Mahmood sent various messengers to the Emperor Homayon, to implore his speedy assistance; but several months having elapsed without any appearance of the Moghul forces, and provisions becoming very scarce in the city, Mahmood Shah embarked on board a fast-rowing boat, and was conveyed to Hajypore.

The city soon after capitulated, and on the 13th of the

A. D. 1537. month *Fervurdy*, in the year 944, was taken possession of by

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the Afghan forces, who plundered and put to death a number of the unoffending inhabitants*. SECT. IV. A. D. 1537-8.

The King was so closely pursued by a party of Shere's troops, that he was obliged to halt, and defend himself. He was soon wounded; but his friends covering his retreat, he was enabled to continue his flight, and arrived in the Moghul camp during the period that the Emperor Homayon was besieging the fort of Chunar.

Homayon, touched with the misfortunes of the royal fugitive, received him in the most gracious manner; and promised that, as soon as he had taken the fortress, he would proceed to Bengal, and reinstate him in his kingdom.

Early in the year 945, the Emperor, having succeeded in taking the fort of Chunar, advanced towards Bengal; and hearing that Shere Khan was busily employed in fortifying the strong passes of Terriagurhy and Sicklygully, the flanks of which are covered on one side by the rapid current of the Ganges, and on the other by lofty mountains, he sent forward a considerable force, under the command of Jehangire Cooly Beg, to clear the road; but this officer, upon his arrival at Terriagurhy, found that, in addition to formidable entrenchments, he had to contend with a numerous army of Afghans, commanded by Jellal, the son of Shere Khan. A. D. 1538-9.

Not dispirited by such difficulties, Jehangire made an attack upon the entrenchments; but after losing a number of men, he

* In the History of Faria de Souza, it is related, that the unfortunate monarch had made application for assistance to Nuno de Cuna, the Governor-general of the Portuguese settlements in India, who sent a squadron of nine ships to his aid; but they did not arrive in Bengal till after the surrender of the city. This was the first introduction of the Portuguese into Bengal, as a military power; although some of their ships had entered the Ganges as early as A.D. 1517.

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SECT. IV. was himself severely wounded, and compelled to retreat towards the main army.

The Emperor, irritated at such unexpected opposition, advanced hastily towards the passes, vowing vengeance on the garrison; whilst Jellal Khan, alarmed at the approach of the Moghuls, abandoned the entrenchments, and, in a pusillanimous manner, retreated with the whole of his army, to join his father at Gour.

Mahmood, the expelled king of Bengal, who accompanied the army, upon his arrival at Colgong, having heard that the Afghans had murdered his two sons, who were taken prisoners on the capture of his capital, was so affected by the intelligence, that he died after a few days illness.

The reign of this prince, including the period of his expulsion, was five years. The inscription on the Mosque erected by him, and still existing at Saadullapore*, clearly ascertains that he was the son of Sultan Ala Addeen Hussein Shah; although some authors have expressed doubts of his origin. With him terminated the line of independent Kings of Bengal, who ruled that country for two hundred and four years: for although several of the rulers of Gour afterwards assumed the title of King, they were not masters of the whole of the province, nor was their right acknowledged by their contemporaries, and consequently they cannot be considered as absolute sovereigns.

A. D. 1538-9. This event occurred in the year of the Hegira 945.

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* Supposed to be the small Golden Mosque.

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SECT. V.

The Shere Shah Dynasty.

THE Emperor Homayon, having secured the important passes which have been always considered as the keys of Bengal, continued his march to Gour; but Shere Khan, fearing to trust either to its fortifications, or to the bravery of his own troops against the Moghuls, collected all the treasure and valuable effects belonging to the Kings of Bengal†, and retreated, with the whole of his Afghans, by the way of Jarcund, or south-west range of mountains, to his native district of Sehsaram, where in a short time, by a bold and successful stratagem, he rendered himself master of the impregnable and extensive fortress of Rhotas. A. D. 1538-9.

Upon the arrival of the Emperor at Gour, the gates were thrown open, and he was received by the inhabitants with every testimony of joy and satisfaction. Homayon was also much gratified by his easy conquest of so valuable a province.

† Faria de Souza states the amount at sixty millions of gold.

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SECT. V. Orders were immediately issued for the Khutbeh to be read in all the mosques, proclaiming his accession to the kingdom of Bengal: he also directed the name of the city to be changed to *Jennetabad* (the City of Paradise); and, to commemorate the event, ordered a new coinage to be struck, bearing his own titles, and the new name of the city.

The Emperor was, in fact, so much infatuated by his new conquest, that he spent three very important months in luxurious gratifications; during which time his enemies were strengthening themselves in every quarter, and Shere Khan was even making preparations to oppose his return.

Repeated intelligence of the machinations of his enemies at length roused the Emperor from his lethargy; and although it was the height of the rainy season, when the roads of Bengal were covered with water, and the rivers swollen by the torrents from the mountains, he perceived the absolute
A. D. 1539. necessity of returning to Agra. He therefore, in the year 946, appointed Jehangire Cooly Beg governor of Bengal, with five thousand select Moghul cavalry to support his authority; and having with some difficulty crossed the Ganges, proceeded by easy stages towards the western part of his empire.

The Moghul cavalry, unaccustomed to the sultry weather of Bengal, and exposed to constant rains and excessive fatigue, became languid, and perished in great numbers. This circumstance, added to the rebellion of the Emperor's brothers, emboldened Shere Khan, elated by his success against Rhotas, to contend once more for the kingdom of Bengal. He collected the dispersed Afghans from every quarter; and having thrown up entrenchments on the banks of the Currumnassa river, at a place called Chowsar, opposed the further progress of the

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Emperor. For nearly three months, the Moghul army remained in this situation, in a state of inactivity; neither daring to storm the Afghan entrenchments, nor possessing the means of recrossing the Ganges, by which they might have taken another route. Such a state was ruinous to the Emperor's affairs; he therefore readily accepted an overture made by Shere Khan, of sending an agent to settle terms of peace. The pious dervesh Kheleel, preceptor to Shere, became the intermediator. A treaty was drawn out, by which Homayon resigned to Shere Khan the sovereignty of Behar and Bengal, upon condition that he would no longer oppose his march, nor assist his enemies. This treaty having been duly ratified, much rejoicing took place in both camps, but especially among the Moghuls, who were exhausted by continual alarms, and anxious to return to their homes. But the very night on which the treacherous Shere had sworn, by the Koran, not to injure the Moghuls, he suddenly attacked their camp, and, having taken them completely by surprise, slew many of them, and compelled the rest to flee in all directions. SECT. V.

The Emperor, with a few of his friends, escaped by swimming their horses across the Ganges; but eight thousand Moghuls perished in the attempt. This memorable event occurred in the year 946. A. D. 1539.

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SECT. V.

FERID ADDEEN SOOR SHERE SHAH*.

Origin of Shere—He proceeds to Agra—Obtains the Royal grant of his patrimony, the districts of Sehsaram and Tondah—Joins Mahmood, king of Behar—Excites Mahmood's jealousy—Enters the service of the Emperor Baber—Returns to Behar, and, on Mahmood's death, obtains the administration of the government—The young king, Jellal, suspicious of Shere's intentions, flies for protection to Bengal—Shere increases his power by marriage—Submits to the authority of Mahmood, on condition of being allowed to retain part of Behar, and of assisting him against the Emperor Homayon—Betrays Mahmood, by withdrawing his forces previous to the action—Refuses to surrender the fort of Chunar to the Emperor—Takes the fortress of Rhotas by stratagem—Overthrows Homayon, and completes the conquest of Behar and Bengal—Appoints KHIZER KHAN *governor of Bengal—Pursues, and totally defeats the Emperor—Assumes the Imperial titles—Returns from Agra to Gour, and reduces the increasing power of his deputy,* KHIZER KHAN*—Subdivides Bengal into Provinces—His death, character, and public works.*

THE original name of Shere was Ferid. His father was Hussein, of the Soor tribe of the Afghans of Roh, a mountainous country on the confines of India and Persia. When Sultan Beloli placed his foot on the throne of the Indian empire, the grandfather of Shere, Ibrahim, came to Dehly in quest of military service. The original seat of the Afghans

* As the origin and rise of Shere Shah are detailed at considerable length in the History of Hindoostan, it will to some persons appear unnecessary to have inserted it here, and I had determined to omit it; but as many of the readers of this work may not have it in their power to refer to that History, and may be anxious to know the origin of so celebrated a character, it is hoped that, in general, its insertion will not be considered as a work of supererogation.

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was Roh, which, in their language, signifies a mountainous country: it extended, they say, in length, from Sewad and Bijore, to the town of Sui in the dominions of Bukharast; and in breadth, from Hussin to Rabul. This tract, in its fertile valleys, contained many separate tribes; among the number of these was that of Soor, who derive themselves from the Princes of Ghor, whose family held the empire after the extinction of the race of Ghizne. One of the sons of the Ghorian family, whose name was Mohammed Soor, having left his native country, placed himself among the Afghans of Roh, and was the father of the tribe of Soor, which was esteemed the noblest among them.

Ibrahim, the grandfather of Shere, arriving at Dehly, engaged himself in the service of an amyr of the Court of Beloli. When the empire fell to Sekunder the son of Beloli, the noble Jemmal, a chief of high renown, was appointed Governor of Joanpore; and he took Hussein, the son of Ibrahim, in his retinue. He found him a youth of parts; and favoured him so much, that, in a short time, he gave him the districts of Sehsaram and Tondah, in jagier†, for which he was to maintain five hundred horse. Hussein had eight sons: Ferid and Nizam of one mother, of a Patan family: the other sons were born of slaves.

Hussein had no great love for his wife, and he therefore neglected her sons. Ferid, upon this, left his father's house, and enlisted himself a soldier in the service of Jemmal, the governor of Joanpore. Hussein wrote to Jemmal upon this occasion, requesting him to send back his son, that he might be

† A grant or tenure of lands for military or other services.

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SECT. V.

educated. But all that Jemmal could say had no effect upon Ferid. Joanpore, he said, was a better place for instruction than Sehsaram; and he affirmed that he would attend to letters of his own accord. This he did to so much purpose, that he soon could repeat the works of the celebrated poet Sadi, and was, besides, a proficient in all the learning of the country. He, however, employed most of his time in history and poetry, being supported by the liberality of Jemmal.

After three or four years had elapsed, Hussein came to Joanpore; and, by the mediation of friends, the father and son were reconciled. Hussein gave Ferid the charge of his estate, and remained himself at Joanpore. Ferid, when he took leave of his father, said, "That the stability of government "depended on justice; and that it would be his greatest care "not to violate it, either by oppressing the weak, or permitting "the strong to infringe the laws with impunity." When he arrived at his jagier, he actually put this resolution in practice, by rendering justice to the poor, and reducing to order such of his zemindars as opposed his authority. He, by this means, had his revenues punctually paid, and his country well cultivated. His reputation grew apace; for all his actions discovered uncommon genius and resolution.

Hussein coming to visit his estate, was extremely well pleased with the management of his son, and therefore continued him in his office. But the father had a favourite concubine, by whom he had three sons, Soliman, Ahmed, and Mudda; and the old man was extremely fond of her. She told him, that now her son Soliman was grown up, he ought to provide for him. Day after day she continued to teaze Hussein for the superintendency of the pergunnahs for

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Soliman. This gave the old amyr great concern, knowing the superior abilities of Ferid. The son, hearing that the domestic peace of his father was destroyed, by the importunities of his favourite, made a voluntary resignation of his trust, which was accordingly conferred upon Soliman.

Ferid, and his brother Nizam, set out immediately for Agra, and entered into the service of Dowlat, one of the principal omrahs of the Emperor Ibrahim. Ferid, by his good behaviour, soon insinuated himself into his master's affection. Dowlat one day desired him to tell him what he was most desirous to obtain, offering to use his interest with the King in his favour. Ferid replied, that, as his father was now in his dotage, and wholly guided by an artful mistress, who had deprived both him and his brother of their patrimonial inheritance, and had procured their estate for her own spurious offspring, if Dowlat would, therefore, by his interest at Court, procure the royal grant of the estate in his name, he would promise to provide for his father, and maintain five hundred good horse for the service of the empire. Dowlat accordingly preferred this request to the Emperor Ibrahim, who replied, that he must be a bad man indeed who reviled and undermined the interest of his own father. Dowlat retired in silence, and informed Ferid of the answer he had received, but comforted him with a promise of taking another opportunity to urge his request. In the mean time, the father of Ferid died, and Dowlat obtained the Emperor's grant, with which the two brothers set out to Sehsaram with a grand retinue.

Soliman, upon the arrival of his brothers, quitted the country, going off to Mohammed, one of the Afghan family of Soor, and his relation, who held the district of Chond, and

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SECT. V.

kept up a force of 1500 horse, to whom he complained of the behaviour of Ferid. Mohammed told him, that Baber intending to invade Hindoostan, a war between that prince and the Emperor Ibrahim was unavoidable; that therefore, if he should accompany him, when called to the Imperial army, he would endeavour to get him redress. Soliman was too impatient to wait so long in suspense. Mohammed therefore sent a person to Ferid, to treat about a reconciliation. Ferid replied, that he was willing to give his brother a proper share of his father's inheritance, but that he must be excused from parting with any of his power; repeating, at the same time, the old adage, that 'Two swords could never rest in one scabbard.' Soliman would not be satisfied without a share of the government; and therefore nothing was settled between the brothers. This irritated Mohammed so much, that he resolved to compel Ferid to the measures which he himself had proposed. Ferid, being informed of this resolution, began to provide for his own security; but news arriving of the Emperor Ibrahim's defeat and death,

A. D. 1525. the whole country was thrown into confusion; A. H. 932.

Ferid resolved not to lie idle in the midst of the troubles which ensued. He joined Par Khan, the son of Diria Lohani, who had subdued Behar and assumed the royal dignity, under the name of Sultan Mohammed, or Mahmood. As that monarch

Obtains the title of Shere Khan.

was one day on a hunting party, he roused an enormous tiger; which Ferid immediately attacked, and killed with one blow of his sabre. For this bold action, which was done in Mahmood's presence, he was honoured with the title of Shere Khan*. Shere rose gradually to great influence and favour, in Mahmood's

* Shere signifies a lion.

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service. He was even appointed tutor to his son, Jellal. He, in the mean time, requested permission to go to his estate, and was detained there by business till long after his leave of absence had expired. Sultan Mahmood, dissatisfied with this behaviour, reproached him one day, in public, with the breach of promise; and Mohammed of the family of Soor, being present, took that opportunity of accusing him of treasonable designs, and with favouring the interest of Mahmood the son of the Emperor Sekunder†. The Sultan was by this means so incensed against him, that he intimated, at the time, a design to deprive him of his estate, and to confer it upon his brother Soliman, as a just punishment for his offence, and the only thing that could bring him to a proper sense of his duty. SECT. V.

Sultan Mahmood, however, having a great esteem for Shere, against whom nothing was yet proved, laid aside the violent measure to which he was instigated by Mohammed. He nevertheless, by way of alarming Shere, gave orders to his accuser to inquire into his father's estate, and to make an equal division of it among all the brothers. Mohammed, glad of this order, sent one of his servants to Shere, to acquaint him that his brothers, according to the King's commands, were to have their proportionate dividends of the estate, which he had hitherto so unjustly withheld from them. Shere returned for answer, that Mohammed was very much mistaken in this

† The accidental occurrence of three persons of the same name renders this part of the history a little obscure. The first was Mahmood Shah, king of Bengal. The second, Sultan Mahmood, son of a famous general named Diria Lohani, who, in the revolution occasioned by the invasion of Baber, seized upon the province of Behar. The third was of the Royal Afghan family of Lody, and brother of the last Emperor of that dynasty.

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SECT. V.

matter: that there were no hereditary estates in India, as in Ghor, for that all the land belonged to the King, which he disposed of at pleasure: That as he himself had a personal grant of his estate, his brethren were entirely out of the question: That he, however, had already consented to give to his brother Soliman a part of the money and moveables, acording to law.

When the messenger returned with this answer, Mohammed, who was then at Chond, was enraged at so direct a refusal, and raising all his forces, sent them against Shere, under the command of Shadi, his adopted slave, accompanied by Shere's brothers, Soliman and Ahmed. Shadi's orders were to take possession of the country, and to leave a force with Soliman, to protect him in the estate. This resolution being quickly taken, Shere had not time to collect his people; but, upon the first alarm, he wrote to one Malleck, his deputy in the district of Khuaspore Tondah, to harass the enemy with what troops he had, but to avoid an action till he joined him in person. Malleck, desirous of distinguishing himself, gave them battle, and lost his life and the victory. This unexpected disaster weakened Shere so much, that he was in no condition to oppose Mohammed; he therefore abandoned the country, and fled to Juneid Birlass, governor of Currah and Manickpore on the part of the Emperor Baber. He made Birlass a handsome present, was taken into favour, and obtained a body of troops to recover his estates. With these he defeated Mohammed, who fled to the mountains of Rhotas; so that he not only possessed himself of his own territory, but added several other districts to his jagier, which he now professed to hold of the Moghul Emperor, Baber.

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SECT. V.

Having rewarded the Moghuls who had assisted him, he permitted them to return to their master. He, at the same time, levied troops, and was joined by his former friends, who had fled to the hills, which rendered him very formidable in those parts.

Shere, having thus established himself in his estate, performed an act of generosity, which, if it was not intended to deceive the world, does him much honour. He recalled his enemy Mohammed, who had fled; and put him in possession of his former estate. This generous treatment converted his greatest enemy into one of his best friends. Shere, having settled his affairs, left his brother Nizam in charge of his district, and paid a visit to his benefactor, Juneid Birlass, at Currah. Birlass was then going to Agra, and Shere resolved to accompany him thither. He was, upon this occasion, introduced to the Emperor Baber, and attended that prince in his expedition to Chinderi.

After Shere had staid some time in the Moghul camp, and observed their manners and policy, he one day told a friend, that he thought it would be an easy matter to drive those foreigners out of Hindoostan. His friend asked him what reason he had to think so? Shere replied, "That the Emperor "himself, though a man of great parts, was but very little "acquainted with the policy of Hindoostan; and that the "minister, who held the reins of government, would be too "much biassed in favour of his own interest, to mind that "of the public. That therefore, if the Afghans, who were now "at enmity among themselves, could be brought to mutual "concord, the work was completed: and should fortune ever "favour him, he imagined himself equal to the task, however

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SECT. V.

difficult it might at present appear." His friend burst out into a loud laugh, and began to ridicule this vain opinion. Shere, a few days after, had, at the Emperor's table, some solid dishes set before him, and only a spoon to eat with. He called for a knife, but the servants had orders not to supply him with one. Shere, not to lose his dinner, drew his dagger without ceremony, and, cutting up his meat, made a hearty meal, without minding those who diverted themselves at this odd behaviour. When he had done, the Emperor, who had been remarking his manner, turned to Amyr Khalifa, and said, "This "Afghan is not to be disconcerted with trifles, and is likely to "be a great man."

Shere, perceiving by these words that the Emperor had been informed of his private discourse with his friend, fled the camp that night, and went to his own estate. He wrote from thence to his benefactor, Juneid Birlass, that as Mohammed had prevailed on Sultan Mahmood, king of Behar, to send troops against his jagier, he had in haste left the Emperor's camp, without waiting upon him for leave. He, by this means, amused Juneid Birlass, prevented his chastising him, and at the same time made up matters with Mahmood, with whom he became a greater favourite than before.

Sultan Mahmood of Behar, dying a short time after, was succeeded by his son Jellal, a minor. The young prince's mother, the Sultana Dudu, acted as regent, and conferred the principal offices in the government upon Shere. The Sultana dying soon after, the administration fell wholly into the hands of Shere. Mukhdoom Aalum*, the governor of Hajypore, on the part of

Shere becomes Regent of Behar, A. D. 1533-4.

* See page 118.

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Mahmood Shah, king of Bengal, being guilty of some misdemeanor, threw himself under Shere's protection. Mahmood, to revenge this insult, ordered Cuttub, governor of Mongeir, with a great force against Behar. As the forces of Behar were inconsiderable in comparison of those of Bengal, Shere made many overtures for accommodating the differences, but to no effect. Finding no arguments could prevail but the sword, he resolved to stand the unequal encounter: in which his superior skill and bravery acquired him a complete victory. Cuttub was slain, A. D. 1533-4. and all his treasure, elephants, and camp equipage taken, which greatly advanced the political designs of Shere. SECT. V.

After this victory, the chiefs of the Patan tribe of Lohani, the cousins of Jellal the young king of Behar, envying the fortune of Shere, formed a conspiracy to take away his life. Shere discovered the plot, and taxed Jellal with it, who was indeed privy to it, being very jealous of the great influence of his minister. He told the young prince on this occasion, that there was no necessity for taking such a base method of getting disengaged from his servant; for that if he should but once signify his inclination, he was ready to resign that government which he had lately so successfully protected. The prince, either suspecting his sincerity, or being equally suspicious of the other omrahs, would by no means consent to his resignation. This so much disgusted the conspirators, that they took every possible measure to make a breach between the prince and his minister. Shere, finding that he had no security but in maintaining his power by the unlimited use he made of it, justly excited the prince's jealousy to such a pitch, that, one night, the prince, accompanied by his omrahs, fled to Mahmood

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SECT. V. A. D. 1535-6.

of Bengal, and implored his aid to expel Shere, who had usurped his throne*.

Shere, by this event, became lord of all Behar, and grew daily more and more formidable. One Taji was at this time governor of the strong fort of Chunar, which he had held for himself ever since the death of Ibrahim Lody, Emperor of Hindoostan. His wife, Lodi Malleki, who was barren, yet for whom he had a very great affection, being envied by his other wives by whom he had children, they instigated their sons to make away with her: but one of the sons, who had undertaken the murder, missed his blow, and only inflicted a slight wound. Taji, alarmed by her cries, came to her assistance, and drew his sword to kill his son. The son, seeing no means of escape, assaulted his father, and slew him. The sons of Taji were yet too young to be entrusted with the government; and Lodi Malleki drew the reins into her own hands, by her address among the chiefs and zemindars. Shere, informed of these transactions, set a treaty of marriage on foot with Lodi Malleki, which was soon concluded. Shere by these means obtained possession of Chunar and the dependent districts, which was a great acquisition to his power, there being a considerable treasure in the place.

Much about this time, Mahmood, the son of the Emperor Sekunder Lody, having embraced the protection of Rana Sinka, by his assistance, and that of Hassen of Mewat, advanced against the Emperor Baber, and was defeated at Janveh. Mahmood, flying to Chitor, was from thence invited by the chiefs of the

* See reign of Mahmood Shah, p. 119.

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tribe of Lody, who were gathered together at Patna, and by them proclaimed King. He soon made himself master of all Behar. Shere, perceiving that he could not draw the omrahs over from Mahmood's interest, and that he had not sufficient force to oppose him, submitted to his authority, and by that means saved a part of Behar, which the Sultan permitted him to retain. Mahmood told him, at the same time, that if he would effectually assist him in recovering Joanpore from the Moghuls, he, in return, would make over the province of Behar to him: and a contract to that effect was drawn up and executed between them. SECT. V.

Shere, some time after, obtained leave to return to Sehsaram, to levy troops; and Mahmood, marching with an army against the Moghuls, sent him orders to join. But as Shere delayed for some time, the Sultan, persuaded by his omrahs that he was playing a loose game, marched his army through Shere's estate, on his way to Joanpore. Shere came out to meet him, had an elegant entertainment provided for his reception, and then marched with him to Joanpore. The troops of the Emperor Homayon quitted the province upon their approach, so that the Afghans took possession of the country as far as Lucknow.

Homayon lay, at this time, before Callinger, in Bundelcund; and hearing of the progress of the Afghans, he marched against them. Mahmood having, on this occasion, given a superior command to Bein Baezid, Shere, who thought himself ill used, betrayed his master; and wrote a private letter, the night before the action, to Hindoo Beg, one of the Moghul generals, acquainting him, "That he esteemed himself a servant of "Baber's family, to whom he owed his advancement; and "that he would be the cause of defeating the Afghans next

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SECT. V. "day." He drew off his troops in the action, which occasioned Mahmood's defeat, for which service he was greatly favoured by Homayon. Mahmood, after this defeat, retreated
A.D. 1542. to Patna, retired from the world, and, in the year 949, died at Orissa.

Homayon, after this victory, returned to Agra, and sent the noble Hindoo Beg to Shere, to demand possession of the fort of Chunar. Shere excused himself, and obliged Hindoo Beg to retreat. Homayon returned immediately with his whole army to besiege Chunar; and having invested it, he received a letter from Shere, acquainting him, "That he esteemed himself one of the servants of the house of Baber, from whom "he first obtained a government; and that he had evinced his "fidelity, by having been the occasion of the late victory: "That therefore, if the King would permit him to retain the "government of the fort, he was willing to pay him the proper "revenues of the lands which he held; and would send his son "Cuttub, with five hundred horse, to be maintained at his "own expence, in the Emperor's service." As, at this juncture, the affairs of Guzerat, by the conquests of Behadur, required the King's presence, and considering also the strength of Chunar, Homayon consented to these terms; and accordingly, being joined by Cuttub, the son of Shere, with five hundred horse, he marched towards Behadur. The King, however, had scarcely reached Guzerat, when Cuttub deserted with all his horse, and returned to his father. Shere immediately raised what forces he could, and reduced Behar. Not satisfied with his success, he pursued his fortune, and penetrated into the heart of Bengal, having fought with the omrahs of that country several sharp battles, before he could make himself master of the passes, which were defended a whole month.

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SECT. V.

Mahmood of Bengal shut himself up in Gour, the capital, which Shere for a long time besieged. One of the zemindars of Behar having raised a disturbance, he left Khuas Khan to carry on the siege, and returned to Behar. Provisions becoming at length very scarce in Gour, Mahmood fled in a boat to Hajypore; and Shere, having settled affairs in Behar, returned and pursued him. Mahmood, being necessitated to give battle, was defeated; and being wounded in the engagement, fled his kingdom, which immediately fell into the hands of the conqueror*.

It has been before stated, that on the advance of the Emperor Homayon towards Gour, Shere Khan had deemed it prudent to retire to his original patrimony at Sehsaram, where he revolved in his mind various schemes for possessing himself of the important fortress of Rhotas, that he might there lodge in security his family, and the immense wealth which he had brought from Bengal. To take Rhotas by open force was an impossible attempt. It was therefore necessary to devise some stratagem, by which success might be hoped. Shere, for this purpose, sent a message to Raja Berkis, who was in possession of this impregnable fortress, and told him, "That, as he himself was going to "attempt the recovery of Bengal, he hoped that, from their "former friendship, he would permit him to send his family "and treasure into the place, with a few attendants." Berkis at first rejected this request; but Shere sent an artful ambassador to him a second time, with some handsome presents,

Stratagem for taking the fortress of Rhotas.

* See reign of Mahmood, page 121.

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SECT. V.

acquainting him, "That it was only for his women and treasure "he requested his princely protection: That should he be for- "tunate enough to conquer Bengal, he would make proper "acknowledgments for the favour on his return; but if he "should lose his life in the contest, he rather chose that his "family and wealth should fall into the hands of Berkis, than "into those of the Moghuls, his inveterate enemies." Berkis, suffering himself to be deluded by his avarice, determined, when once in possession of the treasure, to keep it; and therefore consented to Shere's request. The Afghan, having provided covered chairs*, filled them all, except two or three which were to go first, with armed men and arms. He at the same time filled five hundred money-bags with leaden bullets, and appointed some of his best soldiers to carry them, in the disguise of slaves, with sticks in their hands, who were intended in appearance to help to carry the treasure up the mountain. The men who carried the close chairs were disguised in the same manner. This train accordingly set out; and the first and second chair being examined at the gate, were found to contain only old women, so that further examination was neglected. The Raja, in the mean time, was busy in counting the bags, which he now reckoned part of his own fortune. When the chairs reached the house which the Raja had appointed, the wolves rushed out among the sheep, and began to dye the fold with their blood. The porters used their staves, till they supplied themselves with arms from the chairs. They easily mastered the garrison, who were off their guard;

* Somewhat similar to our sedan chairs: they are called Doolies.

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and admitted Shere, who was encamped at a small distance. Berkis himself, with a few followers, found means to escape into the woods, by a private passage behind the fort.

Thus fell one of the most impregnable fortresses in the world into the hands of Shere, together with much treasure, which had been accumulating there for ages.

Rhotas is built upon the level top of a mountain. The only entrance to it is a very narrow road, through a steep ascent of two miles, from the foot of the hill to the gates, which are three in number, one above another, defended by guns and rolling-stones. The square contents of the fortified table land, on the top of the mountain, is more than ten miles: in this space are contained towns, villages, and corn fields; and water is found a few feet from the surface. On one side runs the river Soane, under an immense precipice; another river, in the same manner, passes close to the other side; and both meeting a little below, form the hill into a triangular peninsula. There is a very deep valley on the third side, full of impervious woods, which spread all over the mountains, and render access that way next to impossible†.

Shere had now a secure retreat for his family; and his friends began to acquire fresh spirits by this piece of success. Homayon, in the mean time, spent three months, in luxurious pleasures, in Gour the capital of Bengal. He there received advices that his brother, Prince Hindal, had revolted in his governments of Agra and Mewat; that he had put to death Shaik Phoul, the only man of consequence who would

† Since the English have had possession of Behar, the fortifications of Rhotas have been entirely neglected.

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SECT. V.

not break his allegiance to the Emperor; and had coined money in his own name. Homayon therefore left Jehangire Cooly Beg, with five thousand horse, in Gour, and retired towards Agra.

By the excessive rains and bad roads, the king's cavalry and beasts of burthen perished in great numbers on his march, through fatigue and want of forage. Shere, who had now raised a numerous army, entrenched himself at Chowsar, on the banks of the river Currumnassa, in a place by which the King must of necessity pass; and, by treachery, defeated him with great slaughter, in the manner which we have already related*.

Shere completes his conquest of Behar and Bengal.

Shere Khan immediately assumed the royal insignia and titles; but deeming it more advisable to establish himself firmly in the kingdom of Bengal, than to pursue the fugitive Emperor, he marched directly towards Gour. In the vicinity of that city he was opposed by Jehangire Cooly Beg, the Moghul governor; but the great superiority in numbers of the Afghans enabled them shortly to annihilate their adversaries: and Shere, having taken possession of the city, was on the following day proclaimed Sovereign of the united kingdoms of Bengal and Behar, under the title of Shere Shah.

A.D. 1539.

Shere continued in Gour till the end of the year 946, busily employed in forming arrangements for the good government of the country, and in recruiting and equipping his troops. At length, having assembled an army of 50,000 Afghans, he marched to attack the Emperor. They met in the vicinity of Cannouge,

A.D. 1540.

where, on the 10th of the month Mohurrem, 947, the empire

* See page 125.

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of Hindoostan was again transferred from the Moghuls to the Afghans, by the total defeat of the unfortunate Homayon.

Khizer Khan, governor of Gour, excites Shere's jealousy.

When Shere Shah found it requisite to proceed against the Emperor, he entrusted the government of Bengal to a chief named Khizer Khan. This person, fired by that ambition which seems to torment every Mohammedan bosom, shortly after the departure of his patron, united himself in marriage with a daughter of Mahmood Shah, the late king of Bengal. By this connexion he conciliated a number of the dependants of the late dynasty; and, flattered by their attention, he assumed a degree of state and consequence which soon aroused the jealousy and vigilance of Shere Shah; who, judging of the sentiments of others by his own conduct, thought it requisite to clip the wings of the ambition of his deputy: he therefore, in the year 948, returned to Bengal; and Khizer Khan, having advanced some days' journey from the capital to meet him, was seized, and all his wealth confiscated. A. D. 1541.

Bengal subdivided into provinces.

After this, Shere proceeded to Gour, and subdivided the kingdom of Bengal into several provinces, to each of which he nominated a distinct governor. He then appointed Cazy Fazylet, a person celebrated for his learning, policy, and piety, to superintend the whole, to preserve unanimity amongst the governors, and to report to him on their conduct. Having thus settled the affairs of Bengal to his own satisfaction, Shere Shah returned, at the end of the year 948, to Agra.

The prudent measures established by this monarch kept Bengal in a state of tranquillity and happiness during the remainder of his life, which was terminated by the explosion

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SECT. V.

Shere's death, A. D. 1545.

of a shell, as he was besieging the fort of Callinger in Bundelcund, on the 12th of the month Rubby al Avul, A. H. 952. He spent fifteen years in a military life before he mounted the throne; and he sat upon the musnud five years, as Emperor of Hindoostan.

The character of Shere is almost equally divided between virtue and vice. Public justice prevailed in the kingdom, while private acts of treachery dishonoured the hands of the king. He seemed to have made breach of faith a royal property, which he would by no means permit his subjects to share with him. We ought, perhaps, to ascribe this vice to the ambition of Shere. Had he been born to the throne, he might have been just, as he was valiant and politic in war: had he confined his mind to his estate, he might have merited the character of a virtuous chief; but his greatness of mind made him look up to the empire, and he cared not by what steps he was to ascend.

Shere left many monuments of his magnificence behind him. From Sonargaum, in Bengal, to that branch of the Indus called the Nilab, which is fifteen hundred coss*, he built caravanserais at every stage, and dug a well at the end of every coss. Besides, he raised many magnificent mosques for the worship of God on the highway, wherein he appointed readers of the Korân, and priests. He ordered, that at every stage, all travellers, without distinction of country or religion, should be entertained, according to their quality, at the public expence. He at the same time planted rows of fruit-trees along the roads, to preserve travellers from the scorching heat

* About three thousand of our miles.

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of the sun, as well as to gratify their taste. Horse-posts were placed at proper distances, for forwarding quick intelligence to government, and for the advantage of trade and correspondence: this establishment was new in India. Such was the public security during his reign, that travellers and merchants, throwing down their goods, went without fear to sleep on the highway.

It is said, that Shere, being told his beard grew white, replied, "It was true that he had obtained the empire towards the evening." He divided his time into four equal parts:—one he appropriated to the distribution of public justice, one to the regulations of his army, one to worship, and the remainder to rest and recreation. He was buried at Sehsaram, his original estate, in a magnificent sepulchre which he had built in the middle of a great reservoir of water†.

MOHAMMED KHAN SOOR.

Soon after the succession of Selim Shah, the second son of Shere Shah, to the throne of Dehly, he had the weakness to abrogate the prudential system of his father; and appointed one of his relations, named Mohammed Khan, to the general

† This fine monument of the magnificence of Shere still remains entire. The artificial lake which surrounds it is not much less than a mile in circumference.

The following is a poetical description of it;

"From 'midst a limpid pool, superbly high,
The massy dome obtrudes into the sky:
Upon the banks more humble tombs abound,
Of faithful servants, who their Chief surround.
The Monarch still seems grandeur to dispense,
And e'en in death maintains preeminence."

Asiatic Miscellany.

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SECT. V.

government of Bengal. This chief is said to have ruled with strict justice and great propriety during the whole of the reign
A. D. 1553. of Selim; but when, in the year 960, the abandoned Mohammed Adil* had seized the throne, the Governor of Bengal, deeming himself absolved from any allegiance to the murderer of the son of his patron, disclaimed the Imperial authority, and ordered the coin to be stampt in his own name.

During the following year, he extended his dominions by taking possession of some of the districts of Joanpore; but, in
A. D. 1555. the year 962, having advanced at the head of a numerous army to Choppergotta near Calpie, he there met his death, in an engagement with Himu, the vizier of the Emperor Mohammed Adil.

BEHADUR SHAH.

After the defeat at Choppergotta, the troops of Bengal retreated to the village of Joosy, in the vicinity of what is now the fort of Allahabad; where the Afghan chiefs raised to the throne Khizer Khan, the son of the deceased king, under the title of Behadur Shah. Although this prince was anxious to avenge the death of his father, he deemed it more prudent to return to Bengal, and, having arranged the affairs of that province, to wait a more favourable opportunity to contend for the empire of Dehly.

Upon the arrival of Behadur Shah at Gour, he found that a chief, named Shabaz Khan, had, upon intelligence of the defeat of the Bengal army, taken possession of that city in the name of the Emperor Mohammed Adil. The usurper

* See History of Hindoostan, A. D. 1552.

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was however shortly abandoned by his own troops, seized, and put to death. SECT. V.

After this event, Behadur Shah employed himself in recruiting his army; and in the following year, 963, marched to meet the Emperor Mohammed Adil. The contending armies met in the vicinity of Mongier; and, after a hard-fought battle, the Emperor was slain, and his army totally routed. This victory gave to Behadur Shah the absolute sovereignty of Bengal and part of Behar. He is said to have ruled these territories with reputation for six years, and died at Gour in the year 968. A. D. 1556. A. D. 1560-1.

JELLAL ADDEEN.

Behadur Shah, dying without children, was succeeded by his brother Jellal Khan, who at the end of three years (viz. in 971) also died at Gour, and was succeeded by his son, a youth, who soon after fell by the hands of an assassin named Ghyas Addeen, who for a short time usurped the government. A. D. 1563-4.

SOLIMAN SHAH KERANY.

Soliman Kerany takes possession of Bengal, but allows his brother, Taj Khan, to act as his deputy—Proceeds to Bengal on the death of his brother, and removes the seat of government from Gour to Tondah —Sends presents to the Emperor Akbar—Invests the Fort of Rhotas, the Governor of which obtains the assistance of the Emperor, whose army causes Soliman to raise the siege—Invades Orissa, and basely assassinates Sultan Ibrahim—By politic conduct he subsequently enjoys a peaceable reign, and dies much regretted by his subjects.

The Afghan tribe of Kerany had been peculiarly distinguished by Shere Shah and his son Selim, who conferred on them handsome estates in Boujepore and the vicinity of Khuaspore

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SECT. V.

Tondah. Soliman's elder brother, Taj Khan Kerany, was governor of Sumbul during the reign of the Emperor Selim Shah; but, on going to pay his respects at the Court of Mohammed Adil, he was so disgusted with the conduct of that infamous monarch and his vizier*, that he resolved to abandon the service of so unworthy a master, and retire to his paternal estates. In his progress towards Boujepore, he seized a hundred elephants belonging to the Emperor, and a large sum of the public money: the former he distributed amongst his brethren and relations, and the latter he disbursed in raising troops to oppose Himu, the Imperial vizier, who came in pursuit of him. They fought in the vicinity of Chunar; but, although the Kerany tribe were worsted, they retired with their wealth and plunder to Boujepore: and the Imperial army being compelled to march against a more powerful enemy, they remained unmolested.

Soliman Kerany, the second brother, was appointed by Selim Shah to the government of Behar; and, upon the death of that monarch, not only refused to acknowledge the authority of his successor, but stimulated his brother Taj Khan also to quit the Imperial service, and to join him with his adherents. The consequence of this advice has been already related.

A. D. 1555.

When, in the year 962, the Emperor Mohammed Adil advanced into Behar, Soliman joined his troops to those of the King of Bengal, and contributed much to the victory gained over the Imperial arms in the vicinity of Mongier. He continued on good terms with Behadur Shah, and his brother Jellal Addeen; but when the son of the latter was

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* See History of Hindoostan, A. D. 1552.

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SECT. V.

assassinated by Ghyas Addeen, he detached a well-appointed army, under the command of his brother, Taj Khan Kerany, to take possession of Bengal. This measure having been effected with little opposition, he allowed his brother to retain the government as his deputy during his life, which however only lasted one year.

A. D. 1564-5, Soliman Shah makes Tondah the capital of Bengal.

On the decease of Taj Khan in the year 972, Soliman proceeded to Bengal; but conceiving, from the number of kings who had died at Gour, that it was either an unhealthy or an unlucky place, he made Tondah, or Tonra, the capital of his dominions†.

Soon after Soliman had taken possession of Bengal, he despatched an intelligent agent with many valuable presents to the Court of the Emperor Akbar‡, with assurances of his great respect and attachment; which conduct highly gratified and flattered the Emperor, and contributed to the ease and comfort of the inhabitants of Bengal, who were at that period very apprehensive of a visit from the Imperial arms.

Soliman having rendered himself completely master of all Bengal and Behar, excepting the strong fort of Rhotas, marched with a numerous army in the year 973, and invested that fortress. A. D. 1565-6. The siege had continued nearly six months, when the Emperor

† The following is the account given of Tondah in Major Rennell's Memoir. "Tondah, Tanra, or Tarrah, is situated very near the site of Gour, on the road leading from it to Rajemahel. There is little remaining of this place, save the rampart; nor do we know for certain when it was deserted." It is sometimes called Khuaspore Tondah, from the original name of the district in which it was situated*.

This account is not so correct as that generally furnished by Major Rennell; as Tondah is certainly separated from Gour by the Bagamutty river, which Mr. Wilford supposes was the old bed of the Ganges. See Asiatic Researches, 8vo edit. vol. V. pp. 257, 272, 277.

‡ Akbar ascended the throne in the month of January 1556.

* See Ayeen Akberry, vol. II. p. 177.

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SECT. V.

A. D. 1566. Akbar arriving at Joanpore, Futteh Khan, the governor of Rhotas, implored his assistance; promising to deliver up the keys of the garrison to any of his Majesty's servants who might be sent for that purpose. Akbar, anxious to get possession of so important a place, immediately sent off a chosen detachment of Moghuls to raise the siege. In the mean time, the King of Bengal, fearful of encountering the Imperial arms, retreated to his own country; and the Emperor, desirous to prevent his aiding the rebellious Usbec chiefs, sent an ambassador, named Mohammed Khan Seistany, to cultivate his friendship. The Emperor at the same period sent an ambassador to the Raja of Orissa, to form a treaty with him; and to desire, should Soliman join the rebels, that the Raja would immediately invade Bengal, and depend upon him for support and assistance.

A. D. 1567-8. In the year 975, the Emperor being engaged in the western provinces, Soliman invaded Orissa, and shortly subdued that province. But this conquest was stained by an act of the grossest treachery; for having invited to a conference Sultan Ibrahim, who for a short period had been Emperor of Dehly, and after various misfortunes had acquired an establishment in that country, he basely assassinated him*.

Soliman, having left a deputy to govern Orissa, returned,

A. D. 1568-9. in 976, to his capital. In the following year he invaded and plundered the district of Couch Beyhar; but was recalled from thence, by intelligence that the people of Orissa had risen and driven away his governor. Upon his return to Tondah, he detached a force to recover his authority in Orissa; and having effected this point, he afterwards limited his ambition to the security and improvement of his dominions.

* See History of Hindoostan, vol. II. p. 197.

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Although Soliman insisted upon his courtiers addressing him by the title of "Your Majesty," he never assumed the umbrella, or other insignia of royalty: and as he continued from time to time to send presents to the Emperor Akbar, and affected to hold his dominions of that monarch, he, by this politic conduct, enjoyed a quiet and peaceable reign, and died at his new capital in the year 981, much regretted by his subjects, and highly respected by all his contemporaries. A. D. 1573.

DAOOD KHAN.

Daood Khan assumes independence, and proceeds to hostilities with the Emperor Akbar—Treaty concluded, with which Daood is dissatisfied, and puts his General to death—Siege of Patna—Hajypore taken by assault—Daood pusillanimously flies from Patna, and its garrison is destroyed—Retreats with his treasure to Orissa—Partial successes of the Afghans—Daood concentrates his forces at Cuttack—After a hard-fought battle, retreats to the fort of Cuttack—Throws himself on the Emperor's clemency—Swears allegiance, and obtains the province of Orissa—Monaim Khan removes the seat of government from Tondah to Gour—Dreadful pestilence at Gour—Daood, on the death of Monaim Khan, raises an army of Afghans, and recovers Bengal—Made prisoner, and put to death—Conclusion of the Afghan (commonly called Patan) Sovereignty.

Upon the death of Soliman Kerany, his eldest son, Bayezid, assumed the reins of government; but the Afghan chiefs, being dissatisfied with him, in a few months put him to death, and raised to the throne Daood Khan, the second son.

This prince, who was addicted to wine and bad company, forsook the prudent measures of his father; and assuming all the insignia of royalty, ordered the Khutbeh† to be proclaimed

† A prayer for the reigning monarch, permitted only to be used for independent sovereigns.

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SECT. V. A. D. 1573.

in his own name through all the towns of Bengal and Behar; and directed the coin to be stampt with his own title; thus completely setting at defiance the authority of the Emperor Akbar.

Shortly after Daood Khan's succession, he inspected the public treasure, which he found to be immense. He also ordered a general muster to be taken of his army and war establishment, which is said to have consisted of 40,000 well-mounted cavalry; 140,000 infantry, of different descriptions; 20,000 pieces of cannon of various calibres; 3,600 elephants; and several hundred war-boats. With such a force he thought himself equal to contend with the Emperor Akbar; and, upon some slight pretence, ordered a force to march into the Moghul territories, and to take possession of the fort of Zemanieh, situated on the southern bank of the Ganges, a little above Ghazypore, which a few years before had been erected by Khan Zeman, the Imperial captain-general, as a frontier garrison.

Daood proceeds to hostilities with the Emperor Akbar.

When intelligence of this event reached the Emperor, who was at that time in Guzerat, he determined upon annexing Bengal to the Imperial dominions, and sent immediate orders to Monaim Khan, his general, commanding in the province of Joanpore, to assemble an army and invade Behar. This mandate was quickly carried into execution, and a powerful Moghul army advanced to the vicinity of Patna. There they were opposed by Lody Khan, the Generalissimo and Prime-minister of Daood Khan; and after some skirmishing, a truce was concluded; the articles of which were, that, upon condition of the Moghuls retiring from Behar, the King of Bengal should pay the sum of two lacs (200,000) of rupees, in ready money, to the Imperial treasury; and should present the Emperor

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with silks, muslins, and other productions of Bengal, to the amount of 100,000 rupees more.

Daood Khan, when freed from the apprehension of the invading foe, affected to find fault with Lody Khan's conduct in this transaction; and, shortly after his return, imprisoned him, confiscated all his wealth, and put him to death.

The Emperor Akbar was also displeased with his General for granting such easy terms to the enemy, and appointed Raja Todermul to supersede him in the command of the troops destined to the conquest of Bengal. In the mean time, Monaim Khan, the Moghul general, informed of the conduct of the King of Bengal, and of the displeasure of the Emperor, returned with rapid strides to Patna, and laid siege, in the early part of the year 982, to that city.

Siege of Patna, A. D. 1574.

Daood Khan, after a slight attempt to repulse the enemy, took post with some of his most select troops within the fortifications; and, by his example and precept, stimulated the garrison to defend themselves to the last extremity: in short, after besieging the city of Patna for several months, the Moghul General was obliged to wait the arrival of the Emperor; who, having proceeded by water from Agra, arrived with a numerous army in the vicinity of Patna on the 16th of the month Rubby Assany, 982; and on the following day, after reconnoitring the fort from a lofty mound, called *Punj-paharry* (or the Five Hills), gave orders for its closer investiture.

The Emperor, having obtained intelligence that the besieged received constant supplies of provisions from Hajypore, situated on the opposite bank of the Ganges, sent a chosen detachment of 3000 men, furnished with scaling ladders, &c. under the command of Khan Alum, to attack that fortress;

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SECT. V.

and Raja Gujety, a zemindar of that district, who had under his command a number of spearmen and irregular cavalry, and who had offered his services to the Emperor, was directed to co-operate with the Moghul general.

The attack was made in the most spirited manner, and was observed by the Emperor, by the means of a telescope, from a battery on the bank of the river; but as Futteh Khan, the Governor of Hajypore, defended himself with great resolution, the Imperial troops were nearly exhausted, when the Emperor despatched three large boats, filled with volunteers, to their assistance. Upon the arrival of this reinforcement, the Moghuls renewed their attack; and, after killing the Governor and the greater part of the garrison, carried the place.

Khan Alum, having succeeded in his enterprise, ordered the heads of the Governor and of all the slain to be put on board a boat, and sent to the Emperor; who immediately forwarded them to Daood Khan, with an insinuation, that such shortly would be his fate, unless he submitted to the Imperial arms. Daood Khan, who was naturally of a timid disposition, was so much affected by the sight of the heads of his brave troops, that he resolved to abandon Patna, and take refuge in Bengal. He, in consequence, embarked all his treasure and valuables, and in the middle of the night of the 21st of Rubby Assany,

A. D. 1574. A. H. 982, made his escape by means of quick-rowing boats.

The garrison, which consisted of above 20,000 men, finding themselves abandoned by their King, fled in all directions; and the roads were so crowded with horses, carriages, and elephants, that great numbers of the lower orders were trampled to death. To complete their misfortunes, the bridge over the river Poonpoon broke down; which gave the

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SECT. V.
A.D. 1547.

Moghul cavalry an opportunity of coming up with the hindmost of them, and left them only the option of being hewn to pieces by the swords of their enemies, or of being drowned in the river.

The Moghuls pursued the remainder of the fugitives as far as Derriapore, nearly fifty miles from Patna, and seized upon 400 elephants and many other valuable articles.

The Emperor remained six days at Derriapore; and, previous to his leaving it, to return to Agra, appointed Monaim Khan, who also bore the lofty title of Khan Khan (Lord of Lords) to the government of Behar and Bengal; and in addition to the troops which that nobleman had previously with him, he ordered 10,000 chosen cavalry, under the command of Raja Todermul, to join him. He also presented him with all the boats and stores which were brought from Agra, and ordered him to pursue and extirpate Daood Khan and his adherents from those provinces.

Upon the arrival of Daood Khan at the pass of Terriagurhy, he stopt to examine the state of the fortifications; with which he was so well contented, that he told the garrison he depended upon their stopping the progress of his enemies for a year; and that at all events he expected they would defend themselves to the last extremity: after which he proceeded with a more tranquil mind to Tondah, his capital.

The hopes of the King were, however, much disappointed; for on the approach of the Imperial General, the Afghans, terrified by the horrid example made of the garrison of Hajypore, could not be brought to stand the assault, but shamefully took to flight; and Monaim Khan obtained possession of that important pass, the key of Bengal, without the loss of a man.

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SECT. V.

When intelligence of this unexpected event reached Daood Khan, despairing of being able to contend with his adversaries, he loaded his treasure and valuable effects upon elephants, and took the route of Orissa.

Monaim Khan, not aware of the intentions of the King of Bengal, proceeded towards Tondah with much circumspection: but when his spies informed him that Daood Khan had again retreated, he advanced rapidly with his cavalry, and on
A. D. 1574. the 4th of Jummad Assany (5th month) 982, took possession of the capital of Bengal without opposition.

Some days after this event, the Imperial General despatched Raja Todermul, with a well-appointed army, in pursuit of the fugitive King; and at the same time detached Mujenun Khan Kakeshelan with a considerable force, to take possession of Ghoragot, the jagier or estate of Soliman Mungely, an Afghan chief of considerable consequence. But this measure was not so easily effected; for the Afghans, fighting in defence of their property and families, behaved with great courage, and slew a multitude of their enemies. At length, overpowered by numbers, they were nearly all extirpated, and their wives and children made captives.

Mujenun Khan confiscated all the Afghan estates, and divided them amongst his own dependants of the tribe of Kakeshelan; but encouraged his soldiers to unite themselves in marriage with the Afghan females, and took for his son the daughter of Soliman Mungely, the deceased chief.

The Raja Todermul having advanced to Medarun (Bheerbhoom), there received intelligence that Daood Khan had halted at Ryn Kesary, and, instead of continuing his retreat, was collecting his dispersed troops, with an intention of again

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opposing the Imperial arms. This news compelled the Raja to halt, and to send off an express to Monaim Khan at Tondah. The Imperial Governor, immediately on receiving this unexpected intelligence, detached a second army, under the command of Mahmood Cooly Khan, to the assistance of the Raja; who, after the arrival of the reinforcement, proceeded to Gualior, which was twenty miles from Ryn Kesary. He there learned that Joneid, a cousin of the King of Bengal, who was celebrated for his courage and intrepidity, had arrived with a number of his followers at that place, on his way to join the King. The Raja, setting too little consequence on his enemy, ordered two brigades, under the command of Abul Cossim, to attack Joneid; but they were repulsed with much disgrace and slaughter, and the Raja was compelled to march with all his force to their assistance. The Afghans, unable to oppose such a number of enemies, dispersed themselves in the woods, and on the following day effected their junction with the King.

Immediately after this event, the pusillanimous Daood Khan again retreated; and the Moghul chiefs advanced to Midnapore, a town which has since given its name to the district formerly called Jellasir. At this place the Imperial army halted for some days; during which time Mohammed Cooly Khan died; and dissentions breaking out immediately after amongst the Moghul chiefs, the Raja Todermul, who was in fact an alien amongst them, and was always dubious of his own authority, having called a council of the principal officers of the army, determined to return to Burdwan, and there to wait for further instructions from the Governor-general.

When this disagreeable intelligence was communicated to

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SECT. V. Monaim Khan, he ordered a second reinforcement, under the command of some celebrated officers, to join the Raja, and made preparations to follow with all the Moghul forces that could possibly be spared from the defence and protection of the newly-conquered dominions.

The Raja, having been joined by the confederate forces, again advanced to Midnapore, and thence to Bukhtore. At the latter place he received information that the King of Bengal had retired with the whole of his forces to Cuttack Benaras, where he was resolved to defend himself to the last extremity.

This event caused the Raja again to halt, and wait the junction of the Governor-general; who, proceeding from Tondah by rapid marches, shortly united his forces with those of the Raja; and the whole of the Imperial army then advanced towards Cuttack.

A. D. 1574. On the 20th of the month Zykad (11th month) 982, the Moghuls came in sight of the Afghan camp, which was covered in front by strong entrenchments; but as Daood Khan had resolved to risk the fate of another battle, he drew out his army in front of the camp, and waited, with great determination, the attack of the enemy. The numbers on both sides were nearly equal; but the Afghans had two hundred furious elephants placed along their line, by whose strength they hoped to break through the squadrons of their opponents, and to clear a road for the more active operations of their cavalry.

On the other side, Monaim Khan had brought with him a number of swivels and small guns mounted upon carriages; much more dreadful in their effect than the charge of the huge animals.

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A. D. 1574.

This battle was contended with greater obstinacy than had ever occurred between the two nations: for although the guns succeeded in putting the elephants to the route, and driving them back on their own line, yet the Afghan cavalry charged with such resolution, that the Moghul line was thrown into great confusion, their Commander-in-chief was wounded, and, his horse becoming unmanageable, he narrowly escaped being captured.

At length, Gujer Khan* and several of the best Afghan officers having fallen, Daood Khan was alarmed, and fled to the fort of Cuttack, leaving his camp to be plundered by the enemy.

The Moghuls, although victors, had suffered so much in this engagement, that they did not pursue the fugitives, but halted five days on the field of battle, to bury their dead, and to arrange plans for sending away their wounded. They afterwards proceeded, by easy stages, till they reached the banks of the Mahanuddy, one mile from Cuttack, where they encamped, and commenced making preparations for the siege of the fort.

Daood Khan, now driven to the extremity of his dominions, and aware that Cuttack was his last stake, was much alarmed for the consequence; and, by the advice of his counsellors, resolved to throw himself upon the clemency of the victors. He therefore sent an ambassador to the Imperial General, who represented that it was contrary to every principle of religion for the followers of Mohammed to extirpate their brethren; and that it would well accord with the Emperor's liberality, to allow his master to retain a small portion of his former domi-

* There is a tradition that one of the Afghan Emperors ennobled all his countrymen in Hindoostan; in consequence of which, every person of that nation now assumes the title of Khan (Lord).

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SECT. V.
A. D. 1574.

nions, in which he and his adherents might pass their lives in peace and quietness, and be numbered amongst the Imperial servants.

The eloquence of the ambassador, and the justness of his representation, together with a wish of terminating the war, induced Monaim Khan to accede to the proposal; and he agreed, that if Daood Khan would in person make the request, he would comply with his wishes, and strongly recommend his case to the consideration of the Emperor.

On the following day, Daood Khan, attended by several of his chiefs, left the fort, and was received in the Moghul camp with every mark of respect and attention. The troops were drawn out to salute him; and all the chiefs, seated, according to their rank, in the tent of audience, waited his approach. When he arrived at the bounds of the camp, he was met by several officers; and as he approached the place of interview, Monaim Khan advanced a considerable distance to embrace him.

Daood Khan was highly gratified by these marks of kindness; and unbuckling his sword, gave it to the General, saying, "As my opposition has been the cause of such a friend being wounded, I henceforward relinquish the title of a soldier." Monaim Khan took his hand, and led him to the seat of honour. After a short time, an elegant entertainment was brought in; and the King having feasted, the subject of the treaty was introduced.

Daood Khan swears allegiance to the Emperor.

The King swore by every thing that was sacred, if the Emperor would make a proper provision for him, he would continue, during his life, one of his most faithful subjects; and would never, in any manner, aid or abet his enemies. This declaration having been committed to writing, was signed and

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sealed by the King: after which the General rose from his seat, and, presenting him with a rich and valuable scimitar, said, "As you are now become one of the servants of the illustrious "Emperor of Hindoostan, in his name I present you with this "sword, which I request you will use in his service and de- "fence: and in order that you may wear it with proper dignity "and effect, I bestow on you, in his Majesty's name, the pro- "vince of Orissa in free gift; not doubting but that you will "henceforward prove yourself a faithful and loyal subject." SECT. V. A.D. 1574.

After this conversation, many costly presents were brought in by the attendants, and laid before the King; who having signified his acceptance in the usual manner, took his leave, and was attended to the bounds of the camp with the same ceremonies as he entered it.

Monaim Khan, being anxious to return to the seat of government, marched on the following day; and on the 18th of the month Suffer (2d month), 983, triumphantly entered Tondah. During his absence, the Afghans of Ghoragot had risen, and, having driven away their new governor, Mujenun Khan, had extended their depredations as far as Gour; but on the approach of the Imperial army, they dispersed, and concealed themselves in the woods, to wait for a more favourable opportunity. A.D. 1575.

Monaim Khan, having heard much of the ancient and desolate city of Gour, went to view it; and was so much delighted with the situation, and its many princely edifices, that he resolved again to render it the seat of government. To effect this plan, although it was then the season of the rains, he ordered the troops and all the public officers to remove from Tondah to Gour. Whether owing to the The seat of government removed from Tondah to Gour.

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SECT. V.

Dreadful pestilence at Gour.

dampness of the soil, the badness of the water, or the corrupted state of the air, a pestilence very shortly broke out amongst the troops and inhabitants. Thousands died every day; and the living, tired with burying the dead, threw them into the river, without distinction of Hindoo or Mohammedan. The Governor became sensible of his error, but it was too late. He was himself seized with the contagion, and at the end of ten days bade adieu to this transitory world.

A. D. 1575. This event occurred in the month Rugib, 7th month, A. H. 983.

Monaim Khan was a nobleman highly respected, and held the titles of Amyr al Omrah, and Sepah Salar, for fourteen years. During his government of Joanpore, he expended much money on public buildings; and the celebrated bridge at that city still stands, a monument of his magnificence, and of the skill of the architect*. As he died without heirs, his immense wealth became the property of the crown.

The Afghans, under Daood Khan, recover Bengal.

The death of Monaim Khan served as a signal for a general insurrection of the Afghans. They assembled from all quarters; and Daood Khan, the deposed king, forgetting his oath of allegiance to the Emperor, placing himself again at their head, they quickly compelled the Moghuls, then commanded by Shahem Khan Jellair, to retire from Bengal, and to take refuge in Hajypore and Patna.

As soon as intelligence of the death of Monaim Khan reached the Imperial court, the Emperor appointed Hussein

* In the year 1773, a brigade of British troops, under the command of Sir R. Barker, in their return from Oude, having embarked on the river Goompty, at Sultanpore, in the height of the rainy season, sailed over this bridge, which suffered no damage from the violence of the current, although the bottom of the river is, in other places, covered with shifting sands.

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Cooly Khan, then governor of the Punjab, to the government of Bengal, with the title of Khan Jehan: but the principal part of that chief's forces being in the district of Lahore, several months elapsed before he could reach Bengal, during which period the Afghans increased in number and strength. Thus Daood Khan found himself again at the head of a formidable army of 50,000 horse: and had these troops been possessed of that bravery which has been often evinced by the Afghan nation, the Emperor Akbar would have found it one of his most arduous undertakings to extirpate them from a country possessing such natural advantages. SECT. V.

Early in the year 984, the new governor, who during his march had been joined by all the expelled Moghuls, came in front of the pass of Terriagurhy, which he found was garrisoned by 8000 chosen Afghans. He hesitated not to attack the entrenchments, and, by superiority of courage and numbers, succeeded in getting possession of them, at the expence of the lives of many of his men; for, on this occasion, the Afghans fought with great spirit, and the major proportion of the garrison fell in the contest. A. D. 1576.

The King of Bengal had taken post, with the greater part of his army, in the strong situation of Agmahel (now called Rajemahel), protected on one flank by the mountains, and on the other by the river Ganges. In this position he defended himself for several months, till the Moghul governor, having been reinforced by the Imperial troops of Patna, Tirhoot, and other places, on the 10th of Rubby al Akhir (4th month), 984, made a general assault upon the Afghan lines; and by the assistance of some artillery, sent by water from Agra, succeeded in forcing them. Joneid Kerany, the cousin of Daood A. D. 1576.

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SECT. V.

Khan, upon whom the Afghans had great dependence, and several other generals, were killed or wounded by cannon balls; and the troops, terrified by the dreadful effects of these weapons, took to flight, and left their King a prisoner in the hands of his enemies.

Made prisoner, and put to death.

When Daood Khan was brought before the Moghul Governor, he was upbraided with his perfidy to the Emperor; and having little to say in his defence, he was condemned as a rebel, and his head sent by an express messenger to Agra. This event occurred in the year 984, being the 20th year of the reign of the Emperor Akbar.

A. D. 1576.

Conclusion of the Afghan Sovereignty.

With Daood Khan terminated the line of Bengal Kings, who had reigned in succession over that country for 236 years; and with him was brought to a conclusion the sovereignty of the *Afghan nation over that province, of which they had held the uncontrouled possession for nearly four centuries.

The government of the Afghans in Bengal cannot be said to have been monarchical, but nearly resembled the feudal system introduced by the Goths and Vandals into Europe. Bukhtyar Khulijy and the succeeding conquerors made choice of a certain district as their own domain: the other districts were assigned to the inferior chiefs, who subdivided the lands amongst their petty commanders, each of whom maintained a certain number of soldiers, composed principally of their relations or dependants; these persons however did not cultivate the soil themselves, but each officer was the landlord of a small estate,

* The Afghan is generally called the Patan empire; but the latter word is unknown to the present Afghans, and is not, I believe, used by any of the ancient historians.

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having under him a certain number of *Hindoo* tenants, to whom, from the principle of self-interest, he conducted himself with justice and moderation: and had it not been for the frequent change of masters, and constant scenes of rebellion and invasion, in which private property was little regarded, the cultivators of the soil would have been placed in a state of comparative happiness; and agriculture would have flourished, as it subsequently did in another part of India, under the government of their countrymen, the Rohillas.

The condition of the upper classes of Hindoos must, doubtless, have been much deteriorated; but it is probable that many of the Afghan officers, averse to business, or frequently called away from their homes to attend their chiefs, farmed out their estates to the opulent Hindoos, who were also permitted to retain the advantages of manufactures and commerce.

The authority of the Afghan kings of Bengal depended much upon their personal ability and conduct. We have seen them, on some occasions, acting as despotic sovereigns; at other times possessing little or no influence beyond the town or city in which they resided,—often insulted, and even murdered, by their menial servants.

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SECT. VI.

Governors under the Moghul Dynasty.*

HUSSEIN COOLY KHAN, KHAN JEHAN.

SECT. VI. A. D. 1576. AFTER the victory at Agmahel (Rajemahel), Khan Jehan collected all the plunder and elephants of the Afghan camp, and sent them, under the charge of Raja Todermul, to the presence of the Emperor Akbar. He then detached a large force, under Muzuffir Khan, to pursue the fugitives, who had taken refuge in the hilly districts of Behar, with orders, after having extirpated them, to lay siege to the fort of Rhotas. These services were A. D. 1578. ably performed by Muzuffir Khan; and in the year 986, after a blockade of many months, that impregnable fortress was delivered up, by capitulation, to the Imperial arms. The Governor also sent a considerable force into Orissa, to seize the family and remaining property of Daood Khan; which being effected, he, in the same year, compelled the Raja of Cooch Behar to pay a tribute, and to acknowledge himself a vassal of the empire.

* For the history of the Moghuls, the reader is referred to the Life of Baber, in Dow's Hindoostan; and if he wishes for further information, to Gibbon's Roman Empire, under the article Zingis Khan.

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Khan Jehan employed himself with much perseverance and fidelity to regulate his government; and before his death, which happened in the vicinity of Tondah, in the end of the year 986, the whole of the provinces of Behar, Bengal, and Orissa, including Cuttack, were again annexed to the empire of Hindoostan. SECT. VI. A. D. 1578.

MUZUFFIR KHAN TIRBUTTY.

Muzuffir Khan appointed Governor of Bengal—In consequence of regulations in the financial system, the Moghul Chiefs of Bengal rebel, and take possession of Gour—The Chiefs of Behar afterwards mutiny for the same reason, and, uniting with those of Bengal, lay siege to Tondah, which they take, and murder the Governor.

When intelligence of the death of Khan Jehan reached the Emperor, he was much affected, and sent letters of condolence and honorary dresses to the brother and relations of the deceased. But as it was requisite that an officer of known courage and tried abilities should be immediately appointed to that important government, to prevent any insurrection of the Afghans, an express was sent, early in the year 987, to A. D. 1579. Muzuffir Khan, the conqueror of Rhotas, nominating him Governor-general of the three provinces; but in order to give him more leisure to attend to his military and political duties, his Majesty was graciously pleased to appoint Rai Putter Doss, and Meer Adhum, to be joint-superintendants of the revenue; Rizvy Khan to be paymaster-general; and Abul Futteh to be supreme judge. The effects of this arrangement were shortly evinced; for although no revenue had been remitted from Bengal by the former governor, under pretence that

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1579. the great military establishment had absorbed the whole, Muzuffir Khan, in the first year, sent to court five lacs of rupees in specie, a number of elephants, and a large collection of the valuable manufactures and natural productions of that country.

It has been before stated, that when, in the year 982, Monaim Khan had taken possession of the capital of Bengal, he detached Mujenun Khan Kakeshelan to take possession of Ghoragot; and that the said chief, having performed the service, immediately divided the jagiers or estates of the Afghans amongst his own followers.

This system of military service was perfectly congenial to the wishes of the Moghuls; and every chief, in succession, established himself and his dependants in the district to which he had been first appointed: and the late governor, Khan Jehan, being only solicitous about extirpating the Afghans, allowed them to continue in undisturbed possession. But when the new system of finance was introduced by the Emperor Akbar, the Governor was directed to call upon these officers for the muster-returns of their brigades, and to demand from them the balance of revenue exceeding the amount required for the regular payment of the army. He was further ordered frequently to change the jagiers, to prevent the troops establishing themselves in any one place.

The first persons to whom these orders were communicated, were, Khaledy Khan, who had obtained possession of Jellasore, and Baba Khan, who had succeeded to the command of the clan of Kakeshelan in Ghoragot. These chiefs remonstrated strongly against the orders; but the Governor continuing unmoved by their solicitations, they shaved their heads, and,

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having put on mourning, declared they would part with their jagiers only with their lives.

They then crossed the river, and, having taken possession of the city of Gour, sent expresses to their adherents, to join them with all possible despatch, and to seize upon any of the Imperial treasure which they might find in the districts through which they passed.

The Governor, much alarmed at these proceedings, secured all the boats on the western side of the river, and endeavoured to collect a body of troops on which he might depend. In the mean time, the Emperor, having been informed of the mutiny, and apprehensive lest it might become general throughout the army, sent an order to the Governor, reprimanding him for the harshness of his conduct, panegyrising the former fidelity and attachment of the tribe of Kakeshelan, and assuring the mutineers of the Imperial forgiveness if they would return to their allegiance and duty.

However hurt the feelings of the Governor might be at the receipt of this order, he immediately forwarded it to the rebels, who, pretending implicit obedience to the Imperial mandate, only requested that the Governor would send to them Rizvy Khan, the paymaster-general, and Putter Doss, the superintendant of the revenue, to assure them of his forgiveness and reconciliation; but no sooner had these officers crossed the river, than they were thrown into confinement, and the rebels became more unreasonable in their demands.

At the same time that the alteration had taken place in the financial system of Bengal, a separate paymaster-general, and superintendant of revenue, had been appointed to the province of Behar; and these officers, having also endeavoured to carry

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1579. into execution the orders of the court, gave much offence to the military commanders: the troops in Behar rose in arms, and, placing Masoom Cabuly at their head, put the superintendant of the revenue to death, and caused the paymaster to flee. They afterwards advanced to Terriagurhy, and, having forced the pass, effected a junction with the mutineers of Bengal.

The rebels then laid siege to Tondah; the fortifications of which being very weak, and the garrison every day deserting to the enemy, the Governor was compelled to yield without any conditions. He was immediately murdered, and all his wealth plundered by the insurgents. Having discovered, amongst the state prisoners, a nobleman, named Sief Addeen Hussein, who had been banished to Bengal by the Emperor, the insurgents released him, and dignified him with the title of Generalissimo.

By this unexpected and strange event, the provinces of Behar and Bengal were again torn from the hands of the Emperor; and Akbar had now to contend against 30,000 cavalry of his own nation and subjects, and for a cause in which he could not hope for the cordial co-operation of his army. This event A. D. 1580. occurred in the year 988. The historians of Akbar have endeavoured to throw the blame of this rebellion upon the Governor, who, in fact, appears merely to have obeyed the orders of his court.

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RAJA TODERMUL.

The Emperor appoints Raja Todermul to the command of an army against the Rebel Chiefs — Great influence of the Raja over the Hindoos — Prevails on the Zemindars not to supply the Rebel army with provisions, by which its leaders are obliged to separate — Restores Behar to the Imperial authority — Complains to the Emperor of the misconduct of the Vizier, who is in consequence deposed — Succeeds in quelling a rebellion in Oude — The Emperor supersedes him in his command, and appoints Aazim Khan, governor of Behar, to the united government of the provinces of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa.

WHEN intelligence of these untoward occurrences reached Agra, the Emperor, fearing to trust any of his Moghul officers, assigned the command of a numerous army to the Hindoo Raja Todermul; and gave him a commission, authorising him to call upon all the governors, jagierdars, zemindars, &c. upon his route, to join him, and co-operate with him in subduing the rebels. A. D. 1580.

When the Raja arrived at Joanpore, the Governor, Mohammed Masoom Ferunjudy, a Moghul officer, came out to meet him, and displayed to him a corps of 3000 chosen cavalry, all in complete armour, with which he offered to join the Imperial troops. Although the Raja perceived that he was a vain young man, full of his own consequence, and upon whom little dependance could be placed, he nevertheless thought it better to take with him so suspected a character, than to leave him with such a force in the rear of his army: he therefore accepted his offer, and, by flattery and attention, endeavoured to attach him to the royal cause.

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SECT. VI.

The political conduct of Akbar, in employing the Hindoo chiefs, was attended with the most salutary effects: they were always accompanied by a large body, either of their own clan, or of Rajepoots (the military tribe), who not only served to support the Moghul troops, now inadequate to retain in subjection so extended an empire, but were also useful as a check upon the latter, when refractory or dissatisfied.

A. D. 1580.

The Raja continued his march without opposition till he reached Mongeir, in the month of Jemmad al Akher, 988. Here he learned that the rebel army, consisting of 30,000 cavalry, were encamped at Bhâgalpore, thirty-eight miles to the southward of Mongeir, waiting to give him battle. As it is a system of the Hindoos never to risk the fate of a general engagement, except in cases of extreme necessity, the Raja took possession of Mongeir, and employed his troops in constructing additional lines, extending to the hills, which, with the fort, completely covered the front of his army. This precaution was not unnecessary; for in a few days two of his Moghul chiefs, with their corps, deserted to the enemy. Both armies remained in this situation for several months, and frequent skirmishes took place between their light troops. At length the Raja, by his influence amongst the Hindoo zemindars, prevailed upon them no longer to supply the rebels with provisions; promising to pay them ready money for every thing they brought to his camp: this he was enabled to do by the attention of the Emperor, who sent him 500,000 rupees, in specie, by post. The combined effects of similarity of religion and ready-money payments worked so effectually on the zemindars, that famine shortly found its way into the rebel camp, and compelled the chiefs to separate, in order

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to obtain food. The distress of the rebels was further increased at this time by the death of Baba Khan, the chief of the Kakeshelans. SECT. VI.

Masoom Cabuly proceeded to Behar. Jebbaburdy, who had succeeded to the command of the Kakeshelans, returned to Khuaspore Tondah; and Arab Behadur made a sudden march, by a circuitous route, on Patna, in hopes of surprising that city, which was only garrisoned by a small party of loyalists.

The Raja, having obtained accurate intelligence of their proceedings, sent a chosen detachment to reinforce Patna, and proceeded with the main body of his army towards Behar. When arrived within one march of that city, the rebels made an attack by night upon his army, in hopes of taking him by surprise; but they met with so warm a reception, that, after losing a number of their men, they were compelled to retreat; and as the fortifications of Behar could afford them no security, they abandoned that province, and continued their route to Bengal. Thus, by the prudent and political measures of the Raja, the province of Behar was, in the first campaign, restored to the Imperial authority.

The Raja cantoned his army, during the rainy season of 988, in the vicinity of Hajypore; and wrote to the Emperor, that the Vizier Shah Munsoor had caused a great defection in his army, by calling on several of the chiefs who accompanied him, to account for balances due by them in their former commands: that such conduct, at a time when defection was so general amongst the troops, was in the highest degree impolitic, and, if persevered in, must, by disuniting the army, tend to the ruin of the Imperial affairs: he A. D. 1580.

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SECT. VI.

further added, that, in consequence of the demand made on Masoom Ferunjudy, he had been obliged to allow him to return with his troops to his government of Joanpore, not without suspicions that his intentions were disloyal.

The representations of the Raja were so sensibly felt by the Emperor, that he immediately deposed the Vizier: and, as the throne of Akbar was at no period so shaken as by the rebellion here described, the Emperor found himself under the necessity of begging the services of old omrahs who were in disgrace, or had retired from the court in disgust. Aazim Khan Mirza Koke, a nobleman of great repute, was requested to take the command of 5000 horse, and to proceed, as Governor, to Behar. The Emperor went himself to the house of Shereif Khan Atke, and, having conferred on him an honorary dress, invited him to return to court, and assist him with his counsels.

In order to reconcile Masoom Ferunjudy, he was promoted to the government of Oude; and Tersoom Khan, another of the dissatisfied generals in Raja Todermul's army, was appointed to Joanpore. The former accepted of the appointment, but, soon after his arrival in Oude, raised the standards of rebellion. The Governor of Joosy and Priag, now called Allahabad, having also rebelled, Raja Todermul was obliged to detach part of his army, under the command of Shahbaz Khan, to assist in quelling the disturbances in Oude. This important service was effected in the last month of the year

A. D. 1581.

988, by the complete overthrow of Masoom Ferunjudy, and the capture of his family and all his wealth.

It may appear extraordinary, that a prince possessed of so much bravery and activity as the Emperor Akbar should not

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have placed himself at the head of the army, to put down so serious a rebellion; but, upon a reference to the History of Hindoostan, it will be found, that his attention was at the same time distracted by disturbances in Malwa and Guzerat; and that his own brother, Mirza Mohammed Hakeem, meditated an invasion of Hindoostan from Cabul. SECT. VI. A. D. 1581.

Aazim Khan, having arrived with his army at Behar, endeavoured, more by reconciliation than by force, to bring the rebels back to their duty; but, failing in success, he proceeded, in the year 990, to Agra, to meet the Emperor after his return from Cabul, and there laid before his Majesty a full and melancholy statement of the eastern provinces. A. D. 1582.

The Emperor, having taken into mature deliberation the dangerous state of Bengal, and the evil consequences of divided authority, superseded Raja Todermul, and appointed Aazim Khan, whose title was now changed to Khan Aazim, to the united government of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa. He, at the same time, commanded all the troops at the capital, which had not been on the expedition to Cabul, to attend the new Governor, and firmly to re-establish the Imperial authority in those provinces.

KHAN AAZIM MIRZA KOKE.

Khan Aazim, by sowing dissention among the Rebel Chiefs, succeeds in re-establishing the Royal authority in Bengal, and takes quiet possession of Tondah — Solicits the Emperor's permission to resign his government — The Afghans, under Cuttulu Khan, having extended themselves in considerable force over Orissa, Khan Aazim deputes Fereed Addeen Bokhary to conclude a truce with them — Fereed gives offence to one of the Afghan commanders, and hastily retires, losing several of his people

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SECT. VI. *on his return—The Imperial troops advancing to resent the insult offered to their ambassador, the Afghans retreat to their forests—Khan Aazim returns to Agra, and resigns his employment.*

It would be tedious to narrate the various rencounters between the rebels and the loyal troops, or to detail the numerous stratagems and intrigues by which the new Governor attempted to recover the royal authority: it may suffice to say, that the success of Khan Aazim was greater than the apparent means he possessed. Having, by bribery and skilful agents, sown dissention among the rebel chiefs, the tribe of Kakeshelan submitted to his authority*; and the followers of Masoom Cabuly forsaking him, he was obliged to seek refuge with some of the zemindars, who had taken pity on his deplorable situation. In short, Khan Aazim, before
A.D. 1582. the end of the year 990, obtained quiet possession of the city of Tondah, the capital of Bengal, and once more re-established the Imperial authority over that country; but being afraid of the unhealthiness of the climate, and desirous of returning to his family, he requested that a successor might be immediately appointed.

During the revolt of the Moghul troops, the scattered Afghans had again collected in Orissa, under the command of

* It is probable that Khan Aazim restored to them their lands on certain conditions; as Dr. F. Buchanan, who has been lately employed by the Bengal government in taking a statistical survey of the country on the north-east of the river Ganges, was surprised at the number of Mohammedans which he found in those districts. These are, in all likelihood, the descendants of the Afghans and Kakeshelans, softened, in the course of two centuries, by intermixture with the Hindoos; for, besides the children which they had by Hindoo women, they used to purchase a number of boys during a scarcity, and educate them in the Mussulman religion. These boys, and all other converts, were allowed to take the Arabian title of Shaikh; and the posterity of these are, perhaps, now more numerous than the genuine descendants of the stock to which they all ascribe their origin.

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a chief named Cuttulu Khan; and, having taken complete possession of that province, they extended their dominion over the districts of Midnapore and Bissuntpore, leaving the river Dummooda as the barrier between them and the Moghuls.

As soon as Khan Aazim had taken possession of Bengal, his attention was directed towards these troublesome neighbours; and, in the year 991, he sent a considerable army to A. D. 1583. expel them from those districts; but the chief to whom he entrusted the command of the expedition, not feeling himself sufficiently powerful to repel the Afghans by force, deputed the celebrated Fereed Addeen Bokhary, author of the History of the Emperor Jehangire, who held a considerable command in the Imperial army, to conclude a truce with Cuttulu Khan.

Fereed proceeded from Burdwan with an escort of three hundred chosen horse, and was met at the distance of four miles from Khoram by Cuttulu Khan. Both parties alighted from their horses, and having embraced, again mounted, and proceeded towards the fort, on the outside of which Cuttulu Khan had pitched a suite of tents, and prepared a grand entertainment for the ambassador.

Previous to the commencement of the feast, the Afghan chief introduced one of his commanders, named Behadur Khan, to the ambassador; but the latter, who prided himself on being a descendant of the Arabian Prophet, did not receive him with sufficient respect; on which the revengeful Afghan retired in disgust from the company, and gave orders to his adherents to be prepared to retaliate the insult. This was overheard by some of the followers of the ambassador, who communicated their suspicions to their master that treachery was intended. Fereed immediately took the hint, and, under pretence of sudden indisposition, requested leave to return to his own camp.

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He was permitted to depart by Cuttulu Khan, who, being probably ignorant of the circumstances, had no intention of injuring him: but shortly afterwards he was attacked by Behadur Khan, and many of his people killed.

This transaction threw a great stigma on the Afghans, and incensed the Moghul General, who immediately advanced from Burdwan, and compelled Cuttulu Khan to take refuge in the forests. But as Khan Aazim was at that period preparing to leave Bengal, and several of the chiefs who had come with him from Agra were anxious to accompany him back, they refused to pursue the Afghans into Orissa, and the whole army returned to Tondah.

Khan Aazim having settled the affairs of Bengal and Behar, resigned his employment, and arrived at Agra in the month of
A. D. 1584. Rubby al Avul (3d month of the year 992), and was most graciously received by the Emperor, who personally thanked him for his services.

SHAHBAZ KHAN KUMBO.

THIS chief had taken a very active part in the war of Bengal; and upon the rebellion of Masoom Ferunjudy, he was detached by Raja Todermul in pursuit of the rebel. He engaged him in the city of Oude; and, having entirely routed him, compelled him to seek refuge with the Rajas of the mountains, whose territories border on Oude. After this signal service, he rejoined the Raja's army at Hajypore, where he was again usefully employed.

After Khan Aazim had assumed the command of the Imperial army, Shahbaz Khan was detached, with several other chiefs, to ravage the estates of the Kakeshelans in Ghoragot;

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which having effected, he subdued the country as far as the banks of the Burhampooter.

In reward for these services, the Emperor was pleased to appoint him to succeed to the government of Behar and Bengal, upon the resignation of Khan Aazim; but so invidious was that office now held, that Shahbaz Khan declined the honour, and had actually proceeded as far as Joanpore, on his way to Agra, when he was met by a special messenger, commanding him to return and assume the government, under the pain of his Majesty's displeasure.

Shahbaz Khan, having returned to Bengal, experienced much difficulty in adjusting the affairs of that kingdom: the tribe of Kakeshelan, and the adherents of the other rebels, were still possessed of so much influence, that he found it impossible, or at least dangerous, to re-assume their jagiers. He therefore permitted them to retain quiet possession: and from the same motives was induced to enter into a treaty with Cuttulu Khan, the chief of the Afghans; relinquishing to them the province of Orissa, on condition that they should retire from Bengal, and refrain from further invasion.

These acts of the new Governor were not approved of at court: he was suspected of having received large sums of money for these concessions. He was therefore ordered, in the year 995, to deliver over the government to Vizier Khan Herevy, and to repair to Agra; where, upon his arrival, he was put into close imprisonment, and was not liberated for three years.

Vizier Khan Herevy appointed Governor, A. D. 1587.

Vizier Khan Herevy did not long enjoy his new dignity. He died the same year, at Tondah, without having effected any alteration in the system of his predecessor.

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SECT. VI.

RAJA KENORE MAN SING, OF ABNYR.

Mān Sing appointed Governor of Behar and Bengal—Subdues the Zemindar of Hajypore—Unsuccessful attempt to recover Orissa—His son, Juggut Sing, taken prisoner by the Afghans—Makes a temporary peace with them—The Afghans seize on the Temple of Jagernaut—The Raja obtains a decisive victory over them, and annexes Orissa to the Imperial dominions—Fixes on Agmahel (Rajemahel) for his capital of the three provinces—The Afghans again rebel, and enter Bengal—Peace restored—Sultan Khusero appointed nominal Governor of Orissa—The Raja of Couch Beyhar visits Bengal—The Governor accompanies the Emperor in an expedition against the Dekkan; on which the Afghans again invade Bengal, and obtain possession of great part of the kingdom—Mān Sing returns, and defeats the Afghans in a desperate battle—Resigns his government—Cause of his resignation—Attempts to raise his Son-in-law, the Emperor's grandson, to the Imperial throne—His conduct forgiven—Re-appointed Governor of Bengal; but soon afterwards recalled to Court.

WHEN intelligence of the death of Vizier Khan reached the Imperial court, which at that period was in the Punjab, the Emperor Akbar was pleased to bestow the government of Behar and Bengal on Raja Mān Sing, whose sister was married to the Prince Selim (afterwards Emperor, under the title of Jehangire); but as the Raja was then employed against the Afghans of Paishawur, orders were sent to Sayid Khan, who commanded at Patna, to assume the government till the arrival of the Raja, to whom instructions were also given to proceed to Bengal with all possible despatch.

A. D. 1589. Mān Sing arrived at Patna in the year 997. Here he learned, that Poorun Mull Khedurye, zemindar of Hajypore,

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A. D. 1589.

had taken advantage of the disturbances in that country, in order to amass considerable wealth; and that, having collected a numerous army, he had assumed a degree of influence incompatible with his situation. On this account, the Raja, being resolved to subdue the spirit of insurrection which had so long disturbed the quiet of the Eastern provinces, immediately marched his army into the territories of the Zemindar, and compelled him to take refuge in his fort; whence Poorun Mull, intimidated by the number of the Imperial forces, sent a most humble message, offering to disband his army, to pay a large sum of money, and to give up all his elephants, provided the Raja would pardon him, and allow him to retain his zemindary.

These terms were acceded to by the Raja, who immediately forwarded the elephants and money, by one of his agents, to court. This event was considered as an auspicious omen by the Emperor, who for a considerable time had received only mortifying intelligence from Bengal; and an honorary dress and congratulatory letter were sent to the Raja.

Some of the Moghul officers in Ghoragot, having extended the hand of rapine over the district of Jessore, the Raja sent his son, Juggut Sing, to punish them. The Moghul chiefs, unable to oppose the Imperial army, dispersed, and concealed themselves in the woods; but Juggut Sing seized their granaries, and fifty-four elephants, the latter of which were immediately forwarded to court.

Mān Sing having an unfavourable opinion of the climate of Bengal, continued to reside in Behar, and allowed Sayid Khan to remain as his deputy at Tondah.

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About this period, the Raja caused the important fortress of Rhotas to be put into complete repair; and added to the fortifications a lofty stone gateway, part of which is still standing. He also erected a house for his own occasional residence, deepened and repaired the reservoirs of water, and laid out a handsome garden in the Persian style.

A.D.1589-90.

In the year 998, the Raja planned an expedition for the recovery of Orissa out of the hands of the Afghans. Having assembled the troops of Behar, at Bhâgalpore, he marched through the western hills to Burdwan; but, previous to his setting out, he had ordered Sayid Khan to march with the troops of Bengal by the route of Cutwa, and to form a junction with him at Burdwan. Upon his arrival at this place, he received an apology from his deputy, stating, that he had experienced so much difficulty and delay in equipping his army, he was afraid the rainy season would set in before any thing could be effected against the Afghans; and therefore strongly advised the Raja to canton his army till the conclusion of the rains, when he would immediately join him. The Raja was much disappointed at this intelligence; but seeing no remedy, he directed cantonments to be built for the army at Jehanabad, on the banks of the Dalkisor river, not many miles distant from the present Calcutta.

Whilst the royal army was in this situation, waiting the junction of the Deputy Governor of Bengal, Cuttulu Khan ordered a division of his troops to advance to Dherpore, which was within fifty miles of Jehanabad, and to plunder the country in that vicinity. To put a stop to the ravages of the Afghans, the Raja detached his son, Juggut Sing, who compelled them to retire, and to take refuge under the guns of a fort; a number

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of which had been constructed in different parts of that country. At this place they pretended to enter into a negotiation, whilst they were in daily expectation of a reinforcement from Cuttulu Khan. The young Raja was deceived by their artifices; and as soon as the additional force arrived, the Afghans made an attack upon him by night, surprised his camp, took him prisoner, killed a great number of his people, and compelled the remainder to seek their safety in flight. This victory raised the spirits of the Afghans to the highest pitch of exultation: whilst the Raja was overwhelmed with confusion at the disgrace, and with sorrow on account of his son, who was carried prisoner to Bissuntpore, and, according to a report which prevailed for some days, had been put to death. SECT. VI.

Fortunately for the royal cause, Cuttulu Khan, who had been for some time much indisposed, died a few days after this event; and as his children were not arrived at the age of manhood, the Afghan chiefs released the son of the Raja, and, through him, sued for peace. As the rainy season was not yet terminated, and the Raja found himself unable to undertake any active measures, he readily listened to their proposals: in consequence of which the sons of Cuttulu Khan, attended by Khuaje Issa, their minister, visited the Raja, and presented him with one hundred and fifty elephants, and many other costly articles. They then agreed, if allowed to retain quiet possession of Orissa, to stamp the coin in the name of the Emperor, and to prefix his name to all public edicts: further, in compliment to the Raja, they agreed to give up to him the temple of Jagernaut and its domain, held sacred by all Hindoos. The latter article highly flattered the Raja and his Bramin

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counsellors: and the young Afghans, after being treated with every mark of respect and attention, were clothed in dresses of honour, and permitted to return to Orissa; soon after which the Raja broke up his cantonments, and returned to Behar.

Although the Emperor was displeased at the want of energy evinced by the Raja on this occasion, he would not dissolve the treaty; and as long as Khuaje Issa, the prime-minister of the Afghans, lived, the peace was preserved inviolate on both sides: but at the end of two years that able man quitted this transitory world, and the covetous Afghans seized upon the rich and sacred territory of Jagernaut.

This proceeding was considered as sacrilege by the pious Raja, and he requested the Emperor's permission to exterminate the Afghans from that province.

A. D. 1591-2. Having obtained the royal sanction, Raja Mān Sing, in the year 1000, ordered all the troops of Behar to proceed by the western road, called the Jarcund route, to Midnapore, whilst he himself embarked with a chosen detachment in boats; and, proceeding down the Ganges, compelled Sayid Khan, his deputy in Bengal, to unite his forces on this expedition.

The Afghans, alarmed at these preparations, assembled all their forces; and, having retreated across the Subanreeka river, waited there the approach of their enemies. The contending armies continued for some time encamped opposite each other, and daily skirmishes took place between their light troops. At length the natural impatience of the Afghans overcame their prudence; they recrossed the river, and, placing too much dependance upon their elephants, rushed with violence and precipitation upon the royal army, which being drawn up with much skill in battle array, having a

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number of guns posted along the front, waited with coolness the advance of the enemy. SECT. VI.

The fire from the Royal artillery soon threw the elephants into confusion, and drove them back with terror and dismay on the Afghan line; the squadrons of which having opened, and allowed the elephants to pass, made a desperate charge upon the Moghuls; but the latter, being superior in numbers, resisted them with vigour. The contest lasted nearly the whole day: at length the Afghans gave way, and sought their safety in flight. A.D. 1591-2.

The Raja pursued the enemy, and next day took possession of the city of Jellasore. At this place, Sayid Khan, deputy-governor of Bengal, tired of the campaign, and envious of the reputation of his superior officer, left the army without permission, and returned to Tondah.

Notwithstanding this defection, the Raja continued to pursue the fugitives, and compelled them to take refuge in Cuttack, a strong fortress, which was then in possession of Ramchund, the zemindar of the country, who had restored or changed its name to Saringghur.

The Raja having invested the fortress on all sides, left his army to carry on the siege, and embraced that opportunity of going to pay his devotions at the holy temple of Jaggernaut.

Whilst engaged in these solemn duties, he received several overtures from Ramchund and the Afghans in Cuttack; and upon his return to that place, finding little progress had been made in the siege, he consented to grant them peace, upon condition, that the Afghans should give up all their elephants, and promise to conduct themselves, in future, as faithful subjects of the Emperor; and that the Zemindar should pay the revenues of the district into the Royal treasury: in return for

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SECT. VI. which, jagiers were assigned to the Afghan chiefs in the district of Khaleefabad, and the Zemindar was allowed to retain possession of Cuttack and its dependencies. Thus the province of Orissa was again annexed to the Imperial dominions, and the Raja obtained much credit for his exertions.

After this splendid conquest, the Raja returned in triumph to Behar, whence he despatched 120 elephants, taken from the Afghans, to the Imperial presence. He then determined upon taking charge of both the governments of Behar and Bengal; and fixed upon the city of Agmahel, the name of which he changed to Rajemahel (Palace of Sovereignty), as the capital of the three provinces *. In this place he built a palace, and constructed a rampart of brick, strengthened with bastions, all round the town, the situation of which has been before described in the reign of Daood Khan Kerany. As the city increased in size and celebrity, the Mahommedans, as a compliment to the Emperor, dignified it with the title of Akbarnagur.

When the Raja returned towards Behar, he left a considerable force, under the command of his son, Juggut Sing,
A. D. 1592-3. upon the frontier of Orissa; and in the year 1001, the zemindar Ramchund having failed in his engagements, the Moghul army again entered his country, and took the forts of Jorwe, Subhal, Khareghur, and several other places. In the mean time, some exactions having been made from the Afghans, who by the treaty of peace had been allowed to retain their jagiers, they again rebelled, and, having advanced into Bengal, plundered the royal port of Saatgong, in the vicinity of the town now called Hoogly.

* This place, in antient times, under the Hindoo government, was called Raje Girhē.

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These events again called the Raja into the field; but finding it was impolitic to render the Afghans desperate, he allowed them to return to their jagiers; the Zemindar of Orissa, having made an apology for his past conduct, was also forgiven; and peace was once more restored to that unhappy province, the inhabitants of which had been so often plundered, and their fields destroyed, by the contending armies.

In the year 1002, Sultan Khusero, then a child, the grandson of the Emperor, was appointed nominal Governor of Orissa, and a portion of its revenue assigned for his jagier, and for the payment of 5000 troops supposed to be under his command. The Raja Mān Sing was confirmed as the young prince's deputy; and Sayid Khan removed from Bengal, and appointed commandant of the troops in Behar. During this year, Raja Mān Sing paid a visit to the Emperor, and returned to his government loaded with honours. A. D. 1593-4.

In the year 1004, Luchmen Narain, the Raja of Couch Beyhar, whose territory was bounded on the east by the river Burhampooter, on the south by Ghoragot, on the west by Tirhoot, and on the north by the mountains of Thibet and Assam, and who is said to have possessed an army of 100,000 infantry, 4000 cavalry, 700 elephants, and 1000 war boats, came to visit the Raja Mān Sing, and professed himself a vassal of the Emperor. This conduct gave offence to his relations and neighbouring princes; they united against him; and compelled him to take refuge in his fort, whence he wrote to the Governor of Bengal, requesting him to send a force to his relief. A. D. 1595-6.

This event gave the Moghuls the first opportunity of entering Couch Beyhar. A considerable detachment was sent, under the command of Jehaz Khan, who quickly dispersed the

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SECT. VI. rebels, released the Raja, and returned to Bengal loaded with plunder.

A. D. 1598-9. In the year 1007, the Emperor having determined on the conquest of the Dekkan, ordered Raja Mān Sing to join him with as many troops as could be spared from the defence of Bengal, and to leave that country under charge of his deputy.

A. D. 1599, 1600. The departure of the Raja served as a signal to raise the dormant spirit of the Afghans, who, in the year 1008, collected from all quarters, and, having placed Osman Khan, the son of the deceased Cuttulu Khan, at their head, again invaded Bengal. Mohan Sing, and Purtab Sing, the deputy-governors of the two provinces, united their forces, and advanced against the rebels. A general engagement took place in the vicinity of Bhenderuk, in which the Royal army was totally defeated; in consequence whereof great part of Bengal again became subject to the Afghans.

As soon as intelligence of this unlooked-for event reached the Emperor, he ordered Raja Mān Sing, then at Ajmire, to proceed immediately, with all the force he could collect, to Bengal.

A. D. 1599, 1600. The Raja having advanced, in the year 1008, by long marches, to Rhotas, halted there, to rest his army, and to give the dispersed Moghuls an opportunity of joining him. Having effected these purposes, he advanced to Seerpore Attaya, where he found the Afghans waiting to oppose him: a regular engagement ensued, and, notwithstanding the experience the Afghans had of the dangerous effects of their elephants, they again placed them in the front of the battle: these animals were soon driven back upon their ranks; and the Moghuls and

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Rajepoots immediately charging, completed the route. The Afghans fled, and were pursued many miles by their conquerors. SECT. VI.

A curious circumstance occurred in this battle, which gave the Raja great satisfaction. In the former engagement, in which the Royal army had suffered a defeat, Meer Abdul Rezack, the paymaster of the Imperial forces, was taken prisoner, and carried about in triumph by the Afghans; who, fearing that he might make his escape during the approaching contest, placed him upon an elephant, in the midst of the battle, with chains on his hands and feet. On the same elephant was seated a fierce Afghan, with positive orders to dispatch his prisoner, should victory favour their adversaries. In this situation, Abdul Rezack was exposed to the fire of his friends; but, fortunately, a musquet-ball having killed the Afghan, the Moghul troops came up, and released the unhappy prisoner from his perilous situation. Critical situation of Meer Abdul Rezack.

This victory, aided by the presence of the Raja Mān Sing, annihilated the hopes of the Afghans: they retired from the field, and returned to Orissa, there to wait for a more favourable opportunity of recovering their lost power.

After this victory, the Raja paid a visit to the Emperor, and was promoted to the command of 7000 horse; a dignity which, before that time, had not been conferred on any subject. After a short residence at court, he returned to his government.

Raja Mān Sing continued to govern the eastern provinces, with great prudence and justice, till the year 1013, when, at his own request, he was permitted to resign; and upon his arrival at Agra, having presented the Emperor with 900 A. D. 1604.

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elephants, and various curiosities, he was received in the most gracious manner, and honoured by many proofs of the Royal esteem.

Man Sing resigns his government, A. D. 1604. Succeeded by Abdul Mujeed Asuf Khan.

When Raja Mān Sing signified his desire of resigning his government, a nobleman, named Abdul Mujeed Asuf Khan, was appointed to that important trust, and took charge of his office in the year 1013.

The cause of Raja Mān Sing's resignation of so valuable a government, in which he was considered as established for life, will be elucidated by the following extract from the History of Hindoostan.

"When the indisposition of the Emperor Akbar rendered him incapable of attending to public business, the whole weight of government fell on Khan Aazim, the Vizier. Selim, Akbar's only surviving son, notwithstanding the disputes which he formerly had with his father, was still looked upon as the heir of the empire; but the Vizier's daughter being married to Khusero, the eldest son of Selim, that minister was desirous of placing the reins of government in the hands of his son-in-law. He was supported in this scheme by many of the nobles; the most enterprising and powerful of whom was Raja Mān Sing, whose sister was mother of Khusero. The Raja, from the antiquity of his family, and his own address, commanded all the Hindoo interest in the empire; and he had, at that very time, twenty thousand of his native subjects, of the Rajepoot tribe, in, and near the environs of the capital, prepared to execute his orders. Selim, being apprised of the powerful confederacy against him, waited upon his father two days before his death, and laid before him all their schemes. The Emperor summoned Mān

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Sing and the Vizier to his presence; reprimanded them severely; and having publickly acknowledged Selim his lawful successor in the empire, obliged the confederate lords to pay him homage, and to promise to support his title*." SECT. VI.

The Emperor Akbar died on the 16th of Jemmad al Akhir (the 6th month) of the year 1014; and immediately upon this event, the Vizier and Raja Mān Sing formed a conspiracy to place Khusero, the son of Selim, on the throne, in preference to his father. Their scheme was not successful; and the Raja and the young prince were compelled to make their escape on board a boat from Agra. October, A. D. 1605.

The new Emperor, Jehangire, shortly forgave his son, and deemed it prudent policy to overlook the conduct of the Raja: but in order to remove the latter to a distance from the scene of intrigue, he again appointed him to the government of Bengal, with orders to proceed thither immediately, and keep in check the rebellious spirit of the Afghans. Man Sing re-appointed Governor of Bengal.

In obedience to the Royal orders, Raja Mān Sing returned to Bengal; but at the end of eight months, that is to say, early in the year 1015, he was recalled to court†. As it frequently happens that great events arise from apparently inadequate causes, thus the removal of an able and experienced officer from the government of three rich and extensive provinces is attributed to the love of Jehangire for the fair Noor Jehan, then the wife of another person. Again recalled A. D. 1606.

* See Dow's History of Hindoostan, vol. III.

† Raja Mān Sing was allowed to enjoy a life of ease for some years, on his paternal estates, but was afterwards appointed to the command of an army in the Dekkan, and died there A. H. 1023 (A. D. 1615). It is related, that sixty women were burnt on his funeral pile; and that his seraglio consisted of fifteen hundred women, by each of whom he had two or three children, all of whom died before their father, except his successor, Raja Bhao Sing.

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SECT. VI.

CUTTUB ADDEEN KHAN KOKULTASH KOKA.

The Emperor Jehangire confers the Government of the three Provinces on Cuttub Addeen Khan, his Foster-brother—Shere Afgun, a Chief of Burdwan, refuses to wait on the new Governor—This circumstance explained by the history of Chaja Aiass—Birth of the beautiful Noor-Jehan—Her marriage with Shere—Persecution of her husband—Cuttub proceeds to Burdwan, and is killed, with several of his Nobles, by Shere, who also falls in the contest—Affliction of the Emperor at the death of Cuttub.

WHEN the Emperor Jehangire felt himself firmly established on his throne, and found that he could dispense with the services of Raja Mān Sing, he recalled him from Bengal, and appointed his own foster-brother, Cuttub Addeen Kokultash, to the government of the three provinces of Behar, Bengal, and Orissa. On the 9th of the month Suffer, of the year
A.D. 1606. 1015, the new Governor was invested with the robes of office, and, in addition to the usual present of horses, elephants, and arms, received from the royal treasury 200,000 rupees for his own expenses, and 300,000 for the expenses of his followers.

Some months after the arrival of the new Governor at the capital of Bengal, he took offence that Shere Afgun, a nobleman celebrated for his great prowess, but who, disgusted with court, had retired to his estate in Burdwan, had not come to Rajemahel, to congratulate him upon his accession to the government; he therefore summoned him to appear, and to clear himself from some charges of which he stood accused. Shere, suspecting that treachery was designed, refused to move from Burdwan; and the Viceroy, having represented

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this contumacious conduct to the Emperor, received orders to send Shere Afgun a prisoner to court; and if this measure should be found impracticable, to put him to death, either by open force or by stratagem. SECT. VI. A. D. 1606.

Such were the ostensible motives assigned for this transaction; but, in order to elucidate the real cause of this event, it becomes requisite to revert to the History of Hindoostan, and to introduce to the reader one of the most celebrated characters that has ever appeared on the theatre of Asia.*

History of Chaja Aiass.

"About twenty years before this period, Chaja Aiass, a native of the western Tartary, left that country to push his fortune in Hindoostan. He was descended of an ancient and noble family, fallen into decay by various revolutions of fortune. He, however, had received a good education, which was all his parents could bestow. Falling in love with a young woman as poor as himself, he married her; but he found it difficult to provide for her the very necessaries of life. Reduced to the last extremity, he turned his thoughts upon India, the usual resource of the needy Tartars of the north. He left privately friends, who either would not, or could not assist him, and turned his face to a foreign country. His all consisted of one sorry horse, and a very small sum of money, which had proceeded from the sale of his other effects. Placing his wife upon the horse, he walked by her side. She happened to be with child, and could ill endure the fatigue

* The same motives which were assigned in page 126, respecting Shere Shah, have caused the insertion of this extract from the History of Hindoostan; and the beauty of the style induces me to give it verbatim, although it varies, in some trifling particulars, from my Persian Manuscripts.

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of so great a journey. Their scanty pittance of money was soon expended: they had even subsisted for some days upon charity, when they arrived on the skirts of the Great Solitudes which separate Tartary from the dominions of the family of Timur, in India. No house was there to cover them from the inclemency of the weather; no hand to relieve their wants. To return, was certain misery; to proceed, apparent destruction.

They had fasted three days: to complete their misfortunes, the wife of Aiass was taken in labour. She began to reproach her husband for leaving his native country at an unfortunate hour; for exchanging a quiet, though poor life, for the ideal prospect of wealth in a distant country. In this distressed situation she brought forth a daughter. They remained in the place for some hours, with a vain hope that travellers might pass that way. They were disappointed: human feet seldom tread these deserts. The sun declined apace: they feared the approach of night: the place was the haunt of wild beasts; and should they escape their hunger, they must fall by their own. Chaja Aiass, in this extremity, having placed his wife on the horse, found himself so much exhausted that he could scarcely move. To carry the child was impossible: the mother could not even hold herself fast on the horse. A long contest began between humanity and necessity: the latter prevailed, and they agreed to expose the child on the highway. The infant, covered with leaves, was placed under a tree; and the disconsolate parents proceeded in tears.

When they had advanced about a mile from the place, and the eyes of the mother could no longer distinguish the solitary tree under which she had left her daughter, she gave way to grief; and throwing herself from the horse on the

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ground, exclaimed, "My child! my child!" She endeavoured to raise herself; but she had no strength to return. Aiass was pierced to the heart. He prevailed upon his wife to sit down: he promised to bring her the infant. He arrived at the place. No sooner had his eyes reached the child, than he was almost struck dead with horror. A black snake, it is said, was coiled around it; and Aiass believed he beheld him extending his fatal jaws to devour the infant. The father rushed forward: the serpent, alarmed at his vociferation, retired into the hollow tree. He took up his daughter unhurt, and returned to the mother. He gave her child into her arms; and, as he was informing her of the wonderful escape of the infant, some travellers appeared, and soon relieved them of all their wants. They proceeded gradually, and came to Lahore. SECT. VI.

The Emperor Akbar, at the arrival of Aiass*, kept his court at Lahore. Asuf Khan, one of that monarch's principal omrahs, attended then the presence. He was a distant relation to Aiass, and he received him with attention and friendship. To employ him, he made him his own secretary. Aiass soon recommended himself to Asuf in that station; and, by some accident, his diligence and ability attracted the notice of the Emperor, who raised him to the command of a thousand horse. He became, in process of time, master of the household; and his genius being still greater than even his good fortune, he raised himself to the office and title of Actimâd-ul-Dowla, or High-treasurer of the empire. Thus he, who had almost perished through mere want in the desert, became, in the space of a few years, the first subject in India.

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* In the Tarikh Khafy Khan, he is called Ghyas Beg.

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The daughter, who had been born to Aiass in the desert, received, soon after his arrival at Lahore, the name of Mher-ul-Nissa, or the Sun of Women. She had some right to the appellation; for in beauty she excelled all the ladies of the East. She was educated with the utmost care and attention. In music, in dancing, in poetry, in painting, she had no equal among her sex. Her disposition was volatile, her wit lively and satirical, her spirit lofty and uncontrouled. Selim, the prince-royal, visited one day her father. When the public entertainment was over, when all, except the principal guests, were withdrawn, and wine was brought on the table, the ladies, according to custom, were introduced in their veils. The ambition of Mher-ul-Nissa aspired to a conquest of the prince. She sung—he was in raptures; she danced—he could hardly be restrained, by the rules of decency, to his place. Her stature, her shape, her gait, had raised his ideas of her beauty to the highest pitch. When his eyes seemed to devour her, she, as by accident, dropt her veil; and shone upon him, at once, with all her charms. The confusion, which she could well feign, on the occasion, heightened the beauty of her face. Her timid eye by stealth fell upon the prince, and kindled all his soul into love. He was silent for the remaining part of the evening. She endeavoured to confirm, by her wit, the conquest which the charms of her person had made.

Selim, distracted with his passion, knew not what course to take. Mher-ul-Nissa had been betrothed, by her father, to Aly Cooly Shere Afgun, a Turkomanian nobleman of great renown. Selim applied to his father Akbar, who sternly refused to commit a piece of injustice, though in favour of the heir of his throne. The prince retired abashed; and Mher-ul-

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Nissa became the wife of Shere Afgun. The latter, however, suffered in his prospects of life, for not having made a voluntary resignation of the lady to the enamoured prince. Though Selim durst make no open attack upon his fortunate rival, during the life of Akbar, men in office worshipped the rising sun, and threw accumulated disgrace on Shere Afgun. He became disgusted, and left the court of Agra. He retired into the province of Bengal, and obtained, from the Subahdar of that country, the superintendency of the district of Burdwan.

The passion for Mher-ul-Nissa, which Selim had repressed from a respect and fear of his father, returned with redoubled violence when he himself mounted the throne of India. He was now absolute; no subject could thwart his will and pleasure. He recalled Shere Afgun from his retreat. He was afraid, however, to go so much against the current of the public opinion, as to deprive that amyr of his wife. Shere was inflexible: no man of honour in India can part with his spouse, and retain his life. His incredible strength and bravery had rendered Shere extremely popular. He was naturally high-spirited and proud; and it was not to be expected that he would yield to indignity and public shame. His family, and his former reputation, were high. Born of noble parents in Turkomania, he had spent his youth in Persia; and had served, with uncommon renown, Shaw Ismael the third of the Sufviye line. His original name was Asta Jillô, but having killed a lion, he was dignified with the title of Shere Afgun, or the Overthrower of the Lion. Under the latter name he became famous in India. In the wars of Akbar, he had served with great reputation. He had distinguished himself in a particular manner under Khan Khanan, at the taking of Sind, by

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SECT. VI. exhibiting prodigies of personal strength and valour. Preferments had been heaped upon him; and he was highly esteemed at court during the life of Akbar, who loved in others that daring intrepidity for which he himself was renowned.

Jehangire kept his court at Dehly, when he called Shere Afgun to the presence. He received him graciously, and conferred new honours upon him. Shere Afgun, naturally open and generous, suspected not the Emperor's intentions. Time, he thought, had erased the memory of Mher-ul-Nissa from Jehangire's mind. He was deceived: the monarch was resolved to remove his rival; but the means he used were at once ungenerous and disgraceful. He appointed a day for hunting; and ordered the haunt of an enormous tiger to be explored. News was soon brought, that a tiger of an extraordinary size was discovered in the forest of Nidarbari. This savage, it was said, had carried off many of the largest oxen from the neighbouring villages. The Emperor directed thither his march, attended by Shere Afgun, and all his principal officers, with their train of dependants. Having, according to the custom of the Moghul Tartars, surrounded the ground for many miles, they began to move toward the center, on all sides. The tiger was rouzed: his roaring was heard in all quarters; and the Emperor hastened to the place.

The nobility being assembled, Jehangire called aloud, "Who among you will advance singly, and attack this tiger?" They looked on one another in silence: then all turned their eyes on Shere Afgun. He seemed not to understand their meaning. At length three omrahs started forth from the circle, and, sacrificing fear to shame, fell at the Emperor's feet, and begged permission to try singly their strength against the

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formidable animal. The pride of Shere Afgun arose. He had imagined that none durst attempt a deed so dangerous. He hoped that after the refusal of the nobles, the honour of the enterprise would devolve in course on his hands. But three had offered themselves for the combat; and they were bound in honour to insist on their prior right. Afraid of losing his former renown, Shere Afgun began thus in the presence: "To attack an animal with weapons is both unmanly and unfair. God has given to man limbs and sinews, as well as to tigers: he has added reason to the former, to conduct his strength." The other omrahs objected in vain, "That all men were inferior to the tiger in strength, and that he could be overcome only with steel." "I will convince you of your mistake," Shere Afgun replied; and, throwing down his sword and shield, prepared to advance unarmed. SECT. VI.

Though the Emperor was, in secret, pleased with a proposal full of danger to Shere, he made a shew of dissuading him from the enterprise. Shere was determined. The monarch, with feigned reluctance, yielded. Men knew not whether they ought most to admire the courage of the man, or to exclaim against the folly of the deed. Astonishment was painted in every face: every tongue was silent. Writers give a particular but incredible detail of the battle between Shere Afgun and the tiger. This much is certain, that, after a long and obstinate struggle, the astonishing warrior prevailed, and, though mangled with wounds himself, laid at last the savage dead at his feet. The thousands who were eye-witnesses of the action were even almost afraid to vouch for the truth of the exploit, with their concurring testimony. The fame of Shere was increased, and the designs of the Emperor failed.

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SECT. VI. But the determined cruelty of the latter stopt not here: other means of death were contrived against the unfortunate Shere.

He had scarcely recovered from his wounds, when he came to pay his respects at court. He was caressed by the Emperor; and he suspected no guile. A snare however was prepared for him. Jehangire had meanly condescended to give private orders to the rider of one of his largest elephants, to waylay his rival, in one of the narrow streets, when he next should return to court, and there to tread him to death. As accidents of that kind sometimes happen, from the rage of those animals in the rutting season, the thing might have passed without suspicion. Shere was carried in his palanky. He saw the elephant in his way. He gave orders to the bearers to return back: the elephant came forward: they threw the palanky, with their master, in the street, and fled to save their lives. Shere saw his danger. He had just time to rise. He drew a short sword, which always hung by his side: with this weapon he struck the elephant across the root of the trunk, which he cut off with one blow. The animal roared, turned from him, fell down and expired. The Emperor was looking out at a window: he retired with amazement and shame. Shere continued his way to the palace. Without any suspicion of treachery, he related the particulars to Jehangire. The latter disguised his sentiments, but relinquished not his designs. He praised the strength and valour of Shere, who retired satisfied, and unsuspecting, from the presence.

Whether the Emperor endeavoured to conquer his passion for Mher-ul-Nissa, or felt remorse from his own behaviour, is uncertain; but, for the space of six months, no further attempts were made against the life of Shere, who now retired

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to Bengal. The former designs of Jehangire were no secret: they were the subject of common conversation, little to the advantage of the character of a great prince. Absolute monarchs, however, are never without men who flatter their worst passions, and administer to their most pernicious pleasures. Cuttub, subahdar of Bengal, was one of these convenient sycophants. To ingratiate himself with the Emperor, though perhaps not by his express commands, he hired forty ruffians to attack and murder Shere, when an opportunity should offer. Shere was apprized of the intentions of Cuttub. He continued within doors; but such was his confidence in his own strength and valour, that at night he would not permit his servants to remain in his house. They, according to custom, retired each to his own home. An old porter only remained, of the men-servants, under the same roof with Shere. The assassins were no strangers to a circumstance common in India. They made their observations upon the house: they found that there was a room on the right hand within the principal door, which Shere used as a writing chamber. This room communicated, by a narrow passage, with the sleeping apartments. When it was dark, they took advantage of the old porter's absence, and conveyed themselves, without discovery, into the house.

The principal door being bolted at the usual hour, Shere and his family went to bed. Some of the assassins, when they thought he was fallen asleep, stole silently into his apartment. They prepared to plunge their daggers into his body, when one of them, who was an old man, being touched with remorse, cried out with a loud voice, "Hold! have we "not the Emperor's orders? Let us behave like men. Shall

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"forty fall upon one; and that one asleep!" "Boldly spoken!" said Shere, starting that instant from his bed. Seizing his sword, he placed himself in a corner of the room: there he was attacked by the assassins. In a few minutes, many of the villains lay, weltering in their blood, at his feet. Scarce one half escaped without a wound. The old man, who had given warning, did not attempt to fly. Shere took him by the hand, praised and thanked him for his behaviour, and, having inquired about those who hired the assassins, dismissed him, with handsome presents, to relate the particulars abroad.

The fame of this gallant exploit resounded through the whole empire. Shere could not stir abroad for the mob, who pressed around him. He, however, thought proper to retire from the capital of Bengal, to his old residence at Burdwan. He hoped to live there in obscurity and safety, with his beloved Mher-ul-Nissa. He was deceived: the Subahdar of Bengal had received his government for the purpose of removing the unfortunate Shere; and he was not ungrateful. After deliberating with himself about the means, he at last fell upon an effectual expedient. Settling the affairs of his government at Rajemahel, which was at that time the capital of Bengal, he resolved, with a great retinue, to make the tour of the dependent provinces. In his route, he came to Burdwan. He made no secret to his principal officers, that he had the Emperor's orders for dispatching Shere. That devoted amyr, hearing that the Subahdar was entering the town in which he resided, mounted his horse, and, with two servants only, went to pay his respects. The Subahdar received Shere with affected politeness. They rode, for some time, side by side; and their

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conversation turned upon indifferent affairs. The Subahdar suddenly stopped: he ordered his elephant of state to be brought; which he mounted, under a pretence of appearing with becoming pomp in the city of Burdwan. Shere stood still, when the Subahdar was ascending; and one of the pikemen, pretending that Shere was in the way, struck his horse, and began to drive him before him. Shere was enraged at the affront: he knew that the pikeman durst not have used that freedom without his master's orders: he saw plainly that there was a design laid against his life. Turning therefore round upon the pikeman, he threatened him with instant death. The man fell on the ground, and begged for mercy. Swords were drawn. Shere had no time to lose: he spurred his horse up to the elephant, on which the Subahdar was mounted, and, having broken down the *ambhary* or castle, cut him in two: and thus the unfortunate Cuttub became the victim of his own zeal to please the Emperor. Shere did not rest here: he turned his sword on the other officers. The first that fell by his hands was Aba Khan, a native of Cashmire, who was an amyr of five thousand horse. Four other nobles shared the same fate: a death attended every blow from the hand of Shere. The remaining chiefs were at once astonished and frightened: they fled to a distance, and formed a circle around him. Some began to gall him with arrows; others to fire with their musquets. His horse, at length, being shot with a ball in the forehead, fell under him. The unfortunate Shere, reduced to the last extremity, began to upbraid them with cowardice. He invited them severally to single combat; but he begged in vain. He had already received some wounds: he plainly saw his approaching fate. Turning his face toward Mecca, he took up

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some dust with his hand; and, for want of water, threw it, by way of ablution, upon his head. He then stood up, seemingly unconcerned. Six balls entered his body, in different places, before he fell. His enemies had scarcely courage to come near, till they saw him in the last agonies of death. They praised his valour to the skies; but, in adding to his reputation, they took away from their own.

The officer, who succeeded the deceased Subahdar in the command of the troops, hastened to the house of Shere. He was afraid that Mher-ul-Nissa, in the first paroxysms of grief, might make away with herself. That lady, however, bore her misfortunes with more fortitude and resignation. She was unwilling to adopt the manners of her country, upon such tragical occasions: she even pretended, in vindication of her apparent insensibility, to follow the injunctions of her deceased lord. She alleged that Shere, foreseeing his own fall by Jehangire, had conjured her to yield to the desires of that monarch without hesitation. The reasons which she said he gave were as feeble as the fact itself was improbable—he was afraid that his own exploits would sink into oblivion, without they were connected with the remarkable event of giving an empress to India."

When intelligence of the death of Cuttub Addeen Khan reached the Emperor, he was much afflicted, as he had ever found him a faithful and devoted servant; and it is said, that, on this occasion, Jehangire made a vow he would never see the lady who had been, though unconsciously, the cause of his favourite's death: but the beauty and attractions of that accomplished female made him change his resolution, and, for

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many years, she, conjointly with him, ruled the empire of India. A circumstance so uncommon in an Asiatic government is thus recorded on the coin of that period: SECT. VI.

بحکم شاہ جہانگیر یافت صد زیور
بنام نور جہان بادشہ بیکم زر

By order of the Emperor Jehangire, gold acquired a hundred times additional value by the name of the Empress Noor Jehan (*Light of the World.*)

Khafy Khan's History.

JEHANGIRE COOLY KHAN CABULY.

EARLY in the year 1016, Jehangire Cooly Khan, who was then governor of Behar, was, upon the death of Cuttub Addeen, ordered to take charge of Bengal. This was an officer of highly distinguished courage: he had gained great celebrity by the overthrow and death of Sunkeram, Raja of Gorackpore, who had frequently been guilty of disobedience to the royal authority. A. D. 1607.

In his disposition were blended the opposite qualities of piety and cruelty: he constantly retained in his service a hundred persons who could repeat the Koran by heart, and who, at the end of every repetition, bestowed on him the merit arising therefrom*. He also attended prayers five times daily, and was much employed in religious offices; but, as a judge, he was inexorable. While engaged in prayers, he frequently, by a motion of his hand, gave the signal for the flogging, hanging, or beheading a culprit. He was at all times attended by a hundred trumpeters, who, whenever the villagers disputed with him respecting their rents, used to make

* The English reader may perhaps be surprised at this circumstance; but if he will recollect that his own ancestors frequently bequeathed large sums of money for Masses, to be said for their souls, he will perceive that the Governor only anticipated events.

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SECT. VI. so dreadful a noise as terrified the rustics into submission. He was also constantly accompanied by a hundred Cashmirian archers, who could bring down the smallest bird in its flight, and who were ready to pierce with their arrows any person pointed out in the crowd: in short, he was detested by the inhabitants of Behar; but, fortunately for those of Bengal, he died in little more than a year after he had assumed that government, and before he had time to make them feel the effects of his cruelty.

SHAIKH ALA ADDEEN ISLAM KHAN.

Islam Khan appointed to the Government—Makes Dacca the Capital of the Province—Account of the Portuguese Pirates—Sebastian Gonzales takes possession of Sundeep, and several other islands at the mouth of the Ganges, and attains to great power—Anaporam, brother of the King of Arracan, takes refuge at Sundeep—Gives his Sister in marriage to Gonzales—Dies—The King of Arracan enters into a confederacy with the Pirates—Their united forces invade Bengal—defeated—The Afghans, under Osman Khan, rebel—The Governor sends an Ambassador to them—The Afghans refuse to submit—The Governor sends an army, under Shujáet Khan, against them—A general engagement ensues, which, after a hard-fought contest, terminates in favour of the Moghuls—Osman Khan having been killed, his brother and son supplicate for peace—The Governor sends his own son, Hoshung, with the prisoners and elephants to Agra—The Governor of Behar being absent, an Impostor assumes the title of Sultan Khusero, and takes possession of Patna—The Governor returns, and puts the Impostor to death—Islam Khan dies.

A. D. 1608. In the year of the Hejira 1017, the government of Bengal being vacant by the death of the late occupant, the

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Emperor was pleased to promote Islam Khan to that office: he at the same time appointed Afzul Khan to the charge of Behar.

Dacca made the capital of Bengal.

The first act of Islam Khan's authority was the removal of the seat of government from Rajemahel to the city of Dacca; the name of which, in compliment to the reigning Emperor, he changed to Jehangire-nagur. He built there a palace, and a brick fort, some remains of which are still standing.

Although the Oriental historians have not assigned any reason for Islam Khan's changing the seat of government, his motives are satisfactorily accounted for in the annals of Portuguese Asia.

Portuguese Pirates.

It appears, that, at the conclusion of the 16th century, a number of Portuguese were settled on the coast of Arracan and Chittagong: many of these had entered into the service of the native princes; and, from their knowledge of maritime affairs, and by their desperate bravery, had risen to considerable commands, and had obtained extensive grants of land, both on the continent and in the adjacent islands.

A. D. 1607.

The treacherous or turbulent conduct of these adventurers having given offence to the Raja of Arracan, he, early in the year 1016, determined to extirpate them from his dominions: many were in consequence put to death, but a number of them escaped, in nine or ten small vessels, to the islands at the mouth of the river Ganges, where, for some time, they lived by piracy*.

* See Translation of Faria de Souza's History, vol. III. p. 154.

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A. D. 1067. This conduct having attracted the notice of Futteh Khan, the Moghul commander of the Island of Sundeep, he ordered all the Portuguese inhabitants and other Christians on the island to be seized and put to death. He then embarked, with 600 soldiers, on board forty vessels, and went in pursuit of the pirates. He found them at anchor off the Island of Deccan Shabazpore, and attacked them with great vigour; but the superior skill of the Portuguese, in the management of their ships and the use of their cannon, counterbalanced the advantage of numbers; and, after a hard-fought contest, which lasted the whole night, Futteh Khan, with the greater part of his troops, was killed, and the whole of his fleet captured.

This unexpected victory raised the fame of the pirates; and, in consequence, their countrymen and Christian converts joined them from all quarters. They elected for their chief a common sailor, named Sebastian Gonzales, and determined to secure for themselves a permanent settlement, by taking possession of the Island of Sundeep.

March, A. D. 1609. In the year 1018, the whole Portuguese force, consisting of 400 men, landed at Sundeep; upon which the brother of Futteh Khan, with the Mohammedan troops, took refuge in a small fort, while the Hindoo inhabitants remained neutral spectators of the contest; but as the garrison expected no quarter, they defended themselves with great resolution, and the siege was protracted for a considerable time: at length, a Spanish ship having cast anchor at the island, the captain of her agreed to assist the Portuguese; and having, at night, landed fifty of his men, he marched with lighted torches, and drums beating; and, being joined by the Portuguese, they attacked the fort, entered it, and put the whole of the garrison to the sword. The natives of the islands immediately

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submitted, and were granted security of their lives and property, on condition of delivering up all the Mohammedans: of these 1000 were brought to the fort, and, in revenge for the Portuguese families that had been put to death by Futteh Khan, were butchered in cold blood.

Thus Sebastian Gonzales became absolute master of the island of Sundeep, and was obeyed by the natives and Portuguese as an independent prince. In the course of a short time, his force consisted of 1000 Portuguese, 2000 Indian soldiers, 200 cavalry, and eighty sail of vessels, of various sizes and well mounted with cannon; and, as his government was conducted with equity, many merchants resorted to the island, and, by their commerce, contributed much to increase his revenue.

The neighbouring chiefs, astonished at the prodigious success of Gonzales, sought his friendship, and deprecated his wrath; but, as he was of an intractable and covetous disposition, he listened not to their friendly overtures; and although he was under great obligations to the Raja of *Batecala*, who had first given refuge to the Portuguese in their distress, he ungratefully seized upon the islands of Shahbazpore and Patelbanga, which belonged to that chief; by which means his territories became as extensive as those of some independent princes; and, consisting entirely of islands, were secure from the attacks of an enemy, so long as the Portuguese were masters of the sea*.

About this period, an event occurred which contributed much to the fame and riches of the pirates. Anaporam, a

* These islands, which are all situated at the mouth of the eastern branch of the Ganges, are, at present, but thinly inhabited, their only productions being rice and salt; and their climate is supposed to be very unfavourable to European constitutions.

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SECT. VI. brother of the King of Arracan, who was governor of one of the districts in that country, having been guilty of some misdemeanour, fled, and took refuge at Sundeep, where he prevailed upon Sebastian Gonzales, by the promise of a large sum of money, and his sister in marriage, to espouse his cause, and to assist him in the recovery of his government. Gonzales, in consequence, sent a detachment of troops, and several ships, with Anaporam, to the coast of Arracan; but they were so vigorously opposed, that they were obliged to return without effecting any thing more than bringing off the wealth and family of Anaporam, who, in compliance with his promise, paid Gonzales a large sum of money, and permitted his sister to turn Christian, and to become the wife of the pirate. The prince, shortly after this event, died, not without suspicion of having been poisoned; and all his wealth fell into the hands of Gonzales.

A. D. 1610. The following year, the Raja of Arracan, having determined to invade Bengal, sent an envoy to Sundeep, to conclude a treaty of peace with the pirates, and to request their co-operation against the Moghul forces: he was also authorised to demand the wife and children of the deceased prince. The latter request was immediately complied with; and the lady, having been carried to Chittagong, was married to the Governor of that place.

A league was shortly after concluded between the Raja and the Portuguese; by which it was stipulated, that the Raja should invade Bengal with a large army by land; and that the Portuguese should co-operate by sea, and with their small vessels protect and guard the passage of the rivers. The Raja also agreed to place his own fleet under the command of

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Gonzales, provided the latter gave his nephew as a hostage for its safe return. It was further stipulated, that whatever conquests were made, should be equally divided between the contracting parties. Every thing having been settled to their mutual satisfaction, the combined forces proceeded towards Bengal, and, without opposition, took possession of the country in the vicinity of Luckipore and Bulloah, on the eastern side of the river Megna: but, a numerous army of the Moghul troops soon after arriving, the Arracanners were defeated with great slaughter; and the Portuguese, having neglected to occupy the rivers with their gun-boats, the former were pursued nearly as far as Chittagong; and the Raja, with great difficulty, effected his escape upon an elephant.

Such were, probably, the circumstances which induced Islam Khan to change the seat of government, and to fix his residence at Dacca; where, by his alertness in opposing the invaders upon all occasions, he so much recommended himself to the Emperor, that he was promoted to the rank of commander of 5000 horse. Fortunate, indeed, it was for the inhabitants of Bengal, that they at that time possessed so active and enterprising a Governor; for scarcely were their minds freed from the incursions of the Mughs, when they were threatened by an enemy from the opposite quarter.

In the year 1020, the Afghan chief, Osman Khan, son of Cuttulu Khan*, evinced signs of his turbulent and unbroken spirit. In order to bring him to a proper sense of his duty, the Governor had the moderation to send to him an ambassador, who, in an eloquent speech, attempted to convince the Afghans A. D. 1611.

* See page 183.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1611.

of the folly of drawing on themselves the Imperial arms, and the little chance there was of again shaking off the Moghul yoke, which he asserted pressed lighter on them than any other class of his Majesty's subjects: that, united in the faith of Mohammed, it was their duty, as the inferior power, to bend to, and endeavour to assimilate with, the conquerors: that nations rise and fall by destiny: that for six hundred years the Afghans had ruled Hindoostan with despotic sway; but that Fate had now consigned the sceptre to the hands of the Moghuls: they ought, therefore, to bear their lot with humility and resignation, and bend down in submission to the Divine decree. Had this address been made to any other nation, it is possible it might have been attended with effect; but as, to the present day, the Afghans have never been able to "convert their swords into ploughshares," and, of the descendants of the numerous bands of that tribe who formerly overran Bengal, not a man is to be found who will condescend to cultivate the ground, the rhetoric of the ambassador was thrown to the winds. The haughty Osman Khan, at the head of 20,000 Afghans, considered himself as a second Alexander, and breathed nothing but war and independence.

The Governor, having been thus foiled in amicable overtures, lost not another moment in making preparations to subdue this haughty spirit: he fitted out a numerous and well-appointed army, the command of which he entrusted to Shujâet Khan, a brave and experienced officer, with orders to expel the whole of the turbulent Afghans from Orissa.

Upon the approach of the Royal army, Osman Khan advanced to the banks of the Subanreeka river, the neighbourhood of which abounded with swamps and quagmires,

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and was consequently unfavourable for the operations of the Moghul Cavalry. The Imperial General, however, advanced in battle array, and found the Afghans drawn out ready to receive him. Osman had placed his war-elephants in front of the columns destined for the attack; and, upon the signal being given, these furious animals advanced, and bore down every thing before them. Syed Adam and Iftikhar Khan, who commanded the right and left wings of the Imperial army, with a number of other chiefs of note, were soon extended on the plain. Notwithstanding great numbers of the rebels had become the food of the blood-thirsty sword, and were fallen in the dust of destruction*, Osman, elated by the death of so many of the Royal chiefs, and regardless of the number of his own people who were slain, being preceded by a celebrated elephant named Bukhteh, advanced in person into the heat of the action; but being exceedingly corpulent, he rode a quiet elephant, carrying an *ambhary*, or covered seat, from which he discharged his arrows with great execution. Having, at length, reached the post of Shujâet Khan, the Imperial commander-in-chief, he ordered the driver of the war-elephant to trample that officer, and the small party which surrounded him, under foot. Shujâet Khan, perceiving his intention, spurred on his horse, and wounded the elephant with his spear; he then drew his sword, and inflicted four other wounds on the animal; but the furious beast, only more irritated by his wounds, made a desperate charge, and overthrew the General's horse. Shujâet, however, extricated himself from his steed, and, bravely standing

* A literal translation of the whole of this passage may be found in the Appendix to the Descriptive Catalogue of Tippoo Sultan's Library, No. 36.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1611.

his ground, wounded the elephant twice on the fore leg, which brought him upon his knees: the chief then plunged his dagger into the animal's trunk, which completely disabled him.

Shujâet Khan, having thus narrowly escaped from so unequal a contest, remounted his horse, and shewed himself to his troops, who were much dispirited, and beginning to retire. At this crisis, when, a number of the Royal generals having been killed and many more disabled by wounds, a universal panic pervaded the army, by chance, a Moghul ball, from some unknown hand, struck Osman in the forehead; but the wound not proving immediately mortal, he continued, while he had any strength remaining, to stimulate his troops to fight: at length, becoming faint, he was obliged to retire; and the Afghans, seeing their chief's elephant moving to the rear, fled to their camp. Osman reached his tent nearly exhausted, and expired during the night. Early the next morning, Vely and Mumriez, the brother and son of the deceased, fled with the body to their fortress, and the Afghans dispersed themselves in various directions.

The state of the Moghul army was such, that they could not pursue the fugitives, till a reinforcement of 300 fresh cavalry, and 400 infantry, joined them. Shujâet Khan then placed himself at their head, and followed the Afghans.

The son and brother of Osman, seeing the perseverance of the Imperial General, found there was no alternative but to throw themselves on his clemency: they therefore sent an envoy to him, to request he would pardon their errors; and to state, that if he would assure them of personal safety, they would proceed to Court, and become his Majesty's most faithful dependants and adherents.

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Shujâet Khan having strictly complied with these propositions, the next day Vely and Mumriez, with a number of the deceased chief's relations, waited on the Imperial General, and presented him with forty-nine elephants, and some jewels, being the only remaining property of the Afghan chief. With these proofs of his success, Shujâet Khan immediately proceeded to Dacca, and presented them and his prisoners to the Governor.

As this was the expiring effort of the Afghans to recover their authority in Bengal, the news was received at Court with great satisfaction. Shujâet Khan was honoured with the title of Rustemi Zemān (the Hercules of the Age); and the Governor was promoted to the command of 6000 horse.

On the twenty-second of Mohurrem, A. H. 1022, Hosheng, A. D. 1613. son of the Governor, arrived at Agra with his prisoners and the elephants of the Afghan chief, and was most graciously received; he also presented to the Emperor several of the Mughs, natives of the countries of Pegū and Arracan, who had been made prisoners during the war with those nations. The customs of these people seemed to his Majesty very reprehensible, as he was informed that they ate animals of every kind, and married their half-sisters, and that their religion was of the grossest idolatry*.

During the period the troops of Bengal were employed against the Afghans, an impostor, calling himself the Prince Khusero, eldest son of Jehangire, who had been long confined in consequence of his rebellion, made his appearance in the province of Behar. The misfortunes of Khusero had rendered

* The inhabitants of the greater part of the Eastern Peninsula of India are Boodhists, or worshippers of Godama.—*See Symes's Embassy to Ava.*

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1612.

him popular; and as India has always abounded with numerous adventurers and soldiers of fortune, ready to follow the standard of any one who will pay them, or hold out to them a prospect of plunder, in less than a week the impostor had collected a body of 7000 men: with these he advanced against the city of Patna; and Afzul Khan, the governor, being then absent with most of the troops, the banditti easily stormed the ramparts; and the impostor, having given up the town to be plundered by his followers, reserved for himself the palace and property of the Governor. He then caused himself to be proclaimed Emperor, under the title of Khusero Shah; and sent orders to the Zemindars, and other public officers, to come and pay their respects. Many of these persons waited on him; and, from the plausibility of his story, were convinced that he was the prince.

Afzul Khan, the governor, was at Gazypore when he received intelligence of the insurrection; and as he had been one of Khusero's adherents during the rebellion, and still his well-wisher, he was at a loss how to act: but before his arrival at Patna, he was convinced of the deception, and took the requisite measures for quelling the disturbance.

The impostor, whose real name was Cuttub, was not deficient in personal bravery. He led his troops some miles from Patna, to oppose the approach of the Governor; but at the first onset he was abandoned by all but a few friends, and compelled to flee and take refuge in the palace: there he defended himself for some time with much resolution; but was at length killed by a brick, thrown at him from the roof of an adjoining building. His accomplices were then seized; and they acknowledged that he was a young Rohilla Afghan, who,

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having visited Dehly, had been there informed he bore a strong resemblance to the unfortunate Prince Khusero, whose hard fate was deplored by thousands; and that these circumstances had induced him to assume the name of the prince, and to try to better his fortune. SECT. VI.

Improbable as was the success of this enterprise, it has been frequently imitated in Hindoostan, and has caused considerable commotions.

Islam Khan continued to govern Bengal with great reputation, and died at Dacca in the year 1022. A. D. 1613.

COSSIM KHAN.

Cossim Khan appointed to the Government—Disputes with the Son of the deceased Governor respecting his Brother's property—Affairs of the Portuguese continued—Sebastian Gonzales treacherously seizes the Arracan fleet—Ravages the coast of Arracan—repulsed—Applies to the Viceroy of Goa for assistance—The Viceroy sends a fleet to invade Arracan—The Raja, assisted by the Dutch, opposes and defeats the Portuguese—Gonzales retires to Sundeep, and is pursued by the Arracanners, who defeat him, and take possession of that island, whence they make frequent incursions into Bengal—The Emperor, irritated thereat, censures the Governor, and supersedes him.

The Emperor Jehangire was much distressed when he heard of the death of Islam Khan; and, as a proof of his regard, appointed Cossim Khan, the brother of the deceased, to the A. D. 1613. government. This officer proceeded immediately to Bengal; and meeting with Kereem Khan, the illegitimate or adopted son of his brother, at Rajemahel, disputed with him regarding the inheritance, and, by force, took from him a considerable part

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of the effects, and several elephants, which the young man contended were the property of the Emperor. By this conduct the Governor incurred the Royal displeasure; and although no notice was immediately taken of the circumstance, it probably accelerated his recall.

As, during the period of this officer's government, his attention was principally occupied in opposing the incursions of the piratical Portuguese and the Mughs, it now becomes requisite to revert to their history.

Affairs of the Portuguese, continued.

After the retreat of the Raja and the army of Arracan, Gonzales treacherously invited the captains of the vessels belonging to that nation, on board his ship, and put them all to death; after which he took possession of the whole Arracan fleet, and returned with it to Sundeep: but in order to complete the measure of his villainy, he immediately fitted out an expedition to plunder the coast of Arracan, which, in consequence of the victory gained by the Moghuls and his seizure of the fleet, was left totally unprotected. He therefore plundered and burnt many of the towns on the coast; and had even the audacity to go up the Arracan river, and to seize upon all the merchant vessels in that harbour: he was repulsed, however, in his attack on the city, and compelled to retreat: but, previous to his departure, he had the mortification to see his nephew, whom he had given as a hostage, impaled upon a lofty hill, by order of the Raja, in revenge for his treachery. This sight did not awaken in the breast of the wretch any sentiments of remorse for his own infamous conduct, but served only to stimulate him to seek revenge, even at the expense of his independence.

During the whole period of Gonzales' success, he had

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never taken any notice of, nor submitted himself to, the authority of the Viceroy of the Portuguese settlements in India: but upon his return to Sundeep, he despatched one of his ships, with an intelligent agent, to Goa, to make an offer of his obedience to the Viceroy, Don Hierome de Azvedo, and to urge him to the conquest of Arracan, which he described as a rich and fruitful country, and capable of making very little resistance. On his part, he engaged to co-operate with all his forces, and to send to Goa an annual tribute of a ship-load of rice: he further urged, that his conduct against the King of Arracan had proceeded entirely from his desire of revenging the murder of his countrymen, who had been unjustly put to death by that prince. SECT. VI.

The Viceroy, ambitious of extending the conquests of his nation to a country which had not yet submitted to the Portuguese yoke, fitted out an expedition, consisting of fourteen large galliots, one fly-boat, and a pink; and gave the command of it to Don Francis de Meneses, who had been for several years Governor of Ceylon: but, in his instructions to that officer, he did not sufficiently appreciate the value of the assistance to be expected from the pirates, and even commanded that the attack should be made without waiting for their junction.

On the third of October, 1615, the expedition entered the river of Arracan*; whence Don Francis despatched a galliot, A. D. 1615.

* Since the year 1783, when the Birmans conquered Arracan, European vessels are not allowed to enter that river; but it is said to have six fathoms water on the Bar, and to be capable of containing a very large fleet. Its source, however, is not above seventy miles from the sea, although it was formerly supposed to have its rise in China.—*See Symes's Embassy to Ava.*

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1615.

to inform Gonzales of his arrival; and resolved to wait at the mouth of the river till his messenger returned from Sundeep.

In the mean time, the Raja, having learnt the hostile preparations that were making against him, prevailed upon the masters of some Dutch vessels, which were in the harbour, to join him against the Portuguese, and, on the 15th of October, attacked the latter with a numerous fleet, led on by a Dutch ship. The fight lasted the whole day, but nothing decisive took place; and, in the evening, the Arracanners returned up the river. In this situation, things remained till nearly the middle of the month of November, when Gonzales made his appearance with fifty sail of vessels, of various sizes. He was much irritated at the conduct of the Viceroy, in not having sent him timely notice; and severely censured Don Francis for having entered the river previous to his junction, as the enemy had thereby been apprised of their intentions, and were doubtless well prepared for the attack.

On the 15th of November, Don Francis, dividing his fleet into two squadrons, took the command of one himself, and gave the other to Gonzales. He soon after got under weigh; and, at some distance from the city, discovered the Arracan and Dutch fleet drawn up, ready to receive him. With his own squadron he attacked the right of the enemy, while Gonzales vigorously opposed the left. The fight continued till sun-set; when Don Francis, being killed by a musquet-ball, and above 200 more of the Portuguese having also fallen, Gonzales found it requisite to retire; and with the ebb-tide returned to the mouth of the river, where, after burying the dead, and consulting with the captains respecting their

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further proceedings, it was agreed to abandon the enterprise, SECT. VI. and to return to Sundeep.

This defeat ruined the affairs of Gonzales: the Portuguese officers returned to Goa, and induced many of the pirates to accompany them. His followers also, disgusted by his brutal behaviour, abandoned him; and, in the following year, the Raja of Arracan invaded Sundeep, defeated Gonzales, and took possession of the other islands; whence, under the denomination of Mughs, the Arracanners frequently invaded and plundered the lower parts of Bengal, carrying off with them the inhabitants as slaves*.

As Cossim Khan did not evince sufficient energy in repelling these invaders, the Emperor severely censured him for his conduct; and, in the year 1027, recalled him to Court, to A. D. 1618. answer for his negligence.

IBRAHIM KHAN FUTTEH JUNG.

Ibrahim Khan, appointed to the government, encourages agriculture and manufactures—The Agents of the English East-India Company arrive, over land, at Patna, and establish a Factory in that city—The prince Shah Jehan rebels—Marches to Dehly—Defeated by the Emperor—Flees to the Dekkan—Resolves to invade Bengal—Obtains possession of the Province of Orissa—Advances into Bengal, and takes Burdwan—The Governor marches from Dacca, and takes post with his army in the vicinity of Rajemahel—The Prince endeavours to bribe the Governor, but, failing of success, advances against him—Crosses the river Ganges—Defeats and kills the Governor.

THIS officer, who was married to a sister of the Empress Noor Jehan, had frequently distinguished himself in military

* In Major Rennell's Bengal Atlas, a considerable district is marked as "Lands depopulated by the Mughs."

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enterprises, by which he had obtained the title of "Victorious in War," was chosen by the Court as a person well qualified to defend the country against all invaders. His commission, however, did not include Behar, which was still continued to Afzul Khan; but he had permission to nominate his own deputy for the management of Orissa, to which station he appointed his nephew, Ahmed Beg. He was also allowed to appoint his son, Syf Allah, then only twelve years of age, to be superintendant of Burdwan*.

For nearly five years, the provinces of Bengal and Orissa enjoyed, under the able government of Ibrahim Khan, a state of tranquillity and security, which tended much to the happiness of the inhabitants. Agriculture and commerce were encouraged, and the manufactures were carried to a degree of perfection they had never before attained. The delicate muslins of Dacca, and the silks of Maldah, constituted the chief part of the dress of the Imperial court, whether male or female; and the fineness of its texture was such as cannot now be imitated†.

The English East-India Company establish a factory at Patna, A. D. 1620.

It was during the period that Afzul Khan governed Behar, and Ibrahim Khan, Bengal, that the English first visited these provinces. Some years previous to this time, agents had been sent, over land, from Surat to Agra, where they had established a factory; and, on their representation, two persons were sent (A. D. 1620) to Patna, to purchase cloths, and to establish a house of business in that city; but the great expense of land-

* See the interesting fate of this youth in the History of Hindoostan, vol. III. p. 105.

† The Empress Noor Jehan is said to have entirely changed the fashion of the ladies' dresses, to have invented a number of new ornaments to decorate their persons, and to have given great encouragement to the artisans and manufacturers.—*Tarikh Khafy Khan.*

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carriage, first to Agra, and then to Surat, so enhanced the price of the articles, that in the following year the trade was abandoned*. SECT. VI.

The spirit of the Afghans was completely subdued; the Assamians were repelled, and the incursions of the Arracanners strictly watched by a fleet of war-boats. Thus situated, Bengal had every prospect of enjoying an undisturbed state of felicity; but the ill-timed ambition of a prince of the Royal family, who subsequently succeeded to the kingdom, lighted up the firebrand of war in these peaceful regions.

In order to elucidate this event, it becomes requisite to recur to the History of Hindoostan†, in which it will be found, that, in the year of the Hegira 1025, the Emperor Jehangire appointed his third son, Khoorum, to command the army destined for the conquest of the Dekkan, and on this occasion conferred on the prince the lofty title of Shah Jehan (King of the World).

The prince was successful; the chiefs of the Dekkan sued for peace, and agreed to pay an annual tribute; and Shah Jehan, in the following year, returned triumphant to court.

In the year 1029, whilst the Emperor was amusing himself in the delightful Valley of Cashmire, the tributary princes‡ of the Dekkan threw off their allegiance, and supported their rebellion by an army of 60,000 horse. A.D. 1619.

Shah Jehan was again detached to the Dekkan, with an army of 40,000 horse; and in the space of a few months,

* See Messrs. Hughes and Parker's Letter. Vol. I. of *India Records*, A.D. 1620.

† See Life of Jehangire, vol III.

‡ Nizam Shah, Adil Shah, and Cuttub Shah. See Scott's History of the Dekkan.

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without any considerable action, he reduced the insurgents to their former obedience, forcing them to pay the arrears of their tribute, which was now settled at the annual sum of fifty-five lacs of rupees.

Rebellion of the Prince Shah Jehan, A. D. 1621.

In the year 1031, Shah Jehan, being again at the head of a numerous army devoted to his service, and convinced that, as long as his elder brother, Sultan Purvez, lived, he had no chance of succeeding to the throne, resolved to anticipate by force that which was ordained him by destiny.

The author of the History of Shah Jehan ascribes his rebellion to the violence and ambition of the Sultana Noor Jehan. "That woman," says the writer, "finding that the health of the Emperor declined, was apprehensive that the crown would devolve on Shah Jehan, who had for some time been the determined enemy of her influence and power; she therefore resolved to ruin the affairs of that prince, and to fix the succession in the person of Shariâr, the fourth son of Jehangire, who was married to her own daughter, by her former husband Shere Afgun." A sudden invasion of the Persians, and the capture of Candahar, was deemed by this unnatural son as a fit opportunity to strike the blow. On receipt of the Imperial orders to march his army from Burhanpore, and to repel the invaders, he threw off the mask, and on the twenty-seventh

A. D. 1621.

of Jemmad al Akhir, A. H. 1031, proclaimed himself Emperor of Hindoostan.

His next step was to proceed to Dehly, if not with the intention of deposing his father, at least with a resolution to assume the powers of government.

On his arrival in the vicinity of the capital, he wrote the

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Emperor a letter, in which he stated the grounds of his complaints, and proposed to return to his duty on the following conditions:

That the command of all the Imperial army should be given to him without reserve.

That the governors of provinces should receive their orders from him.

That he should have the free controul and command of all the arsenals and Royal magazines.

That the impregnable fort of Rentimpore should be placed in his hands, as a place of security for his family, during his campaigns against the Persians.

The Emperor, previously displeased at his conduct, was enraged at these insolent proposals. He issued an edict proclaiming his son a rebel, and confiscating all his estates and property: he further commanded all his loyal subjects immediately to join the Imperial army, to assist him in defence of his throne. By these spirited measures the Emperor soon found himself at the head of 40,000 horse, with which he advanced to meet his rebellious son.

The Emperor was impatient to come to an action; but Asuf Jah, the Vizier, opposed this measure, by affirming that it was imprudent to risk a defeat with so small a force, while reinforcements were daily expected. In fact, the army of the Punjab, under the command of a distinguished officer, named Mohabet Khan, joined the Imperial camp the next day; after which the ardour of the Emperor was no longer to be restrained; he attacked the rebels near Tuglickabad, defeated them, and compelled his son to flee to the Dekkan.

Shah Jehan was pursued by the armies of his elder brother,

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1621. Sultan Purvez, and Mohabet. When he arrived on the banks of the river Nerbudda, he endeavoured to make a stand against them; but being again defeated, he fled to Golcondah. At this place he formed the bold resolution of seizing upon Bengal. Having given his fugitive troops time to join him, he took the route of Orissa; and before Ahmed Beg, the deputy-governor of that province, had any intelligence of his approach, he entered that territory. Ahmed Beg, quite unprepared to resist so sudden an attack, retreated with his troops, and left Orissa to the quiet possession of the Prince.

Shah Jehan invades Bengal.

Shah Jehan, after refreshing his army at Cuttack, appointed Cooly Khan governor of the province; he then advanced to Burdwan, and laid siege to that city, which after some days capitulated. During the time he was encamped before Burdwan, he recruited his army, by taking several of the Afghan chiefs, with their followers, into his service: he also wrote letters to all the Moghul officers, of whom he had any knowledge, inviting them to join his standard, and assuring them of every favour his gratitude could bestow.

It was immediately after the capture of Burdwan that Michael Rodriguez, the governor of Hoogly, apprehensive of an attack upon his settlement, went to pay his respects to the Prince; as at that period the Portuguese had acquired great power in India, and had, at Hoogly, a good corps of European artillery. The Prince was exceedingly anxious to attach them to his cause; he received the Governor with the greatest condescension, and promised him very great rewards, if he would assist him with some pieces of cannon, and a detachment of Europeans.

Rodriguez understood sufficient of the politics of Hin-

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doostan, to see that the Prince's project was a desperate one, and very unlikely to be attended with success. He therefore prudently declined the offer of Shah Jehan; but did it in such terms that were considered as an insult, and, after the Prince's succession to the throne, drew on the unfortunate inhabitants of Hoogly the vengeance of that monarch. SECT. VI. A. D. 1621.

When intelligence of this unlooked-for invasion reached the governor, Ibrahim Khan, he was exceedingly perplexed; part of his army was employed in Chittagong against the Mughs; and other divisions of it were dispersed over the country, to enforce the collection of the revenues. He, however, immediately marched from Dacca with what forces he could collect, and took post at Rajemahel, where he ordered all his troops to rendezvous.

Shah Jehan, convinced that, in his situation, delays were dangerous, and that his success depended entirely upon prompt and vigorous measures, advanced, by rapid marches, towards the Governor; who, finding that the city of Rajemahel was incapable of standing a siege, retreated to the fortifications of Terriagurhy, upon which were mounted a number of cannon, served by vagabond Europeans of different nations, whom he had encouraged to enter his service: but not considering this place sufficiently secure, he entrusted the defence of it to one of his best officers, and encamped, with his army, on the opposite bank of the Ganges.

Whilst the contending armies were thus situated, Shah Jehan wrote the Governor a letter, replete with compliments for his fidelity and attachment to the Emperor, and some excuses for his own conduct, to which, he said, he was doubtless impelled by fate; that he considered the province of Bengal

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1621.

as beneath his notice; but that, as it lay in his route, he was obliged to pass through it, which he hoped to do without opposition;—that if Ibrahim Khan was partial to Bengal, he might make choice of any district in it he preferred, and retire thither with his wealth and family, where he should be permitted to continue in the enjoyment of every thing he desired: but if he preferred returning to Dehly, he was at liberty to depart, taking with him all his family and property, for which a safe-conduct should be granted, and the Prince's honour pledged for their security. To this insidious proposal Ibrahim Khan replied, that his Majesty had entrusted to him the care of that country, and the protection of its inhabitants; that he was grown old in the Imperial service, and, in all probability, had not many years longer to live; that he was willing to sacrifice those years to the performance of his duty; and if he died a martyr in the Royal cause, it would be a subject of fame to himself, and honour to his family; but that as long as he retained a spark of life, Bengal should acknowledge no master but *his* Sovereign.

Ibrahim Khan having taken the precaution to secure all the boats he could collect on his side the river, the army of Shah Jehan was prevented crossing; neither could they advance further on the southern bank, on account of the pass being in possession of the Royalists.

In this dilemma, Deriaw Khan, one of the Afghan chiefs whom the Prince had taken into his service, being known to some of the zemindars in the district of Boglipore, prevailed upon them to produce some boats, which they had sunk, and otherwise concealed from the Governor. The boats were, during the night, collected at a place some miles down the

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river, in the vicinity of Sooty. At the break of day, Deriaw Khan, with his Afghan cavalry, crossed the Ganges, and was immediately followed by Abdullah Khan, who had deserted to the prince at the battle of Tuglickpore, and had ever since been his principal counsellor. SECT. VI. A. D. 1622.

When Ibrahim Khan found that the enemy had crossed the river, he withdrew as many of his troops as could be spared from the defence of Terriagurhy*; and, being thus reinforced, advanced to meet the rebel chiefs. The number of forces on each side were nearly equal, but the troops of Shah Jehan were better mounted. The Governor entrusted the command of the first line to his nephew, Ahmed Beg, who charged the enemy with great vigour; but his nephew being repulsed, the Governor advanced with the second line; and though requested by his friends not to risk his person in the heat of the engagement, he replied, "My life is of no consequence: I will devote it to the service of his Majesty, and either conquer or die." Having said this, he rushed with his corps of reserve into the thickest of the enemy; he was shortly surrounded, and fell covered with wounds: his death served as an excuse to his troops to quit the field; they fled towards Dacca, and left their camp to be plundered by the enemy. Defeat and death of the Governor.

During the period that Shah Jehan had been contriving means to cross the river, his engineer, Roumy Khan, had pressed forward the siege of Terriagurhy†: and, at the time that the battle was raging on the opposite bank, he set fire to a

* In order to conform to the orthography of Major Rennell's Map, I have written the names of the *passes* as he has done; but in the Persian character, they are written *Telyagurhy*, and *Sankrygully*.

† In the Jehangire Nameh, the fortress is said to have been merely an inclosed burying ground; but the long defence it made, does not coincide with that statement.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1622.

mine, which blew up twenty yards of the fortifications, and opened a breach, through which the rebels rushed with impetuosity, and put the greater part of the garrison to the sword.

The capture of Terriagurhy, and the death of the Governor, decided the fate of Bengal; the authority of the Prince was everywhere acknowledged; and the zemindars and public officers hastened to make their terms with the conqueror.

SHAH JEHAN.

Shah Jehan, after the victory, proceeds to Dacca—Takes possession of the public treasure and the Governor's property—Advances to Patna, and obtains possession of that city—Prevails upon the Governor of Rhotas to give up the fort, to which he sends his family—Advances to Benaras—Hearing of the approach of the Imperial army, he recrosses the Ganges, and takes post, with his army, on the banks of the Tonse river—A battle is fought between the two armies—The rebels are defeated, and the Prince retires to Rhotas—Proceeds to Patna—Orders Darab, whom he had left as Governor of Bengal, to join him—The Governor refuses—The Imperial army advances towards Patna—The Prince quits Bengal, writes a penitential letter to the Emperor, and is forgiven.

A. D. 1622.

THE Prince, whom we must now consider as the ruler of the province, lost no time in pursuing the few remaining Royalists. He seized upon all the boats that had been collected by both parties; and, having embarked the select part of his army, proceeded, with all possible despatch, down the river, to Dacca. Upon his arrival there, the gates of the fort were thrown open; and Ahmed Beg, the nephew of the late Governor, finding it in vain to contend, further waited on the Prince, and

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delivered to him all the elephants, horses, and other property of his uncle; also 4,000,000 rupees in specie, belonging to government.

After this event, the Prince gave audience to the zemindars and public officers of government. He received them graciously; and having confirmed most of them in their appointments, he nominated a young nobleman, named Darab, the son of Khan Khanan, to the government of Bengal; but, as a security for his fidelity, obliged him to send his son along with the army, as a hostage.

After remaining a short time at Dacca, Shah Jehan marched towards Patna, which, at that period, was the jagier of the prince Purvez, who had entrusted the care and defence of it to Mukhliss Khan; but that officer, terrified at the approach of the rebels, abandoned his post, and fled to Allahabad.

Shah Jehan, having, without opposition, obtained possession of the capital of Behar, occupied the Soubahdar's palace, and summoned all the zemindars and public officers to attend his Court, and make a declaration of their allegiance. As he was now completely master of the three provinces, he found no difficulty in enforcing his wishes; and even Syed Mubarick, the governor of Rhotas, came and delivered to him the keys of that impregnable fortress. This event he considered of the greatest importance, as it afforded a secure asylum for his family, and the wives of his followers, during the uncertain issue of the approaching campaign. He therefore sent off his *haram*, and all his children, under charge of a careful officer, to Rhotas, with orders to remain there, either till his return, or till he should send a confidential person to bring them to

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1622.

him. During the time this branch of the Royal family resided in Rhotas, the prince Morad Bukhsh was born.

Having refreshed and recruited his forces at Patna, the Prince appointed Byram Beg governor of Behar; and, having formed his army into three divisions, ordered Abdullah Khan, with the left, to proceed and conquer Allahabad. The right division he entrusted to Deriaw Khan, the Afghan, with directions to take possession of Oude; whilst the center division, under his own command, was destined to secure Joanpore and Benaras.

Hitherto fortune had favoured the audacious schemes of Shah Jehan: he was puffed up with success; and, on his route, assumed all the state and authority of the Sovereign. He advanced by short marches, listening to appeals from the decision of former governors, and settling the government of the country.

In the mean time, the Prince Purvez, and Mohabet Khan, who had lost sight of Shah Jehan for a considerable period after his flight from the river Nerbudda, having heard of his success in Bengal, marched through Malwa and Berar, with an intention of driving him from that province; but, on their approaching the vicinity of Allahabad, they learnt that he was already in their neighbourhood, and on his route towards Dehly.

Upon the arrival of the rebel forces, under Abdullah, at Joosy, on the bank of the river opposite to Allahabad, he found that Rustem Beg, the governor, had secured all the boats, and was prepared to oppose his crossing. Abdullah was therefore compelled to wait the arrival of some large boats, which accompanied the army from Bengal. In the mean time, he

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1624.

employed his engineers in constructing batteries, on which he mounted several heavy cannon, that completely commanded the passage: the boats having joined him in a few days, he succeeded in crossing his troops, and took possession of the city of Allahabad.

During these operations of the left wing, Deriaw Khan advanced, with the right, to Joanpore, and obtained undisputed possession of that district; whilst the Prince, with equal facility, became master of Benaras. After the conquest of Joanpore, Deriaw Khan continued his route to Manickpore; but at that place, having received intelligence of the approach of the Royal army, under Sultan Purvez, he deemed it prudent to retreat towards Benaras. Abdullah Khan also abandoned Allahabad; and both wings having formed a junction with the main body, Shah Jehan recrossed the river, and encamped on the banks of the Tonse, which falls into the Ganges, some miles below Allahabad, where he waited the approach of the Royal forces. This position was naturally strong; and, in case of a defeat, secured his safe retreat to Rhotas and Bengal, without having to cross the Ganges—a measure replete with danger, when pursued by a victorious enemy: he also secured all the boats that could be collected, under his own encampment.

Having taken these prudent precautions, the Prince called a council of war, in which it was the opinion of his most experienced officers, that he should not risk a general engagement, but remain entirely on the defensive. This opinion was, however, controverted by Raja Bhime, who declared, that in such a cause procrastination was ruin; and that, if the Moghuls and Afghans would not fight for their Prince, he himself would

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1624.

attack the enemy with his Rajepoots. Shah Jehan, who possessed the greatest bravery, and could not brook delay, coincided in opinion with the Raja, and orders were given to prepare for battle.

In the mean time, the Royal army, having arrived at Allahabad, crossed the Jumna, and advanced against the rebels. The engagement commenced by a distant cannonade; but Mohabet, the Imperial general, finding that, by his numbers, he far outflanked his adversaries, ordered a division of his army to make a circuit to the right, and, crossing the Tonse, to get in the rear of the rebels: this manœuvre was dexterously performed, and Shah Jehan found himself surrounded on all sides: despair added resolution to his courage; with five hundred chosen horse, he rushed into the thickest of the enemy; but his army, with the exception of Raja Bhime, who was slain, not following his example, and his own horse having been shot under him, he was prevailed upon, by the entreaties of his friends, to quit the field, and retire to Rhotas.

Defeat of Shah Jehan.

As the Imperialists had suffered severely in the engagement, and their horses were much fatigued by long and continued marching, Sultan Purvez did not think proper immediately to pursue his brother; and in three days Shah Jehan had the pleasure of embracing his family in their secure and quiet retreat*. At Rhotas the Prince was joined by a number of his troops, who had escaped from the battle; and having again formed these into regular squadrons, he withdrew part of his family from the fort, and marched towards Patna: he at the same time sent orders to Darab Khan, whom he had left at

* Rhotas is situated in the mountains, far from the high road.

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Dacca, as governor of Bengal, to advance to his assistance; but that ungrateful wretch, hoping to make his peace with the Royalists, abandoned his patron in the hour of distress, and wrote to the Prince, that the zemindars had risen in arms on all sides of him, and totally prevented his quitting Dacca. SECT. VI. A. D. 1625.

His treachery was too apparent; and the stern Abdullah Khan, in opposition to the will of the Prince, condemned to death the innocent son of Darab, who had been placed as a hostage in his hands.

The Royal army, having halted some days to refresh themselves in the vicinity of Benaras, continued their route towards Bengal: on their approaching Patna, Shah Jehan, finding that city untenable against so superior a force, abandoned it, and retired to Rajemahel: hence he was again driven, and compelled to retreat to the Dekkan, by the same route he had entered Bengal. Darab Khan, the governor, trusting to the clemency of Prince Purvez, and the interest of his father, who held the dignified title of Khan Khanan (Chief of the Nobility) in the Imperial Court, and was the son of the celebrated Byram Khan the preceptor of Akbar, came to the Royal camp, and gave himself up as a prisoner: the prince recommended him for forgiveness; but the Emperor, who had cruelly punished all the adherents of his son Khusero, after that prince's rebellion, refused to spare the favourite of Shah Jehan, and commanded that his head should be sent to Court, to serve as an example to all other traitors, however high their rank and connections.

Sometime after this event, Shah Jehan, being reduced to the greatest distress, wrote a penitential letter to his father: he was forgiven, on condition of sending orders to his adherents

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1625.

to deliver up all the forts in their possession. By these means Rhotas became again subject to the Royal authority; and not a trace was left of Shah Jehan's having been for two years the possessor of these provinces.

Were we to judge of Shah Jehan's conduct by the rules of Christian morality, or by European policy, we should condemn it as unprincipled and unnatural; but if we refer to the events which took place on his accession to the empire, and several other instances which have since occurred, it will be manifest, that had his elder brother Purvez lived, Shah Jehan would have had no alternative, but the throne or the grave. If, therefore, he could have secured to himself, even during his father's life-time, the kingdom of Bengal, he would have been held excused, in the opinion of all his countrymen: and had he limited his ambition to that object, as he was a favourite of his father, there is little doubt but he might have gained the Emperor's consent to the measure. But he verified the Persian proverb, "Ten derveishes will sleep on one blanket, but two kings will not sleep in the same climate*;" for, on his accession to the throne, he destroyed every male (excepting his own children) of the posterity of Sultan Baber.

KHANEZAD KHAN.

When the Emperor was informed of the flight of his son from Bengal, he nominated Mohabet Khan to the government of that province; but as he was anxious that so experienced an officer should still conduct the war against Shah Jehan, he commanded him to continue the pursuit, and to place his son,

* *Keleem* signifies a blanket; and *Akleem*, the fourteen climates, into which the world was divided by ancient geographers. The rhyme cannot be preserved in the translation.

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Khanezad Khan, as his deputy in the government. We are unacquainted with any part of the conduct of this nobleman, further than that, when his father had seized upon the Emperor, and governed the empire with absolute sway, he remitted to Court the large sum of 22,000,000 of rupees in specie, being the surplus revenue of that province; but before its arrival at Dehly, Mohabet Khan had generously relinquished his power, and the money fell into the hands of his enemies. Khanezad Khan imitated the example of his father; and, to avoid the disgrace of being superseded, resigned his appointment, in the year 1035, and was afterwards most graciously received at Court. SECT. VI. A. D. 1626.

MUKURREM KHAN.

On the removal of Khanezad, the Emperor appointed Mukurrem Khan to the government of Bengal; and bestowed Behar on Mirza Rustem, a Persian prince of the Sofy family.

Mukurrem Khan took up his residence at Dacca; and as the eastern parts of Bengal are intersected by rivers and creeks, navigable at all seasons of the year, and as during the four months of the rains great part of the country is inundated, the usual mode of travelling is by water: on which account the Governors of Bengal have always kept up a large establishment of boats of every description, whether for state, war, or pleasure; and the veneration of the inhabitants for the tutelary deities, who are supposed to preside over the rivers and waters, is carried to an extreme, both by Hindoos and Mohammedans, bordering close upon idolatry: even the present Governors are obliged to comply with the superstition of their subjects, by making, at Dacca, an annual offering to

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1626. Khuaje Khizer (supposed to be the Prophet Elias), to propitiate his good offices in protecting their inland commerce*.

Mukurrem Khan took great pleasure in aquatic excursions, and frequently went on the river, attended by his courtiers, seraglio, &c. About six months after his appointment to the government, he received intelligence that a letter of much importance, from the Emperor, was on its way to him. To evince his loyalty and respect to his sovereign, he ordered the state boats to be prepared, and set out from Dacca to meet the bearer of the letter. After sailing for some time up the river, and the hour of prayer drawing nigh, the Governor gave orders for the fleet to put on shore. It happened that the boat which his Excellency had made choice of on this occasion was exceedingly long and narrow, and much better adapted for rowing than for sailing: in attempting to gain the shore, the broad side of the vessel was brought to the current; a sudden squall at the same moment took the sail, and overset her: the servants and people who were on the deck escaped; but the Governor, and several of his courtiers who were in the state-room, could not extricate themselves, and were drowned.

FEDAI KHAN.

When the unfortunate fate of the late Governor was known at Court, his Majesty was pleased to nominate, in the year

* This offering consists of a boat, or ship, constructed of bamboos and coloured paper, ornamented with flags, lamps, &c. It is placed upon inverted earthen pots, and, being carried in procession to the river side, is launched into the river, amidst the acclamations of the populace and the discordant sounds of every kind of music, and floats down the current with majestic pomp. It is called the offering of the Biera.

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1036, the Nuwab Fedai Khan to the government; and as, for a number of years, except the twenty-two lacks of rupees remitted by Khanezad Khan, no revenue had been sent from Bengal, the Emperor stipulated with the new Governor, that, in addition to the usual presents of elephants, silks, muslins, ambergris, amber, &c. he should annually remit to the exchequer a present of 500,000 rupees for the Royal use, and an equal sum for the use of the Empress Noor Jehan. SECT. VI. A. D. 1627.

Fedai Khan governed Bengal during the remainder of the reign of Jehangire; but soon after the death of that monarch, and the succession of Shah Jehan to the throne, which happened early in the year 1037, he was superseded by Cossim Khan, a favourite of the new Emperor. Feb. 1. A. D. 1628.

COSSIM KHAN JOBUNY.

The Governor takes offence at the Portuguese in Bengal—Represents their conduct to the Emperor, who orders them to be expelled from his dominions—The Governor makes preparations to attack Hoogly—The armies advance, and surround the town—The besieged defend themselves with great bravery—By the explosion of a mine, one of the bastions is destroyed—The Moghuls storm the fort—Many of the inhabitants retire on board their ships, and are there attacked by another division of the army—The Portuguese set fire to several of their own ships, but the greater part are taken by the enemy—Hoogly established as the Royal port of Bengal, and the public officers withdrawn from Saatgong—Cossim Khan dies.

Some years after the arrival of Cossim Khan in Bengal, he took offence at the conduct of the Portuguese, many of whom had established themselves in various parts of the province,

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SECT. VI. and assumed a degree of authority to which they were not entitled: he therefore wrote to the Emperor, that he was very much disturbed in the duties of his office by some European idolaters, who had been permitted to establish themselves at Hoogly, on the western bank of the Bagarutty river, for the purposes of trade; that, instead of confining their attention to the business of merchants, they had fortified themselves in that place, and were become so insolent, that they committed many acts of violence upon the subjects of the empire, and presumed to exact duties from all the boats and vessels which passed their factory, and had completely drawn away all the commerce from the ancient port of Saatgong. The Governor also represented, that the Portuguese were in the habit of kidnapping or purchasing poor children, and of sending them as slaves to other parts of India; and that their pirates, in consort with the Mughs, committed innumerable aggressions on the inhabitants of the districts on the eastern branch of the Ganges. This report recalled to the Emperor's mind the refusal of Michael Rodriguez, the Portuguese governor, to afford him any assistance when engaged in the rebellion against his father, and the offensive manner in which that refusal had been given: he therefore resolved to satiate his revenge, and ordered the Governor to expel the idolatrous Portuguese from his dominions.

In obedience to these orders, Cossim Khan, in the year
A. D. 1631. 1041, commenced preparations to attack Hoogly; but took his measures with such caution, that he completely concealed his intentions from the Portuguese. Having made the requisite arrangements, he gave out that he was about to subdue the refractory zemindars of the districts of Mukhsoosabad, and Hijelle. To effect his purpose, he directed a force, under Behadur

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Kumbu, to proceed from Dacca to Mukhsoosabad; and a second army, under the orders of his own son, Inayet Allah, to march to Burdwan; whilst a third detachment, under the command of Khuaje Shere, proceeded by water, to take possession of the river below Hoogly, and, by constructing a bridge of boats at Seerpore*, to cut off the retreat of the Portuguese. SECT. VI.

Khuaje Shere, having arrived at his post, sent intelligence to the other chiefs, who immediately advanced; and on the second of Zilhije (12th month) of the year 1041, the Royal army invested the town on all sides. Parties were immediately sent to plunder the district belonging to the Portuguese, and to destroy every person of that nation they could find: and as Hoogly had been for many years a considerable port, a number of mariners and boatmen were settled in the vicinity; all these were seized, and compelled to assist in erecting batteries, and to work the artillery, of the use of which the Moghuls were very ignorant. Siege of Hoogly, A.D. 1632.

The siege was continued for three months and a half, during which time the Portuguese made frequent offers of submission, and agreed to pay a tribute of 100,000 rupees; but as they were in daily hopes of succour from Europe, or Goa, they did not relax in their defence, and, by their continual showers of musquet-balls, annoyed the besiegers to a great degree. The Moghul generals, finding all other efforts in vain, were obliged to have recourse to the miners; who, by carrying a sap to that part of the moat near the church, which was both narrower and shallower than any other place, by means of drains drew off the water. Some of the officers, while advancing their galleries in other places, discovered mines of the besieged, which

* Probably Sewrampore, commonly called Serhampore, now belonging to the Danes.

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SECT. VI.

Hoogly taken, October A. D. 1632.

they destroyed: the center mine, which was carried on by Behadur Kumbu, was conducted under a lofty bastion, upon which a great number of the besieged daily assembled. On the 14th of the month Rubby al Avul (3d month) of the year 1042, the mine, being ready, was loaded. The troops were then drawn out, and a column advanced towards the bastion; whilst the besieged, supposing it was to be attacked, collected there in great numbers. For some time a continued discharge of cannon and musquetry was kept up; when, at length, the mine being fired, the whole of the bastion, with the persons thereon, was blown into the air. The Mohammedans, on beholding this event, made a general assault. The slaughter of the Portuguese was very great: many, in attempting to escape to their boats, were drowned; a few of them got to their ships in safety, but there they were immediately attacked by Khuaje Shere and his division. The captain of the largest vessel, on which were embarked 2000 men, women, and children, with all their wealth, rather than yield to the Mohammedans, set fire to the magazine, and blew them up: many other ships followed his example. Out of sixty-four large vessels, fifty-seven grabs, and two hundred sloops, which were anchored opposite the town, only one grab and two sloops, belonging to Goa, made their escape; and these owed their safety to the bridge having been broken, by some of the boats taking fire from the flames of the ships.

Whatever property, either afloat or on shore, escaped the fury of the elements, was taken possession of by the conquerors; and all the pictures and images which ornamented the churches, the worship of which had given great offence to Taje Mahel, the empress of Shah Jehan, while in Bengal, were torn down and destroyed.

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SECT. VI.

From the commencement of the siege, till its conclusion, not less than 1000 of the Portuguese were destroyed; and 4400, men, women, and children, were taken prisoners: of these, some of the priests (against whom Shah Jehan, or his queen, had taken a great aversion), and 500 of the best-looking young persons, were sent to Agra. The girls were distributed among the *harams* of the Emperor and the nobility; and the boys were circumcised and made Mussulmans: the Jesuits and other friars were threatened with severe punishment if they did not abandon their religion and become Mohammedans; but, after some months confinement, were liberated, and sent to Goa*.

Hoogly, having thus come into the possession of the Moghuls, was established as the Royal port of Bengal. A regular Foujedar was appointed from Court, who, in the process of time, was made independent of the Governor; and all the public officers were withdrawn from Saatgong†, which soon declined into a mean village, now scarcely known to Europeans.

Shortly after this event, Cossim Khan, the governor, died

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* It is a circumstance worthy of remark, that the name of Hoogly is never mentioned in Faria De Souza's History of the Portuguese (the English translation of which was published in 1695), although he acknowledges that they lost a large town in Bengal in the year 1633, but which he calls Golin. Messrs. Hughes and Parker also, in their Letter from Patna, dated Dec. 1620, state, that the Portuguese are possessed of two forts in the bottom of Bengal; one called Pirpullye (probably Pipley); the other, Gollyr, or Gollin.

The best account of the origin of Hoogly which I have seen, may be found in the Appendix to the Descriptive Catalogue of Tippoo Sultan's Library, No. 37; but as that account does not define the period at which it was founded, it is reasonable to suppose that V. P. De Samprayo, the commander of the nine vessels which entered the Ganges in 1537-8, did not neglect so favourable an opportunity of establishing a settlement in Bengal (an object for which the Portuguese had been long anxious), during the time that Shere Shah was engaged in his contest with the Emperor Homayon.—See the Note in page 121.

† Saatgong was known to the Romans, by the name of *Ganges Regia*. It is a famous place of worship, and was formerly the residence of the kings of the country, and said to have been of an immense size.—See *Asiatic Researches*, 8vo edit. vol. V. p. 278.—See also *Rennell's Memoir of the Map of Hindoostan*, p. 45.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1632. at Dacca. He was much regretted by all the Mohammedans; being a zealot in his religion, an encourager of literature, and himself an eminent poet.

AAZIM KHAN.

THE Emperor was much distressed on receiving intelligence of the death of his favourite, the Governor of Bengal; and, in A. D. 1632-3. the year 1042, appointed a nobleman, named Aazim Khan, to fill that important office.

It was during the government of Aazim Khan, and in consequence of a *firman** from Shah Jehan, that is to say, in the A. D. 1634. year 1043, that the English first obtained permission to trade with their ships to Bengal; but as the Moghul government had felt the danger of allowing Europeans to enter the river Ganges, and to establish themselves as the Portuguese had done at Hoogly, the vessels were restricted from entering any other port than Pipley in Balasore; and it was at that place the English established their first factory in Bengal†.

The abilities of Aazim Khan were, however, not found equal to the arduous task of governing so extensive a province. He allowed his dominions to be invaded with impunity, both by the Mughs and people of Assam, who carried away much plunder, and many of the inhabitants into slavery. For this conduct he A. D. 1637. was, in the year 1047, recalled to Court, and severely censured by the Emperor; but being a person of very illustrious descent, he was shortly forgiven, and appointed to the government of Allahabad. His daughter was a few months afterwards married to the Prince Shujaa.

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* The firman is dated Feb. 2, 1634.

† See *Bruce's Annals of the East-India Company*, A. D. 1633-4.

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ISLAM KHAN MUSHHEDY.

Character of this officer—The Mugh Chief of Chittagong acknowledges himself a vassal of the Moghul Emperor—The Governor changes the name of Chittagong to Islamabad—The Assamese invade Bengal—opposed and defeated by the Governor, who pursues them into their own country—Returns to Dacca—Is appointed Vizier—Account of the rebellion of the Raja of Boujepore.

THIS was an old and experienced statesman and soldier, who had acquired much celebrity during the late reign; but as the times required all the exertion of the latter character, he is accused of neglecting the civil and judicial duties, and of devoting all his time to military pursuits.

It was during his government, that Makat Ray, one of the Mugh chiefs, who held Chittagong on the part of the Raja of Arracan, having incurred the displeasure of that prince, and being apprehensive of an invasion by his sovereign, sought, in the year 1048, the protection of the Emperor of Hindoostan. He paid his respects to Islam Khan at Dacca, acknowledged himself a vassal of the empire, and made over the sovereignty of his territory. This is the first account we have of the conquest by, or surrender of, Chittagong to the Moghuls, although it is included as part of the Imperial dominions in the *Ayeen Akberry*‡. Its present A. D. 1638.

‡ Chittagong originally belonged to the once independent and extensive kingdom of Tipperah; but, being a frontier province, frequently changed its masters; and was sometimes governed by the followers of Brahma, and at other periods ruled by the worshippers of Boodh. From the latter it was probably taken by one of the Afghan kings of Bengal; as it is stated by Faria de Souza, that, in the year 1538, the Viceroy of Goa sent an agent with presents to Mahmood Shah; that the mission landed at Chittagong, and proceeded thence

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SECT. VI. Mohammedan name of Islamabad corroborates the circumstance above related; though some historians have doubted whether it obtained that name previous to its conquest, twenty-eight years subsequent to this event.

Whilst Islam Khan was thus extending the boundaries of the empire, the inhabitants of Assam, encouraged by the success of their former depredations, collected, in the year
A. D. 1638. 1048, a great force; and embarking on the river Burhampooter, in five hundred large boats, rushed like a torrent on the plains of Bengal. They plundered all the towns and villages on the banks of the Burhampooter; and had nearly reached the capital of the province, when they were met by the Governor with a fleet of war-boats, many of which were armed with cannon: against these weapons the vessels of the Assamese could make little resistance; they were shortly in flames; and the crews, compelled to take to the shore, were attacked by the Moghul cavalry, and 4000 of them put to the sword.

Islam Khan followed up his victory, by pursuing the fugitives into their own country: he entered Assam, and took fifteen of their forts, in which he found much spoil. He afterwards subjected the whole district of Couch Behar, in

thence to Gour; but that the king, being suspicious of their intentions, seized, on the same day, thirteen persons at Gour, and thirty of the ship's company at Chittagong: in revenge for which, the Portuguese, some months after, burned the town of Chittagong. (See *Faria De Souza*, p. 418.) It was probably taken possession of by the Prince of Arracan during the contest between the Afghans and Moghuls, and was not again annexed to the empire till the government of Shaista Khan, as will hereafter be related. Abul Fazel has, in the same manner, included several of the provinces in the Dekkan in his *Tukseem Jumma*, which were not conquered till the reign of Aurungzebe. (See *Ayeen Akberry*, vol. II.)

The march of a British detachment, in the year 1794, to repel the Birmans, ascertained that the boundary of Chittagong was considerably further south than marked in the maps. The river Naaf is now the line of demarcation between the two countries.—See *Symes's Embassy to Ava*, p. 119.

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which there were several strong fortresses; but as the rainy season was approaching, and as he found much difficulty in procuring grain for his troops, he deemed it prudent to retire, before the roads should be rendered impassable by the overflowing of the river.

He commenced his retreat; and, although much harassed by the enemy and the want of supplies, he brought the greater part of his army safe back to Bengal: but, upon his arrival at Dacca, he found an order to deliver over his government to the Nuwab Syf Khan, the deputy of the Prince Shujaa, second son of the Emperor; and to return to Court, to take on himself the office of Vizier. This situation he held for some years, and died as Subahdar of the Dekkan, in the year 1058.

During the period that Islam Khan was employed in Assam, the Raja of Boujepore took advantage of the temporary absence of the Governor of Behar, and extended the hand of usurpation over great part of that province. Abdullah Khan, the favourite general of Shah Jehan, and who had served him zealously during his rebellion, was immediately invested with the government of Behar, and ordered to proceed and punish the Zemindar. He proceeded by rapid marches; and having, on his first arrival, attacked and defeated the Raja, compelled him to take refuge in his fort of Boujepore, then considered a place of considerable strength. Abdullah regularly invested the fortress; and, after some weeks, succeeded in making a practicable breach, when orders were given for the troops to prepare for the assault: but before they advanced, the Raja threw open the gate, and with his wife and children proceeded to the camp of the conqueror. Abdullah was inclined to have pardoned the Raja; but on the approach of the

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SECT. VI. unfortunate family, some of his minions whispered to him, that the lady was celebrated for her beauty. This circumstance decided the fate of the prince; the head of the rebel was sent to Court; and his wife was kept to adorn the seraglio of the Mohammedan officer*.

SULTAN MOHAMMED SHUJAA.

Sultan Shujaa appointed Governor—Again transfers the seat of government to Rajemahel—Appoints his father-in-law to be his deputy at Dacca—Account of Mr. Boughton, an English surgeon, who obtained considerable privileges for his nation—The Prince recalled to Court—Appointed Governor of Cabul—Re-appointed to Bengal—His character—State of Bengal under his government—Indisposition of the Emperor Shah Jehan—Shujaa asserts his claim to the throne—Advances to Benaras—Dara, the eldest son of Shah Jehan, marches from Dehly—Detaches his son Soliman with a numerous army to oppose Shujaa—The contending armies encamp on opposite sides of the Ganges—Raja Jy Sing endeavours to negociate a peace between them—Shujaa agrees to retire; but Soliman, anxious for an opportunity of displaying his military talents, crosses the Ganges, and surprises the Bengal camp—Shujaa, compelled to flee, takes refuge in Mongeir—Receives information of the defeat of Dara by his brother Aurungzebe, and of the latter having usurped the throne—Dubious what line of conduct to pursue—Writes a letter of congratulation, and sends an envoy to Aurungzebe—Shujaa again takes the field—Advances to Allahabad—Proceeds to Kudgwa—The army of Aurungzebe arrives at the same place—A battle ensues, in which Shujaa had the advantage; but neglecting to secure the ground in front of his encampment, is attacked the following day, and, after a hard-fought contest, completely

* If the Hindoos would take the trouble to read History, how ought they to rejoice in their change of masters: but, slaves to the system of fatalism, they look with apathy on the vicissitudes of this world, and consider every event as pre-ordained.

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defeated—Reflections on his conduct—Shujaa retires to Patna—Is pursued by the Prince Mohammed and Meer Jumla—Shujaa retreats to Mongeir—fortifies that post, and the passes of Terriagurhy and Sicklygully—Mohammed takes Patna—Joined by Meer Jumla—The latter obtains information of another road into Bengal—Mohammed advances, by easy stages, towards Mongeir; whilst his coadjutor enters the western hills, and gains possession of the district of Bissunpore—Shujaa, again compelled to retreat, proceeds to Rajemahel—The Royal army invests that city—Shujaa flees to Tondah—The setting-in of the rains, and swelling of the river, stop any further pursuit—The Royal army cantons in the vicinity of Rajemahel—Shujaa recruits his army, and harasses the Imperial camp—The Prince Mohammed, having been betrothed to one of his cousins, deserts to Shujaa—Conduct of Meer Jumla on this occasion—The marriage between the Prince Mohammed and the daughter of Shujaa celebrated at Tondah—Great rejoicings thereon—The Imperialists prepare to cross the Ganges—Shujaa encamps his army—assigns a conspicuous post to his new Son-in-law—The Imperialists cross the river—A battle ensues—Shujaa is defeated, and flees towards Dacca—Jumla takes possession of Tondah—Conduct of the Emperor Aurungzebe upon receiving intelligence of the desertion of his son Mohammed—Stratagem to break the connection between Mohammed and Shujaa—the plan succeeds—Shujaa dismisses his Son-in-law and daughter—Arrives at Dacca—Forsaken by his troops—Resolves to seek refuge at Chittagong, or Arracan—Enters the country of Tipperah—Arrives at Chittagong—disappointed at not finding any ships there—Continues his journey to Arracan—At first favourably received by the Raja—The Raja alters his conduct—Sends an insolent message to the Prince—Orders him to quit his territories—Magnanimous conduct of Shujaa on this occasion—The Raja accuses the Prince, to his Council, of having formed a plot to seize the kingdom—The Arracan troops surround the Prince and his small party—A combat ensues—greater part of the Moghuls killed—Shujaa taken prisoner—Drowned—The Princess stabs herself in despair—The daughters seized, and one of them forcibly married to the Raja—The sons put to death.

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EARLY in the year 1049, Sultan Shujaa, the second son of the Emperor Shah Jehan, then twenty-four years of age, took A. D. 1639.

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possession of the government of Bengal; but his father, fearing to trust him with too much power, conferred the government of Behar on Shaista Khan, the son of the vizier Asuf Jah, and nephew of Noor Jehan.

The seat of government transferred to Rajemahel.

Shujaa again transferred the seat of government to Rajemahel (termed, in the records of that time, *Akbarnagur*), and built there an elegant palace, some of the rooms of which are yet standing. He also strengthened the fortifications which had been erected by Raja Mān Sing, and expended large sums of money in rendering the city worthy of his residence; but, the following year, nearly the whole of the city, and the principal part of the palace, were destroyed by a dreadful conflagration, in which many lives were lost, and the family of the Prince with difficulty escaped.

About the same time, the current of the Ganges changed its bed, and poured its torrents against the walls of the new capital, washing away many of the stately edifices.

Previous to that time, the course of the Ganges was along the northern bank, running under the walls of Gour; but since that period, it pours its torrents against the rocks of Rajemahel, forming eddies and whirlpools, dangerous to the incautious or impatient traveller*.

In consequence of the youth and inexperience of Shujaa, the Emperor took the precaution of sending with him Aazim Khan, who had been Governor of Bengal for nearly five years, and to whose daughter the Prince was lately married, as his chief counsellor and adviser; but Shujaa, either wishing to make him a handsome provision, or to be freed from the superintendance of his father-in-law, appointed that nobleman to

* See *Asiatic Researches*, vol. V. p. 271. 8vo edit.

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reside as his deputy at Dacca; but he, being shortly disgusted with that situation, was, by his own request, removed to the government of Allahabad: whence he was transferred to Joanpore, and died there, in the year 1059, aged seventy-six years. He was buried in his own garden, in the vicinity of that city, where his tomb is still shewn.

The early part of Sultan Shujaa's government was distinguished by his condescension to the English; and by his granting them permission to establish factories, both at Ballasore and at Hoogly; but their ships were not yet permitted to enter the Ganges.

The cause of this partiality to a nation which was destined to become the rival power, and ultimately the support of the descendants of Timour, is thus satisfactorily accounted for.

A. D. 1636. In the year of the Hegira 1046, a daughter of the Emperor Shah Jehan having been dreadfully burnt, by her clothes catching fire, an express was sent to Surat, through the recommendation of the vizier Assud Khan, to desire the assistance of an European surgeon. For this service the Council at Surat nominated Mr. Gabriel Boughton, surgeon of the ship *Hopewell*, who immediately proceeded to the Emperor's camp, then in the Dekkan, and had the good fortune to cure the young Princess of the effects of her accident. Mr. Boughton, in consequence, became a great favourite at Court; and, having been desired to name his reward, he, with that liberality which characterizes Britons, sought not for any private emolument; but solicited that his nation might have liberty to trade, free of all duties, to Bengal, and to establish factories in that country. His request was complied with, and he was furnished with the means of travelling across the country to Bengal. Upon his

Mr. Boughton, an English surgeon, obtains privileges for his nation.

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A. D. 1638.

arrival in that province, he proceeded to Pipley; and, in the year 1048, an English ship happening to arrive in that port, he, in virtue of the Emperor's firman*, and the privileges granted to him, negociated the whole of the concerns of that vessel without the payment of any duties.

In the following year, the Prince Shujaa, having taken possession of the government, Mr. Boughton proceeded to Rajemahel, to pay his respects to his Royal Highness: he was most graciously received; and one of the ladies of the *haram* being then indisposed with a complaint in her side, the English surgeon was again employed, and had the good fortune to accelerate her recovery. Owing to this event, Mr. Boughton was held in high estimation at the Court of Rajemahel; and, by his influence with the Prince, was enabled to carry into effect the orders of the Emperor, which might otherwise have been cavilled at, or, by some underhand method, have been rendered nugatory.

A. D. 1640.

In the year 1050, the same ship returned from England, and brought out a Mr. Bridgeman, and some other persons, for the purpose of establishing factories in Bengal. Mr. Boughton, having represented the circumstance to the Prince, was ordered to send for Mr. Bridgeman: that gentleman, in consequence, went to Rajemahel, was introduced to the Prince, and obtained an order to establish, in addition to that at Pipley, factories at Ballasore and Hoogly†. Some time after this event, Mr. Boughton died; but the Prince still continued his liberality and kindness to the English.

English factories established at Ballasore and Hoogly.

* I was not able to find a copy of this firman among the Indian records; but Mr. Bruce mentions that it is in the State-paper Office, and is dated Feb. 2, 1633-4.

† See *East-India Records*, vol. xiv. p. 22.

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For eight years Shujaa ruled Bengal with great justice and propriety; but as Shah Jehan made it a practice to change his governors frequently, and was jealous of the power and authority he had himself conferred on his sons, he, in the year 1057, sent an order to the Prince, to deliver over the government to the Nuwab Aitcad Khan, and to repair to Court, as he was anxious again to have the pleasure of seeing him, after so long an absence. A. D. 1647.

Upon the arrival of Shujaa at Lahore, where the Emperor then held his Court, he was received in the most affectionate manner; but in a few months was appointed to the government of Cabul. This was a severe mortification to the Prince, who, in common with his brothers, disliked the northern provinces; whose snowy mountains, and uncouth inhabitants, suited not the habits and inclinations of young men accustomed to the luxuries and docile manners of the natives of the south.

For two years, however, Shujaa was compelled to do penance in Cabul; but, at the expiration of that period, he was allowed to return to Bengal, and received the province in the same state he had left it. Aitcad Khan, the governor, expecting that the Prince would shortly return, considered himself merely as a *locum tenens*, and neither altered nor abrogated any of his laws or regulations‡. A. D. 1649.

The following account of Sultan Shujaa, taken from the

‡ "Aitcad Khan was the younger brother of Shaistá Khan, and son of Asuf Khan, brother of the Empress Noor Jehan: being a man of pleasure, and possessing a handsome fortune, he did not wish for any public employment, but spent his time either at the capital, or in visiting his brother, and other excursions of pleasure." *Muasir al Omrah.* In this instance, he appears to have taken charge of Bengal merely to oblige the Emperor, with whom he was a great favourite.

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Character of Shujaa.

History of Hindoostan, will enable the reader to form a judgment of his character: "Shujaa was humane in his disposition, averse to cruelty, an enemy to oppression: in the execution of justice he had no respect of persons, except when the natural tenderness of his disposition gave his mind a bias towards the unfortunate. Though honest, like his brother Dara, he was not so open and free. He never told a falsehood; but he did not always tell the whole of the truth. He was more tranquil, more close and reserved, than Dara; and he was more fitted for the intrigues of party, and that management which is necessary to direct the various passions of men to one point. He was generous to his friends, and did not disdain to hear their advice, though he, for the most part, followed his own judgment of things. He was fond of pomp and magnificence, and much addicted to the pleasures of the *haram*. Graceful and active in his own person, he loved in women that complete symmetry of limbs which rendered him the favourite of the sex; and he spared no expense in filling his seraglio with ladies remarkable for their beauty and accomplishments. In their society he spent too much of his time; but the warmth of his constitution did not make him neglect the necessary affairs of life. During his long government of Bengal, he won the affections of the people by the softness of his manners, and his exact and rigorous execution of justice; and the country flourished in commerce and agriculture, under the protection which he invariably gave to industry. In battle he was brave; nor was he destitute of the talents necessary for a General: and we must attribute his misfortunes in the field to the effeminacy of his troops, more than to his own want of conduct."

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If such was the real character of Shujaa, we may suppose that the Court of Rajemahel rivalled that of Dehly in splendour and luxury; and that the opulent citizens, and persons in office, imitating the example of their Governor, imparted a taste for pleasure and expense to the inhabitants of the province in general; who, secured from all fears of foreign invasion by the affinity of their Prince with the Imperial throne, and protected by his impartial administration of justice from domestic oppression, probably enjoyed more happiness under Shujaa than they had experienced under any former Mohammedan governor.

During this period, it appears that the European nations had every facility given to their commerce; and that the English, in consequence of Shah Jehan's firman, and the privileges obtained by Mr. Boughton, enjoyed a free trade with Bengal: they were also at liberty to export any quantity of saltpetre they pleased; the value of which, in consequence of the civil war then raging in England, was very much enhanced*. He also granted the English his special *nishan*, or order, for freedom of trade.

For nine years after Shujaa's return to the government, the inhabitants of Bengal enjoyed an uninterrupted state of prosperity: but when, in the year 1068, the indisposition of the A. D. 1657. Emperor threw all Hindoostan into a state of convulsion, by the contentions of his four sons for the throne, the eastern provinces felt the shock; and the melody of the flagelet and tambourine was changed for the shrill notes of the trumpet, and martial sound of the kettle-drum.

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* See *Bruce's Annals*, A. D. 1651-2. Also Appendix, No 2.

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A. D. 1657. Shujaa asserts his claim to the Imperial throne.

Sultan Shujaa was the first, who, upon hearing of the dangerous illness of his father, took the field. He excused his precipitation to his followers, by avowing his conviction, that if his elder brother, Dara, succeeded to the throne, he had no prospect but death, or perpetual imprisonment.

The resources which he possessed were considerable; his treasury was well filled; his army numerous, and, to appearance, effective: he was also supported by the good wishes and affections of his subjects.

When Shujaa first hoisted the banner of hostility, he issued a manifesto, stating, that the Emperor was dead, and not without suspicion of treachery; and although he received letters from his father, announcing his recovery, he alleged that they were forged by Dara, to deceive him, and to gain time; he therefore continued his mareh to the vicinity of Benaras, and gave orders to construct a bridge of boats across the Ganges. In the mean time, he received intelligence that his youngest brother, Morad, had assumed the Imperial titles in Guzerat, and was on his march to Dehly, to assert his claim to the throne. This information afforded him at once pleasure and chagrin. He was gratified to think the attention and force of Dara would be divided, when assailed both from the east and the west: but it vexed him to find, that, after conquering Dara, he would still have another rival to subdue. Dara had the earliest intelligence of the designs of his brother in Bengal; and under pretence of a change of air being recommended to the Emperor, he removed him, and the whole Court, from Dehly to Agra. He had previously sent his son Solimān, with a chosen detachment of ten thousand horse, to secure Allahabad; and as soon as he received intelligence of

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Shujaa having commenced his march, he sent off Raja Jy Sing, and Dilere Khan, with a large reinforcement, to join his son.

The orders of the Prince were, to attack Shujaa with the utmost vigour; and compel him either to retreat, or to destroy him: but previous to the Raja's departure from Agra, the A. D. 1658. Emperor sent for him in private, and requested him, if possible, to negociate a peace between the brothers; and to persuade Shujaa to return quietly to Bengal.

Whilst Shujaa was busily employed in preparing his bridge, at Behadurpore in the vicinity of Benaras, the army of Solimān appeared on the opposite bank. But, previous to the commencement of hostilities, the Raja Jy Sing, in obedience to the directions of the Emperor, opened a negociation with the Prince; in which he pointed out to him the evils of a civil war, and the impolicy of opposing Dara, who, supported by the name and authority of his father, could command all the resources of the empire. Shujaa, convinced by his reasoning, and finding it impossible to conceal from his army the recovery of the Emperor, agreed to return to his government, and to disband his army.

The active spirit of the young Solimān, however, did not brook this negociation which Raja Jy Sing was carrying on without his participation: he endeavoured to break it off; and when concluded, he refused his assent: but, in the mean time, he had employed several persons to search for a ford, or to discover the narrowest part of the river, which, it being then the dry season of the year, was uncommonly low. On the day the truce was concluded, his spies brought him information, that, a few miles up the Ganges, his cavalry might cross with

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1658.

little difficulty. He communicated not his intentions to the Raja; but, under prefence of changing the ground of his encampment, he, in the middle of the night, marched off, and before break of day had crossed the river with his own troops and those of Dilere Khan. He then sent orders to the Raja to follow him; and, moving on with rapidity, he completely surprised the Bengal camp.

Shujaa, who had secured all the boats previous to the arrival of his adversaries, considered the Ganges as an insuperable barrier to their attacking him; and, lulled into further security by the negociation he had concluded, was taken totally unprepared. He was rouzed from his sleep by the clashing of arms, and the shouts of the enemy. He started up, seized his arms, and, to render himself conspicuous to his troops, mounted an elephant; but all his efforts to stop their flight was in vain: a few of his officers gathered round him, and fought bravely, but they were compelled, by superior numbers, to retreat to the river side, where they embarked on board the swift-rowing boats of Bengal, and were quickly conveyed to Patna. The capture of Shujaa's elephants, horses, and rich camp equipage, gratified the avarice and vanity of Solimān, and for a time stopt the pursuit. But the Imperial army soon followed the fugitives; and Shujaa, upon their approach, abandoned Patna, and retreated to Mongeir. The fortifications of Mongeir stopt Solimān, till he received orders from his father to return with all haste to Agra, to assist him in opposing his brothers Aurungzebe and Morad, who had united their forces, and combined against him.

The retreat of Solimān rouzed the drooping spirits of Shujaa, and he hastened to levy a new army; but when he

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received intelligence of the defeat of Dara, the captivity of the Emperor, and the usurpation of the throne by his younger brother Aurungzebe*, he was confounded, and knew not what to do. After much consideration, and advice of his counsellors, in order to gain time, he wrote to Aurungzebe, congratulating him on his success, and soliciting a confirmation of his government. SECT. VI. A. D. 1658.

The new Emperor, judging of others by his own feelings, was not to be deceived by such apparent moderation; he, however, treated the envoy of Shujaa with much attention, and was very particular in his inquiries respecting his master's family, and the state of his health: he concluded, by desiring the envoy to inform his brother, that, in the present state of affairs, the granting him a new commission for his government was unnecessary, and, in fact, improper; as he only considered himself the vicegerent of his father, whose infirmities, although they disabled him from wielding the sceptre with effect, did not annul his former appointments. This answer, though not satisfactory, was perhaps as much as Shujaa expected, and afforded him time to complete his preparations; but, in the mean while, it allowed Aurungzebe an opportunity of crushing the power of Dara, of subduing all his other enemies, and firmly establishing himself on the throne.

Shujaa at length threw off the mask, and, from a subject to Aurungzebe, became his competitor for the empire. In the year 1069, he marched from Bengal, with a numerous and well-appointed army; but which, being principally composed of new levies, he was under the necessity of instructing in A. D. 1659.

* See History of Hindoostan, A. D. 1658.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1659.

their duties, whilst advancing to the attack of an army of veterans. He arrived at Allahabad, and crossed the Ganges, without opposition. He halted there for some days; and afterwards proceeded thirty miles, to Kudgwa: at that place the advanced troops of Aurungzebe, under the command of his son Mohammed, came in sight; and orders were given to the Bengal army to throw up entrenchments in their front and left flank; the right being protected by the river.

The Imperial standards made their appearance the following day. Aurungzebe encamped his army opposite his brother's; leaving an extensive plain between the two camps, for a field of battle. On the morning of the 15th, both armies were drawn out in battle array; and, about noon, the cannonade commenced. Shujaa had placed his artillery on a rising ground, in front of his line; and his batteries being well served, the shot plunged into the thickest part of Aurungzebe's line, and, after destroying a number of his people, compelled him to retire.

At this time, Maharaja Jeswint Sing, who commanded the Rajepoot and other Hindoo troops in the service of Aurungzebe, not only deserted his post, but attacked and plundered the Royal camp, which had been left standing some miles in the rear of the army. They seized upon the treasure, cattle, and baggage of the principal officers, and retreated with them towards Agra. This event threw the army of Aurungzebe into great confusion; and had Shujaa been aware of the Raja's intention, and taken advantage of it, he might have obtained an easy victory*.

* Khafy Khan, author of the *Muntekhub al Lebab*, says the Raja did inform Shujaa of his intention; but the result of the contest is a strong evidence of the contrary.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1659.

Shujaa took no advantage of the confusion into which his brother's army was thrown; but, in the evening, allowed the whole of his own troops, together with the cannon, to return within his entrenchments; without taking any precaution to secure the rising ground, which had been so useful to him during the day. This oversight was soon perceived by Meer Jumla, a distinguished officer in Aurungzebe's service; who, having obtained permission, advanced during the night, and threw up a redoubt on the place, well lined with cannon, and defended by a select party of infantry.

As soon as day-light appeared, the negligent Shujaa was awoke by the shot from the redoubt piercing his tents, and the cries of his women. He arose, and saw his error; but it was then too late; and the only remedy left, was, to move his tents to another part of the line.

Aurungzebe, who perceived the commotion in the enemy's camp, thought this a proper opportunity to make a general assault. His army was already drawn out; and he ordered his elephants to advance and tread down the entrenchments.

The troops of Shujaa, however, defended themselves with great resolution: after some hours hard fighting, they compelled their enemies to retire; and, in turn, became the assailants. The Prince, mounted upon an enormous elephant, led the attack. He saw Aurungzebe at a distance, mounted in a similar manner. Fate now seemed to have placed the decision of the battle in his own hands. He ordered his driver to break through the crowd, and to impel the animal against that on which his brother rode. One of the officers of Aurungzebe, who was also mounted on an elephant, perceiving the intentions of Shujaa, rushed forward to meet him: the officer was

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1659.

overturned by the shock; but the elephant of Shujaa suffered so much by the concussion, that he stood for a time trembling in every joint, and could not be again induced to move forward. The disappointed Prince was enraged at his adverse fortune; but, in this dilemma, a driver of the war elephants that attended the Prince advanced against the Emperor, and, by the impetuosity of the first shock, brought the Royal elephant on his knees. Aurungzebe, alarmed at his situation, was about to dismount; when Meer Jumla, who was on horseback near him, called out, "Aurungzebe, you descend from the throne!" The Emperor took the hint, and resumed his seat: in the mean time, his elephant, having recovered, arose, but would not advance. Whilst in this situation, one of the servants, who sat behind Aurungzebe, shot the driver of the other elephant; but the furious animal still continuing to fight, the driver of the Emperor's elephant dexterously mounted him, and drove him off; whilst the servant, beforementioned, took the driver's seat in front of his master, who, finding his elephant very unsteady, and much inclined to run away, gave orders for the chain, which was used to fasten the animal, to be locked round his feet: by this means he was prevented from stirring from the spot.

As it often happens that the success of a battle depends, apparently, upon an inadequate cause, this determination and coolness of Aurungzebe convinced his followers that he was resolved to conquer or to die; and, admiring his magnanimity, they rallied round him, and repulsed the attack of the enemy.

Shujaa, finding that his troops began to give way, and that the elephant on which he rode was become untractable, by the advice of Aliverdy Khan (who is said to have been bribed by Aurungzebe), in an unlucky moment quitted the elephant, and

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mounted his horse. This action could have been seen by only a few of his men, who were near his person; but the greater part of the army perceiving the *ambhary* (seat with a canopy) empty, concluded their master was slain, and fled with precipitation. Aurungzebe was not in a situation immediately to pursue; and night, coming on, gave the fugitives leisure to effect their retreat, though at the expense of their artillery, stores, and camp equipage.

A. D. 1659, Sultan Shujaa defeated by Aurungzebe.

The circumstances which took place, both in this battle and that of Benaras, by no means entitle Shujaa to the panegyric passed on him by the author of the History of Hindoostan: in neither instance did he evince any skill or foresight as a general. He allowed himself to be shamefully surprised on both occasions, and sacrificed his troops by his negligence and want of circumspection: it was also a circumstance well known, that his brother Dara had lost the victory by alighting from his elephant: Shujaa should therefore have taken warning by his example, and have kept his seat, though surrounded with danger and difficulty. As a politician, his talents must appear despicable: doubtless he should have had agents in the enemy's camp, to inform him of the dispositions of the chiefs. The event proved, that one third of Aurungzebe's army, headed by the Maharaja, were disaffected to his cause; and had the attack of Shujaa been combined with the retreat of the Hindoos, there can be little doubt that the contest would have terminated differently. So strongly were his contemporaries convinced that he lost the battle from his want of prudence, that it is since become a proverbial saying in Hindoostan,

"Sujaa jeet bazy, apna haat hara."

"Shujaa having won the game, threw it up with his own hands."

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1659.

Terror and disgrace were the companions of Shujaa's flight: he changed his clothes; he threw off every mark of distinction; and hurried back to Patna as a private man. He not only feared his enemies, but those who had hitherto been his friends: he apprehended that the bribes of Aurungzebe would turn the swords of his own soldiers against him; and he feared to put confidence in any man. At length, arrived at Patna, he felt re-assured, and announced to his family and subjects his safe return.

The morning after the battle, Aurungzebe detached his son Mohammed, with ten thousand chosen horse, to pursue the unfortunate Shujaa. His orders were, not to relinquish the pursuit, till he had captured the fugitive, or reached the gates of Patna. The young man literally obeyed his instructions; and arrived at that city a very short time after his uncle, who, alarmed at the sudden appearance of the enemy, continued his retreat to Mongeir.

In the mean time, the anxiety of Aurungzebe being quieted with respect to the consequences of Maharaja Jeswint Sing's revolt, he ordered Meer Jumla, who then bore the title of Khan Khanan, with a numerous and well-appointed army, to follow the footsteps of the Prince Mohammed, and to assist him in driving Shujaa from Bengal.

Soon after the arrival of Shujaa at Mongeir, he was joined by a number of his dispersed followers; and, having received some reinforcements from Bengal, he strengthened the fortifications of Mongeir, by deepening the ditch; and threw up entrenchments from the fort to the hills, which formed a complete barrier against the enemy's advancing on that side of the river. He also sent orders to strengthen the works of

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Terriagurhy and Sicklygully, and to place garrisons of his best troops therein.

The Prince Mohammed having with little difficulty made himself master of the city of Patna, waited there for the arrival of his coadjutor, Meer Jumla, and the main body of the army.

After the arrival of that experienced officer at Patna, he sent intelligent spies, to procure him exact information of Shujaa's position; and having learnt that it was such as would require much time and difficulty to force, he summoned the zemindars of the neighbourhood of Patna to attend him; and from them he forced the confession, that there was another road by which he might enter Bengal, but that it was circuitous, narrow, and steep; and little used, on account of the difficulties it presented, and the savage manners of the mountaineers. This information was sufficient for Jumla: he selected twelve thousand of his best horse; and, unencumbered with any baggage, he took the route of Sheregotty*, which is situated in the mountains of Jarcund. In the mean time, the Prince Mohammed, with the remainder of the Royal army, proceeded, by easy marches, towards Mongeir, and encamped within a few miles of the fort. For several days after, skirmishing parties advanced from the camp, and made a show as if they intended to assault the entrenchments: by these means the attention of Shujaa was occupied, till his couriers brought him information that the enemy had entered the Bissuntpore province in his rear, and were advancing against his capital.

* A military high road was made about thirty years ago, by this route, from Benaras to Calcutta, which is one third shorter than the old road.

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SECT. VI. A. D. 1659. This intelligence overwhelmed Shujaa with grief and astonishment; he immediately withdrew his troops from the trenches, and retreated to Rajemahel, in which were lodged his family and treasures.

The road being thus left open, the Royal army advanced; and having stormed the passes of Terriagurhy and Sicklygully, invested Rajemahel on one side, while Meer Jumla occupied the other: a communication between the armies was speedily effected; and in a few days the batteries opened against the walls of the city.

For six days, Shujaa resisted all the attacks of the enemy; but was then convinced that the place was no longer tenable. He embarked his family and all his valuables on board boats; and, during a dark and stormy night, crossed over the river to Tondah, the fortifications of which he immediately ordered to be repaired. Fortunately for the fugitive Prince, on the very night that he made his escape, the rainy season set in with great violence: the rivers were swollen by torrents from the mountains, and the Royal camp was laid under water. Meer Jumla, seeing it impossible to pursue Shujaa, and that there was no remedy, was obliged to canton his army, for four months, in the vicinity of Rajemahel.

This respite afforded to the unfortunate Shujaa an opportunity of collecting all his troops from the lower part of Bengal. He also drew from thence a great train of artillery, which was well served by Portuguese, and other Europeans, who willingly entered his service; for that prince, being of a generous disposition, and free from bigotry, gave encouragement to people of all nations and religions; and, it is said, promised the Monks, who, since the destruction of Hoogly,

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were dispersed in different parts of the country, that, if he was successful, he would rebuild their churches, and restore them the privileges they enjoyed under the emperors Jehangire and Akbar. The affairs of that prince began now to assume a more favourable aspect: his troops, finding themselves supported by a good train of artillery, and regularly paid, resumed their confidence; and the eastern parts of Bengal, being intersected by rivers, still afforded many opportunities of prolonging the war, and of exhausting the patience and perseverance of his enemies.

During the time the armies lay in this position, the war-boats of Shujaa frequently crossed the river, and cannonaded the enemy's camp; and, by night attacks, kept them in such a constant state of alarm, that Jumla found it advisable to abandon the city of Rajemahel, and to encamp his army at some distance from the river side.

At this juncture, an event occurred which, for a time, rejoiced and animated the friends of Shujaa, and caused great alarm and anxiety to the new Emperor and his generals.

Love of Prince Mohammed for the daughter of Shujaa.

The Prince Mohammed, who, in conjunction with Jumla, commanded the Imperial army, had, before the breaking out of the civil war, been betrothed to his cousin, the daughter of Shujaa: the animosity between the brothers prevented the consummation of the marriage, and the friends of both parties supposed it was irrevocably broken off: even Mohammed, in the tumult of the camp, seemed to have forgotten the extolled charms of his cousin; but the Princess, moved by compassion for her father, wrote to him an affecting letter with her own hand. She lamented, in the most pathetic terms, the hardness of her fate, which had compelled her to see the man whom she had long considered as her husband waging relentless war

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against her beloved parent, and pursuing him and his family to destruction. This condescension, on the part of an amiable girl, rekindled the latent spark of affection and love in the breast of Mohammed: he resolved to relinquish all his prospects of the empire, to forfeit his father's favour, and to abandon "all the world for love." He, however, flattered himself, that a great portion of the army, who were strongly attached to him for his bravery and liberality, would follow him, and espouse the cause of Shujaa.

Some time after the commencement of the correspondence, the General, Meer Jumla, having removed his camp some distance from Rajemahel, the Prince considered it a favourable opportunity to sound the disposition of his troops. He accordingly invited a number of the officers, whom he considered as his best friends, to his quarters; and laid open to them his disgust at the cruelty and tyranny of his father, his resolution to espouse the cause of Shujaa, and his intention of immediately going over to Tondah, whither he hoped he should soon be followed by all his friends, and a considerable part of the army, whom he considered as devoted to his interest.

For some time the assembly remained mute with astonishment; but, instead of opposing the measure, and pointing out to the Prince the folly of his conduct, they, with that hypocrisy and flattery which are so disgraceful to Indian manners, said, "Whatever your Royal Highness does, must be right: and there can be no doubt, if you go over to Sultan Shujaa this evening, one half of the army will join your standard by sun-rise." On these vague assurances the Prince quitted Rajemahel that evening; he embarked in a pleasure-boat, attended by a few of his confidential servants, as if going

Prince Mohammed deserts to Shujaa.

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